BIO-SBI

Simulation experiments for planning organoid lineage experiments

Two-type branching models ($\mathrm{LGR5}^+ = \mathrm{A}$, $\mathrm{KRT20}^+ = \mathrm{B}$),
neural posterior estimation, identifiability and robustness

Status of results	7 November 2026 (X1, X4 still running)
Repository	`BIO-SBI`, branch `main`, results up to commit `a63b3a8`
Data	synthetic (all experiments) and measured CRC0322 organoid counts (Part II)
Audience	group planning the wet-lab organoid experiments

How to read this report. The executive summary (p. 1) is self-contained. Section 1 defines the model and every diagnostic. Each experiment section has the same four parts: *Question*, *Setup*, *Result*, *Comment*. Orange boxes mark experiments that are still running or were planned but never run. Parameters: A→AA etc. are outcome probabilities per cell event; τ_A, τ_B are mean cell lifetimes (Bellman–Harris only).

Executive summary

Scope. All simulation sweeps of E0–E4 are finished (1126 runs, incl. the E4 extensions to 1024–4096 organoids per endpoint, 5k-vs-20k simulation checks at the real-like BH design, at 512 and at 4096 per endpoint, and the full transition model at 4096, §2.1), all on synthetic data from one reference parameter vector $\theta^\star$ (Table 1), 5 seeds per setting. Two later experiments test the role of the prior with truths swept or drawn from the prior: the E2c rerun (90 runs, §17) and X5 (355 runs, §23); X2 (40 runs, §21) separates dataset from training noise. New in this version: X3 (GW fitted to BH data, 25 runs, §22), the follow-ups of E2 (asymmetric mis-typing, 80 runs, §14.1) and E1b (all seeded organoids recorded, 90 runs, §10.1), the BH timing P0 (§24.1) and the first fit of *measured* data, CRC0322 organoids (12 models × 5 data variants, Part II). X1 (methods) and X4 (combined errors) are still running. Galton–Watson (GW, time in generations; mapping to days nominal) and Bellman–Harris (BH, time in hours; real-like design = days 6 and 10 = 144/240 h with 165/101 organoids). Every error is compared with the well-specified control of the same sweep.

Headline — the real CRC0322 organoids (Part II). The model class used in every synthetic experiment (shared outcome probabilities, one A founder, B cells not dividing, constant lifetimes) **cannot describe the measured organoids**: posterior support mass 0.01–0.04 and 44–54% of the summary features outside the 95% predictive interval; it predicts a strongly positive A–B correlation across organoids where the data show a negative one (z = −21 and −60 on days 6 and 10). Of twelve models fitted to five data variants (3D mean, the three 3D samples, 2D sections), only the combination of **organoid-level fate heterogeneity** (each organoid draws its own outcome probabilities around the shared ones) and **density-dependent growth** (lifetimes lengthen as the organoid grows) fits both the 2D and the 3D data: support 0.73–0.94 over variants and two training seeds, PPC 0–10% (3D) and 10–15% (2D). *Identifiable*: A self-renewal A→AA ≈ 0.6 (0.62 ± 0.06 in 3D, 0.64 ± 0.08 in 2D); A division time early in growth ≈ 16 h in the 3D counts (16.9 ± 1.7 h; 28 h in 2D, a scale difference); carrying capacity $K \approx 50$ cells (54 ± 13 in 3D; 18 in 2D); strong organoid-to-organoid heterogeneity, $\kappa \approx 3$–4. *Not identifiable*: whether KRT20$^+$ cells divide or switch back to LGR5$^+$, and the founder mix — as E0 and E1a predicted from synthetic data.

Key findings

1. **The well-specified GW model is recovered**: at the real-like design MAE 0.033 over the 9 outcome probabilities, contraction 0.89, A→AA 0.52 (truth 0.55); across all E4 designs A→AA 0.47–0.55 — provided B's divisions are fixed to 0 (E0).
2. **B's row is prior-dominated if all transitions are free** (E0): B→A = 0.20 vs truth 0.80 at 5k–50k simulations, every design (uniform Dirichlet puts 0.03% mass above 0.8; a flat prior gives 0.53). X5 shows this is structural, not a tail effect: the estimate barely follows the truth (0.04 → 0.22 for truths 0.1 → 0.9) and 1024 organoids do not fix it. **Decided: structural** (§2.1): with B divisions free, even 4096 organoids per endpoint on three endpoints and a 20k-simulation network give B→A 0.17–0.34 (0/20 runs covered) and put about half of B's probability (0.49–0.57, the prior mean 0.5) on divisions that do not exist, with a clean PPC ($\leq 0.6\%$). In GW the confounding also biases A's row (A persist 0.16 vs 0.03). Whether B divides must be fixed or measured.
3. **Endpoints matter more than organoids, in both simulators** (E4): days/generations {4,6,10} beat every other set at every size; one late endpoint plateaus; a late extra endpoint ({6,10,14}) adds little. GW: contraction 0.80 → 0.95 → 0.96, MAE 0.052 → 0.023 → 0.019 → 0.020 (16 → 512 → 2048 → 4096 organoids/endpoint); with {4,6,10} every probability except A→AB (error 0.02–0.03, intermittently covered) is recovered by ≈ 128, and at 5k simulations multi-endpoint designs plateau at ≈ 1024 per endpoint (MAE ≈ 0.02; flat to 4096). A single endpoint never catches up: at 4096 organoids MAE 0.046, worse than three endpoints at 32 (0.042). BH: 0.50 → 0.79 → 0.80 → 0.82, MAE 0.114 → 0.060 → 0.058 → 0.057. **The plateau is set by the network, not the data**: at 4096 organoids per endpoint, 20k instead of 5k training simulations on the same datasets lower GW MAE 0.020 → 0.017 and SBC error 0.064 → 0.044, and raise BH run coverage 0.76 → 0.93 (§4.1).
4. **BH baseline bias = lifetime/self-renewal ridge.** Well-specified BH gives A→AA ≈ 0.32 and $\tau_A \approx 16$ h (truth 0.55, 20 h), 0/5 covered, at every design. Fixing lifetimes to the truth gives 0.51 (5/5), MAE 0.109 → 0.059 (§6). With the standard 5k-simulation NPE the posterior stays on the ridge up to 4096 clones per endpoint (up to 12 288 organoids, E4): A→AA 0.29–0.41, τ_A 15.7–17.1 h, 0/5 covered in every design, τ_A contraction 0.99 — confidently on the wrong point. But with 20k simulations at 4096 clones (days 4/6/10) it moves most of the way to the truth: A→AA 0.40 → 0.50 (3/5 covered), τ_A 17.0 → 18.9 h (3/5), lifetime error 0.27 → 0.15 (§4.1). At realistic sizes 20k simulations do *not* move it: real-like design A→AA 0.32 → 0.33, τ_A 15.9 → 15.4 h (0/5); with 512 per endpoint on days 4/6/10 it starts (A→AA 0.38 → 0.44, τ_A 2/5 covered). The ridge resolves gradually with data if the network is trained enough; at realistic sizes lifetime information remains necessary. Averaged over the prior A→AA is learned well (X5d): the bias is specific to this tail truth.

5. **A free time scale hides errors** (Figs. 1, 2). In BH the PPC stays ≤ 0.033 for every error except both deaths fixed wrong (0.096) and a global lifetime longer than A's (0.35–0.51). GW, without lifetimes, flags more: A death fixed too high (support ≈ 0), B death fixed at 4× truth (support 0.13–0.33), 40% multi-cell founders (PPC 0.12, support 0.16). Still silent in GW: wrong founder type, B death at 2× truth (B→A 0/5 covered), ignored mis-typing up to 2 posterior sd.
6. **Size of the tested errors (vs paired control; BH | GW):**
   - founders 50% B: A→AB -0.11, τ_B $+4$ h | shifts ≤ 0.07 (silent in both);
   - 40% multi-cell clones: τ_A -1.8 h, B→A -0.07 | A→AA $+0.13$, B→A -0.25 (0/5 covered, flagged);
   - B death fixed at 0.4 (true 0.1): B→A -0.19 | -0.23 to -0.26; A death fixed at 0.2 (true 0.03): A persist -0.10, τ_A -2 to -3 h | no fit; deaths fixed at 0: ≤ 0.07 in both (silent);
   - mis-typing ignored, $e = 0.2$: A→AB $+0.09$ (0.7 sd) | $+0.15$ (2.1 sd; already 1.4 sd at $e = 0.1$); modelled: information loss (A→AB contraction 0.30 → -0.22 | 0.85 → 0.37);
   - BH only: lifetime CV 0.18–0.5 harmless, exponential A→AA $+0.16$, B→A -0.18; quiescence (A persist) not identifiable.
7. **Founder composition**: founder type not learnable in BH (contraction ≤ 0.12), partly in GW (0.68 for truth 0.5); inferring it removes no shift. Founder size: stays at prior in BH; in GW it tracks the truth (0.71 for $p_1 = 0.6$) and inferring it removes the misfit and halves the shifts.
8. **Observed-organoid fraction** (detected/seeded): 0.94–0.95 at $\theta^\star$; dominated by A death (0.3 ⇒ 0.54–0.58); GW exact and BH simulated agree to 0.02 on average; A and B death trade off (one constraint, not two).
9. **Hidden third type (GW, E2c): resolved by the rerun with prior-drawn truths** (§17). The original failure of even the true model (support ≈ 0) was the tail truth (prior probability 10^{-6}–10^{-10}), not the method. In the prior bulk, ignoring C is flagged when C is read as B (9/10 runs at $q = 0$, 7/10 at $q = 0.5$) but *not* when C reads as A (2/10 at $q = 1$, while A/B MAE 0.18 and coverage 0.42 at contraction 0.86: silent confident bias). Modelling C (free or trajectory-constrained) is calibrated (PPC 0, coverage 0.92–0.93) but not identifiable at this design: contraction 0.16–0.20, A/B MAE 0.055–0.059 = prior-mean baseline 0.057; the wrong trajectory constraint is not detected.
10. **Role of the prior (X5, §23)**: (i) averaged over truths drawn from the prior, GW and BH are calibrated (90% coverage, SBC ≈ 0.03; contraction 0.68 GW vs 0.51 BH) — single-truth failures are about truths and priors, not broken inference. (ii) The B-row failure is structural: with B divisions free no prior (uniform, Jeffreys, flat) and no sample size (up to 1024 organoids; nor 4096 per endpoint with a 20k network, §2.1) recovers B→A; with them fixed every truth 0.1–0.9 is recovered under every prior. Constraints, not priors or more organoids. A weak biological prior (A mostly divides, B rarely) is the best soft option (B-division mass 0.54 → 0.11, lowest error, calibrated) but recovers B→A only partly (0.59 at truth 0.9; constraint 0.79). (iii) The BH ridge is a tail-truth effect (at realistic sizes not a training limit: 20k simulations leave it in place; data resolve it gradually from 512 to 4096 per endpoint with a well-trained network, E4); a right literature lifetime prior (±25%) moves A→AA 0.32 → 0.46 (MAE 0.109 → 0.068). (iv) A lifetime prior 50% too long is detected (support ≈ 0, PPC 0.27).
11. **GW as an approximation of BH (X3, §22)**: on BH data (τ_A 20 h, τ_B 30 h) a GW model with a generation length τ at or below A's lifetime fits without any warning (support 0.62–0.84, PPC 0). With $\tau = 20$ h it recovers A's row better than the true BH model (A→AA 0.52, 5/5 covered; MAE 0.086 vs 0.116): fixing τ fixes the time scale and removes the ridge. The price is a silent bias in B's row: B's slower cycle is read as persistence (B persist 0.40 vs 0.10, B→A 0.48 vs 0.80, 0/5). τ longer than A's lifetime fails loudly (τ 24 h: support 0.05, PPC 0.21; 30 h: no posterior samples). GW is usable only with τ set from measured division times of the fastest type.
12. **Mis-typing direction matters (E2 follow-up, §14.1)**: stem cells read as differentiated (A→B label, e_A) are the harmful direction. In GW, ignoring $e_A = 0.10$–0.15 doubles the error (MAE 0.040 → 0.066–0.086, coverage 0.64–0.76) and lowers B→A to 0.63–0.66, partly flagged (support 0.42–0.50); B read as A at 0.10 is almost harmless (MAE 0.040, coverage 0.84). Modelling the known confusion removes the bias. In BH the effect is small next to the ridge error (MAE ≈ 0.12 in every setting).
13. **Recording extinct organoids (E1b follow-up, §10.1)**: with every seeded organoid recorded, death rates are sharper in BH (A death sd 0.015–0.033 vs 0.045–0.057 detected-only) but overall accuracy does not improve, and in GW it worsens (MAE 0.063 vs 0.032 at A death 0.03). Survivor-only summaries plus the extinct fraction recover part of the loss (GW 0.057, 0.068 at A death 0.03, 0.10) but do not beat detected-only data at equal design size.
14. **BH cost (P0, §24.1)**: on an idle machine a BH run at the real-like design costs the same as a GW run (≈ 45 s at `budget=dev`; training $\approx 85\%$, simulation $< 10\%$). Earlier minute-long run times were contention.

Recommendations for the wet-lab design

- **Endpoints:** three, including an early one — e.g. days 4, 6, 10 (best in both simulators). A single day-10 endpoint is the weakest design, and no number of organoids compensates (GW: 4096 per endpoint at one endpoint is worse than 32 per endpoint at three).
- **Organoids:** ≈ 128 per endpoint. In GW this recovers every outcome probability with {4,6,10} (A→BB from 32, B persist from 64, B→A from 128; A→AB within 0.03 but only intermittently covered); gains stop at ≈ 1024 per endpoint. In BH it gives contraction 0.71; A→BB and B death need ≥ 128, A→AB ≥ 256; self-renewal is not recovered at realistic sizes without lifetime information, whatever the training budget (real-like design with 20k simulations: A→AA 0.33; 512 per endpoint: 0.44; only 4096 with 20k comes close: 0.50, §4.1).
- **Measure independently:**
  (a) *A (LGR5$^+$) division time* by live imaging — the single most valuable measurement (it is what separates BH, MAE 0.109, from the GW target, 0.033); per type, not pooled. It is also what a GW approximation needs (X3: τ from the fastest type), and what would test the real-data estimate (16.9 h early in growth, lengthening with organoid size);
  (b) *whether B (KRT20$^+$) cells divide* — by live imaging, lineage tracing or a proliferation marker on KRT20$^+$ cells. The counts cannot decide it even at 4096 organoids per endpoint (§2.1), and B→A is identifiable only once B divisions are fixed;
  (c) *seeding*: number of organoids seeded per well (observed fraction, sensitive to A death; recorded as extinct organoids it sharpens the death rates in BH, §10.1) and whether wells contain multi-cell seeds ($\gtrsim 15\%$ multi-cell clones bias self-renewal and B→A in GW; then fix or infer the founder-size distribution);
  (d) *mis-typing rate* (2D vs 3D comparison), above all how often LGR5$^+$ cells are called KRT20$^+$ (the harmful direction, §14.1), and pass it to the model as an asymmetric confusion: ignored, it is tolerable only up to $e \approx 0.05$ once posteriors are as narrow as in GW;
  (e) *cell-cycle variability*: only whether CV is < 0.5 or near-exponential;
  (f) *founder type* and *quiescence* (e.g. Ki67) if they matter biologically — the counts cannot provide them;
  (g) *apoptosis* only if death rates are to be fixed; otherwise keep them free (a value too high biases B→A; in BH silently).
- **Biological constraints help more than data**: B divisions = 0 (if KRT20$^+$ cells do not divide) is what makes B→A identifiable; neither a different prior, nor 1024 organoids, nor 4096 per endpoint on three endpoints with a 20k-simulation network replaces it (X5a, X5c, §2.1); with B divisions free, the B-row bias also leaks into A's row. If it is not known that B cells do not divide, measure it (item (b) above). A soft biological prior ("B rarely divides") helps but does not replace it; with the constraint keep B's prior near-uniform (an informative symmetric one shrinks B→A toward 1/3).
- **Simulation budget:** train every BH fit and every large design ($\gtrsim 1024$ per endpoint) on ≥ 20k simulations with an epoch cap of ≥ 500 (the 20k runs at 4096 stopped at the 200-epoch cap) and check SBC. At the real-like design 20k does not fix the ridge but lowers the probability error (MAE 0.109 → 0.079); 5k results at large sizes are lower bounds on attainable accuracy (§4.1).
- **Literature division times** can enter as an informative lifetime prior ($\pm 25\%$ gets most of the benefit of fixing them, X5b); check PPC and support mass for conflict (a prior that is too long is flagged; too-short lifetimes bias silently, E3a).
- **Real-data fits must model organoid heterogeneity and density dependence** (Part II): the homogeneous constant-lifetime model of the synthetic experiments is rejected by the CRC0322 data. Report only the identifiable quantities (A self-renewal, A's early division time, K, κ) and treat B's row and the founder mix as unresolved until measured (B divisions, founder type at seeding).
- **Hidden third type**: endpoint counts of two labels cannot identify a three-type model (E2c rerun). If C may exist, find out how it is labelled: read as B, ignoring it is usually flagged; read as A, it biases the A/B rows silently. Modelling it needs a C-specific marker, trajectory data that justify constraints, or much richer designs — a free C model returns the prior.

Methodological lessons

- **Prior tails**: a truth with $< 2\%$ prior mass is pulled to the prior only where the data are weak or confounded along a ridge (A→AA = 0.55 in BH); where the model is identifiable the data win at every truth position (X5a, B divisions fixed: B→A 0.1–0.9 recovered under every prior). Where it is structurally confounded (B divisions free) the prior decides at every position, and neither a flat prior nor more organoids fixes it. With 10^{-6} or less (original E2c) amortised NPE extrapolates outside the prior support, while the same model is calibrated for truths in the bulk. SBC and prior-averaged coverage (X5d) look fine in all these cases: report prior quantiles of the truth, check prior sensitivity, and compare hand-picked truths with prior-drawn ones.
- **Simulation budget vs data size — confirmed**: at 1024–4096 organoids per endpoint the SBC error

of the 5k-simulation amortised NPE doubles (GW 0.03 → 0.06; BH up to 0.039) and accuracy is flat from 2048 to 4096. The 20k check at 4096 (same datasets) separates the two: GW MAE 0.020 → 0.017, SBC 0.064 → 0.044; BH coverage 0.76 → 0.93, A→AA 0.40 → 0.50. The plateau was the network's, and at very large designs an apparently data-limited ridge is partly a training limit (E4, §4.1); training hit the 200-epoch cap there. At realistic sizes the same check (epoch cap 500, not binding) shows the reverse: the ridge stays (A→AA 0.32 → 0.33) while other parameters improve. Test the budget before attributing a bias to the data.

- **Training noise is small; quote the posterior sd** (X2, §21): at the real-like design the sd of posterior means over 10 training seeds on one dataset is ≈20% of the posterior sd (median 0.24 GW, 0.18 BH; its variance ≈4% of the posterior variance). Dataset and training contribute about equally to the seed-to-seed spread (training share 0.53 GW, 0.70 BH), and posteriors are wider than the spread of posterior means across datasets (GW B→A: sd 0.123 vs 0.043). So the posterior sd, not the seed sd, is the uncertainty to quote; differences $\gtrsim 0.3$ posterior sd between arms are not training artefacts; narrow posteriors are the exception (GW A→AA: training noise 0.65 posterior sd).
- **Ridges and free time scales**: endpoint counts fix the growth rate; lifetime, self-renewal and quiescence trade off along it (posterior corr. +0.7, −0.6). The prior picks the point, and the free lifetime also absorbs (hides) errors that GW detects (E1a number, E1c).
- **Compare with paired controls**, not with the truth (BH baseline is biased); 5 seeds resolve shifts of ≈0.02–0.03 (probabilities) and 0.5–1.5 h.
- **Diagnostics**: SBC checks the inference model only; PPC and support mass are relative checks and vary between well-specified GW runs (support 0.07–0.89, PPC up to 0.10); support mass ≈ 0 = the model cannot explain the data (numbers from such runs are not estimates). A clean PPC does not imply identifiability: with B divisions free at 4096 organoids per endpoint the PPC is ≤ 0.6% while B→A is 0.17–0.34 (§2.1).
- **On measured data the checks select models; a synthetic check selects the estimates** (Part II): support mass and PPC separated twelve candidate models clearly (support 0.00–0.06 vs 0.73–0.94). But the final model's B row is as confident-looking as its A row; only a synthetic recovery check of the same trained network shows which parameters are identifiable. Run both for every real-data fit.

Done since the previous version: the real CRC0322 data (Part II); X3 GW fitted to BH data (§22); P0 BH timing (§24.1); asymmetric mis-typing (§14.1); all seeded organoids as data, with survivor summaries (§10.1). **Running** (Part III): X1 methods comparison, X4 combined errors. **New follow-ups**: mis-typing in the real-data model; alternative forms of heterogeneity and density dependence; the synthetic conclusions re-checked under the final model class. The results point to *measurements* rather than more simulations: A's division time, whether B cells divide, the LGR5→KRT20 mis-typing rate and the number of seeded organoids.

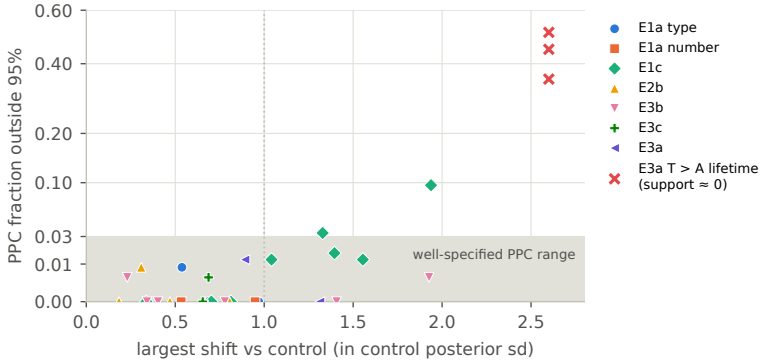


Figure 1: Detectability of BH misspecifications. Each point is one misspecified setting (mean of 5 seeds): largest shift of a posterior mean from its paired well-specified control, in units of the control's posterior sd, against the PPC. Grey band = PPC range of well-specified runs. Crosses: global lifetime $T > \tau_A$ (support mass ≈ 0).

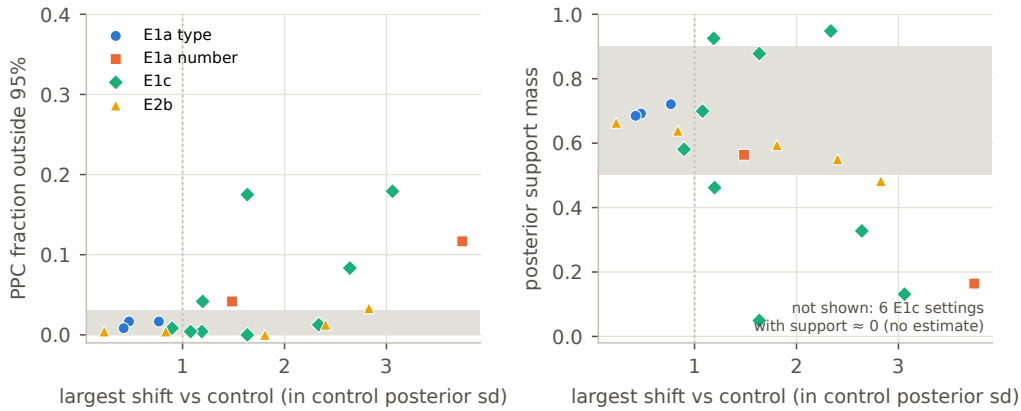


Figure 2: Detectability of GW misspecifications (E1a type and number, E1c, E2b): largest shift from the paired control in control posterior sd, against the PPC (left) and the posterior support mass (right). Grey bands = well-specified ranges. GW flags more errors than BH (no free time scale), but several shifts of 1–3 sd remain inside the well-specified bands.

Contents

Executive summary 1

1 Methods overview 8

I Finished experiments 11

2 E0 — Identifiability of B's row (GW) 11

3 Design comparison — one vs three endpoints (GW) 13

4 E4 — Amount of data: organoids and endpoints (BH) 14

5 E4 — Amount of data (GW) and comparison with BH 18

6 BH ridge — lifetime vs self-renewal 20

7 E1a — Wrong founder type (organoid death as initial conditions; BH and GW) 22

8 E1a — Wrong number of founder cells (BH) 23

9 E1a — Wrong number of founder cells (GW) 24

10 E1b — Death rates and the observed-organoid fraction (BH and GW) 25

11 E1c — Death rates fixed to wrong values (BH) 27

12 E1c — Death rates fixed to wrong values (GW, 4×4 grid) 28

13 E2a / E2b — A↔B mis-typing, known vs ignored (BH) 30

14 E2a / E2b — A↔B mis-typing, known vs ignored (GW) 31

15 E2c — Hidden third type ignored (GW) 32

16 E2c — Third type modelled: three-arm comparison (GW) 33

17 E2c rerun — hidden third type, truths from the prior (GW) 34

18 E3a — Per-type division time vs one global value (BH) 36

19 E3b — Desynchronisation: lifetime CV misspecified (BH) 37

20 E3c — Quiescence vs division time (BH) 38

21 X2 — Seed spread: dataset vs training (GW and BH) 39

22 X3 — Galton–Watson fitted to Bellman–Harris data 40

23 X5 — Role of the prior (GW and BH) 41

24 Device and batch-size benchmark 48

II Real data (CRC0322) 50

25 R — CRC0322 data and fitting procedure **50**

26 R — Model ladder: what the organoids require **51**

27 R — Final model: fate heterogeneity and density-dependent growth **53**

III Running and planned experiments 55

28 Running and planned work (X1, X4, follow-ups) **55**

A Reproducibility **56**

B Glossary **58**

1 Methods overview

1.1 Model

- **Two cell types**: A = LGR5$^+$ (stem-like), B = KRT20$^+$ (differentiated).
- **One event per cell**: a cell is replaced by 0, 1 or 2 daughters. Outcomes of A: death, persist (stays, no division), A→B (switch), divisions A→AA, A→AB, A→BB. B mirrors A.
- **Parameters**: one probability simplex per type; Dirichlet(1,...,1) prior (uniform).
- **Laws**: `two_type` = all 12 outcomes free (10 free params); `reversible_ab` = B divisions fixed to 0 (B: death, persist, B→A; 7 free) — the baseline of every experiment after E0.
- **Founders**: a clone (organoid) starts from N cells ($P(N{=}n)$ = `founder_size`) of i.i.d. type (`founder`); baseline: one A cell.

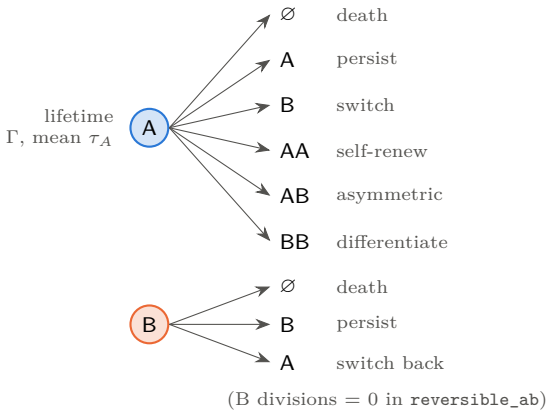


Table 1: Reference truth $\theta^\star$ used by every experiment unless stated (`law.reference`); one founder cell of type A. Prior probability of exceeding the truth under the uniform Dirichlet: A→AA 1.8%; B→A 0.03% (`two_type`) or 4% (`reversible_ab`).

Type	death	persist	switch	→AA	→AB	→BB	mean lifetime (BH)
A	0.03	0.03	0.05 (A→B)	**0.55**	0.05	0.29	τ_A = 20 h
B	0.10	0.10	**0.80** (B→A)	0	0	0	τ_B = 30 h

BH lifetimes: Gamma, shape 8 (CV 0.35). GW: one event per generation.

1.2 Two simulators

	Galton–Watson (GW)	**Bellman–Harris (BH)**
Time	synchronous generations; endpoints in *generations* (real-like: 6 and 10)	continuous; Gamma lifetimes per type; endpoints in *hours* (real-like: 144 and 240 h = days 6, 10)
Extra parameters	none	τ_A, τ_B (log-uniform prior); shape fixed (8)
Sampling	exact detection-conditioned sampler; exact observed fraction	forward simulation + rejection; observed fraction estimated
Cost (P0, idle machine)	real-like design, `dev`: 45 s per run	real-like design, `dev`: 42 s per run (training ≈ 85%)

GW and BH share the outcome law but not the time unit; a GW generation is *not* a day. X3 (§22) fits GW to BH data with a fixed generation length in hours (§1.5).

1.3 Observation, data model and inference model

- **Observation**: biology → capture (Binomial per true type) → labelling (confusion matrix true type × label; may be rectangular, e.g. hidden C read as A with prob. q) → selection of *recovered* clones (≥ 1 detected cell). Baseline: perfect capture and typing.
- **Data**: per endpoint, A and B counts of each recovered organoid. Endpoints are destructive: different organoids per endpoint.
- **Misspecification**: the reference data come from a separate *data model* (`data.simulator`, `data.law`, `data.observation`, with seed `data_seed`); the *inference model* defines prior, training simulations and checks. An error is tested by changing one side only.

1.4 Inference

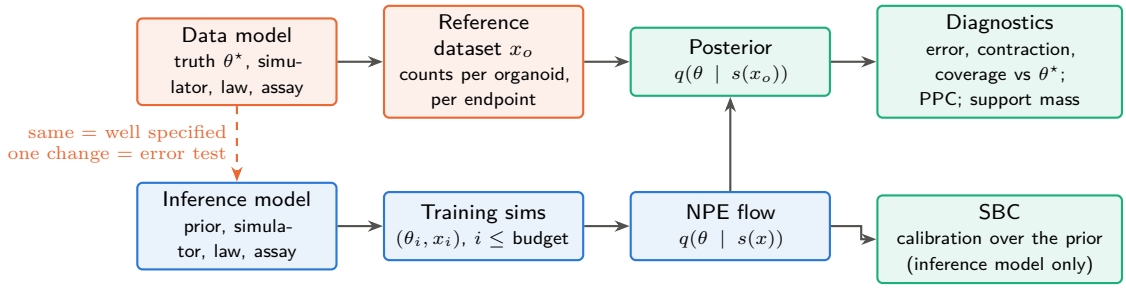
- **NPE** (`sbi` 0.27, neural spline flow, 5 transforms, width 64), amortised, 1 round; sequential NPE (SNPE) only in E0.
- **Summaries** (`moments`): per endpoint, mean, sd, quantiles of $\log(1+n)$ for A, B, total; fraction of clones containing each type; fraction empty; correlation of log counts.
- **Budgets**: `dev` = 5 000 simulations (all BH and most GW error experiments); 20 000 for E0/design comparison and the E4 budget checks; E0 also 50 000. E0 showed 5k→50k does not change recovery. Per run: 2 000 posterior samples, SBC on 200 prior draws, PPC with 200 datasets.

- **Parameterisation**: stick-breaking of each simplex (exact Dirichlet reparameterisation).

1.5 Model extensions (X3, E1b follow-up, real data)

- **GW on an hour axis** (`simulator=galton_watson_hours`; X3): GW with a fixed generation length τ (`model.hours_per_generation`); an endpoint of h hours is simulated as $g = \text{round}(h/\tau)$ generations, so designs and summaries stay in hours and a GW model can be fitted to BH data. τ is set, not inferred.
- **All seeded organoids and survivor summaries** (`observation=all_clones`, `summary=survivor_moments`; E1b follow-up): extinct organoids are recorded as (0, 0) rows; `survivor_moments` computes every `moments` statistic on the non-empty organoids only and adds the extinct fraction.
- **Organoid-level heterogeneity** (real data; `law=two_type_hetero`, law key `clone_heterogeneity`): each organoid draws its own outcome rows, $p_k^{\text{org}} \sim m_k\,\text{Dirichlet}(\kappa\, p_k/m_k)$ over the free entries of row k (mass m_k), independently per organoid and type; all cells of the organoid share them. $E[p^{\text{org}}] = p$ and $\text{Var}(p_{k,o}^{\text{org}}) = p_{k,o}(m_k - p_{k,o})/(\kappa+1)$: small κ = strong heterogeneity, $\kappa \to \infty$ = the homogeneous model. One extra parameter `clone.kappa`, log-uniform prior on $[1, 1000]$. In the "fate-only" variant only the three divisions vary between organoids, while death, persistence and switching stay shared (option `outcomes=[div_AA,div_AB,div_BB]`).
- **Density-dependent lifetimes** (`simulator=bellman_harris_dd`; real data): a cell born when its organoid has N living cells lives Gamma(shape, $\tau_k(1 + N/K)$/shape) hours, so the cycle lengthens as the organoid grows (decelerating growth, tighter sizes). N counts the living cells right after the birth; a lifetime is fixed at birth. The carrying capacity K (`density.capacity`) is shared by all organoids, log-uniform prior on $[10, 10^5]$; $K \to \infty$ is plain BH. τ_k is then the lifetime of a cell in a small organoid.
- **Measured-data fits** (`bio-sbi-infer <run> <data.csv> --ppc 500`): a trained network is conditioned on measured counts (one row per organoid: horizon, A, B); it reports posterior support mass and a PPC on the 48 summary features. Without a truth there is no error or coverage: identifiability is judged by the trained network's own synthetic recovery check.

1.6 Pipeline and experiment logic



Experiment logic: vary one error on the data side (or one assumption on the inference side), keep everything else at the baseline, and compare with the *well-specified control of the same sweep* (same seeds, same datasets; often the same trained network, so differences are paired by seed).

1.7 Diagnostics and how to read them

Metric	Definition	How to read
Posterior mean / error	mean of 2 000 posterior samples; |mean − truth|. MAE over probabilities only (`mae_probabilities`); lifetimes separately	compare misspecified vs control; "shift" = difference of posterior means, paired by seed, ± paired SE over 5 seeds
Contraction	$1 - \text{Var}_{\text{post}}/\text{Var}_{\text{prior}}$	0 = data uninformative; < 0 = wider than prior; > 0.5 = informative
90% coverage across seeds	number of seeds (of 5) whose 90% credible interval contains the truth	4–5/5 expected; 0/5 with high contraction = confident bias
SBC coverage error	mean |empirical − nominal| coverage of central intervals (50–95%) over 200 prior draws	≤ 0.03 = calibrated. Averages over the prior: blind to tail truths and to misspecification
PPC fraction outside 95%	share of summary features whose observed value lies outside the 95% posterior predictive interval	well specified: 0–0.03. Higher = the model cannot reproduce the data. Relative check
Posterior support mass	share of the NPE posterior inside the prior support	well specified ≈ 0.5–0.9 (not 1). ≈ 0 = model cannot explain the data; few/no samples, not an estimate
Recovered (TODO criterion)	contraction > 0.5, |error| < 0.05, coverage ≥ 4/5	used for "organoids needed" (E4)

Reading rules used throughout. (1) *BH baseline bias*: well-specified BH runs give A→AA ≈ 0.32 and $\tau_A \approx$ 16 h (truth 0.55, 20 h); BH misspecified arms are compared with their control, never with the truth. (2) With all transitions free, B's row is not identifiable from endpoint counts (E0; decided at 4096 organoids per endpoint, §2.1). (3) A misspecification that raises neither PPC nor lowers support mass is *undetectable from the fit*. (4) 5 seeds per setting: effects below ≈ 2 paired SE are not resolved. Each seed changes both dataset and network; training noise is ≈ 20% of the posterior sd and about half of the seed-to-seed spread (X2, §21). (5) Wall times in run metrics were measured under heavy contention; only the device benchmark (§24) and P0 (§24.1) measure speed.

Part I

Finished experiments

2 E0 — Identifiability of B's row (GW)

Question

With all transitions free, B→A (true 0.80) came out at ≈0.2. Is this under-training, one bad dataset, miscalibration, a prior-tail effect, or non-identifiability (switching vs division)?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson, perfect observation
Law (free)	`two_type` (10) vs `reversible_ab` (7; B divisions fixed to their true 0)
Data vs inference	well specified (same $\theta^\star$, Table 1)
Design	generations 4, 8, 12 × 32 clones (96 organoids)
Inference / budget	NPE amortised 5k, 20k, 50k; SNPE 4 rounds × 5k; `two_type` with flat prior on B→A (Beta(1,1)), 20k
Seeds / runs	5 / 40 (+ direct checks: C2ST of mean-preserving alternatives, 500 datasets per side)
Varied	law, budget, method, prior
Folder	`results/b_row/` (`distinguish.csv`, `truth_vs_posterior_20k*.csv`)

Result

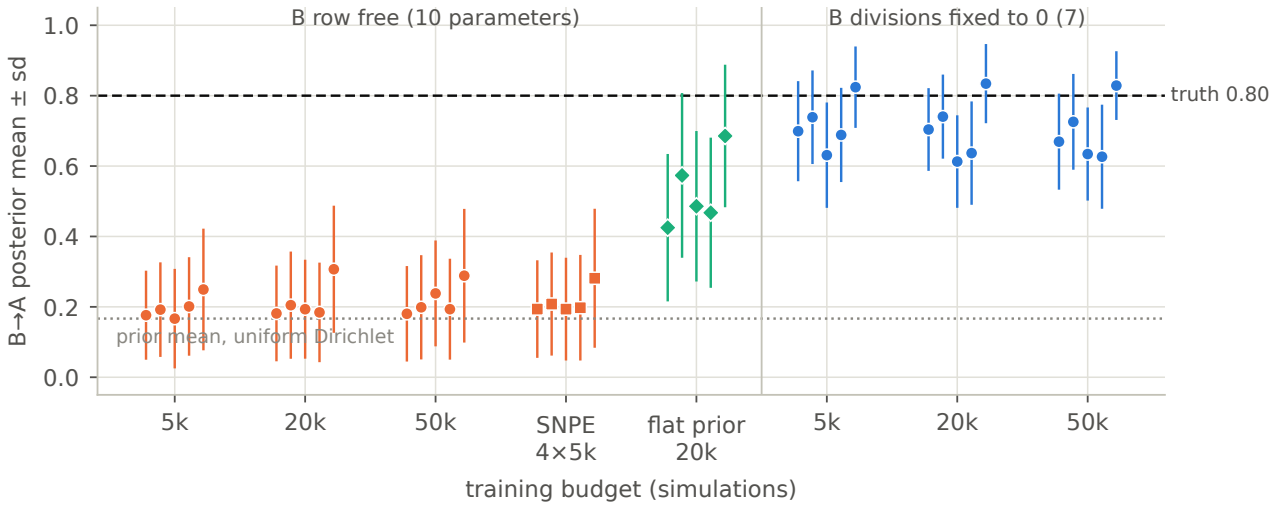


Figure 3: B→A posterior mean ± sd per seed. Orange: all B outcomes free (uniform Dirichlet; squares: SNPE). Green: flat prior on B→A. Blue: B divisions fixed to 0.

Law	Training	B→A mean	post. sd	contraction	covered	MAE (all)
`two_type`	5k / 20k / 50k	0.20 / 0.21 / 0.22	0.14–0.15	−0.03 / −0.13 / −0.18	0/15	0.14
`two_type`	SNPE 4×5k	0.21	0.16	−0.22	0/5	0.14
`two_type`, flat prior	20k	0.53	0.21	0.46	4/5	0.10
`reversible_ab`	5k / 20k / 50k	0.72 / 0.71 / 0.70	0.13–0.14	0.67 / 0.71 / 0.69	15/15	0.05

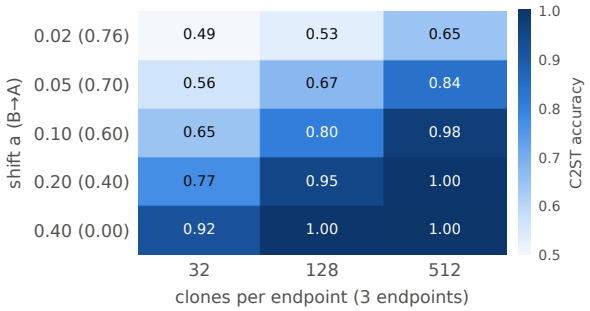


Figure 4: C2ST accuracy separating the truth from a mean-preserving alternative (B→AA = a, B→A = $0.8 - 2a$, B death = $0.1 + a$). 0.5 = indistinguishable.

- SBC coverage error 0.02–0.04 in every arm (looks calibrated).
- PPC ≤ 0.014 in every arm.
- Flat prior: corr(B→A, B→AA) = −0.67; SBC fails (0.069) for B's other coordinates (concentration 0.2), not for B→A.
- Truth-vs-posterior C2ST: inconclusive (0.62–0.95 in both laws).

Comment

- Under-training, dataset and calibration are ruled out: 10× more simulations, 5 datasets, SBC all unchanged.
- Main cause = prior tail: B→A ∼ Beta(1,5), P(> 0.8) = 0.03% (≈15 of 50k training simulations). SNPE cannot help: round 0 is already prior-like. *Revised by X5 (§23.1, §23.3) and decided at 4096 clones (§2.1)*: with B divisions free B→A is not recovered at any truth ≥ 0.5 (bulk included), nor with 1024 organoids, nor with 4096 per endpoint on three endpoints and a 20k network; the confounding below is the root cause (structural) and the tail only makes it visible.
- Data weakly confound switching with division: even with a flat prior the posterior is wide (sd 0.21) and anti-correlated with B→AA. They differ only in clone-size variability; in a direct test 128–512 clones/endpoint make moderate differences detectable, but the posterior does not separate them even at 4096 (§2.1).
- Consequence: fix what biology allows (B divisions = 0 ⇒ B→A ≈ 0.70, contraction 0.7), or measure it; a free B row cannot be rescued by data. All later experiments use `reversible_ab`.

2.1 E0 revisited at 4096 clones: full transition model, 5k vs 20k simulations (GW and BH)

Question

With all 10 transitions free (E0's setting), does B's row become identifiable once neither the data (4096 clones on each of three endpoints, 12 288 organoids) nor the network (20k simulations, epoch cap 500) are limiting? E0's C2ST suggested that larger designs separate switching from division (data limit); X5a and X5c pointed to structural non-identifiability, but only up to 1024 organoids and with a 5k network.

Setup

Simulator / design	GW, generations {4,6,10}; BH, days {4,6,10} = {96,144,240} h; 4096 clones per endpoint; perfect observation
Law (data = inference)	`two_type` (10 free probabilities; BH also τ_A, τ_B), truth $\theta^\star$ (B divisions 0), uniform Dirichlet
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k (epoch cap 200) vs 20k (`budget.simulations=20000 budget.max_epochs=500`)
Reference	B divisions fixed (`reversible_ab`), 20k, same truth, design and seeds (E4 budget check, §4.1)
Seeds / runs	5 / 20 (2 simulators × 2 budgets)
Folder	`results/e4/gw_xxl_two_type_5k/`, `gw_xxl_two_type_20k/`, `bh_xxl_two_type_5k/`, `bh_xxl_two_type_20k/` (commit `503ec72`; analysis in `results/e4/info.md`); table `report/tables/e0_large.csv`

Result

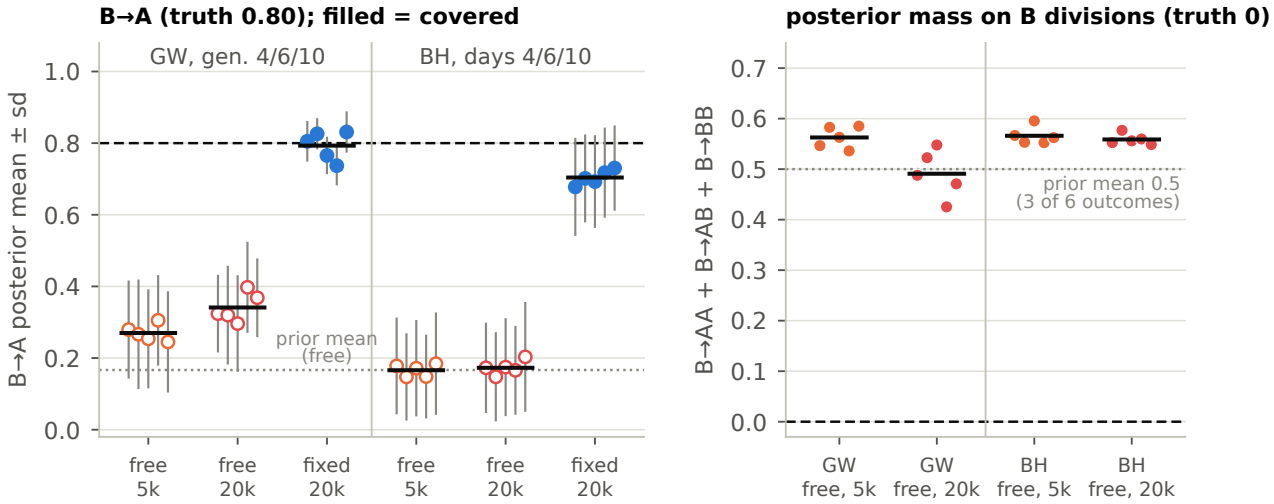


Figure 5: Full transition model at 4096 clones per endpoint, three endpoints. Left: B→A posterior mean ± sd per seed (filled = truth in the 90% interval; bars = mean over seeds); B divisions free (`two_type`, 5k and 20k simulations) vs fixed to 0 (`reversible_ab`, 20k). Right: posterior mass on B divisions (sum of the posterior means of B→AA, AB, BB) per seed; dotted = its prior mean 0.5. Dashed = truth.

	GW, B div. free		BH, B div. free		B div. fixed, 20k
	5k	20k	5k	20k	GW / BH
B→A (0.80): mean, covered	0.27, 0/5	0.34, 0/5	0.17, 0/5	0.17, 0/5	0.79, 5/5 / 0.70, 5/5
B→A contraction	0.04	0.24	0.15	0.12	0.95 / 0.71
Mass on B divisions (truth 0; prior 0.5)	0.56	0.49	0.57	0.56	0 (fixed)
of which B→AA	0.25	0.21	0.29	0.30	—
A persist (0.03)	0.17	0.16	0.12	0.13	0.05 / 0.07
A→BB (0.29)	0.20	0.21	0.23	0.23	0.28 / 0.32
A→AA (0.55)	0.45	0.47	0.34	0.36	0.55 / 0.49
MAE (free probabilities)	0.135	0.118	0.152	0.147	0.017 / 0.049
Coverage (run, 90%)	0.42	0.40	0.71	0.71	0.93 / 0.93
Support mass	0.32	0.53	0.75	0.67	0.78 / 0.51
PPC outside 95%	0.000	0.006	0.000	0.003	0.017 / 0.003
SBC coverage error	0.066	0.050	0.040	0.045	0.044 / 0.040
Epochs, mean	130	182	147	235	190 / 201

Means over 5 seeds. MAE over the free probabilities (10 with B divisions free, 7 fixed). B-division coverage is 0/5 by construction (truth on the boundary): read the mass.

Comment

- **The B-row question is decided: structural non-identifiability.** With B divisions free, B→A stays at 0.17–0.34 (truth 0.80, 0/20 runs covered, contraction ≤ 0.24) even with 4096 organoids per endpoint on three endpoints. Quadrupling the training budget changes it by ≤ 0.07 (GW) or not at all (BH), so it is neither a data nor a network limit.
- **The data do not say whether B divides**: the posterior mass on B divisions stays at 0.49–0.57, its prior mean (0.5), with B→AA $\approx$ 0.2–0.3 for a truth of 0. Yet the PPC is clean ($\leq 0.6\%$): endpoint counts of A and B are reproduced equally well by "B switches back" and "B divides, rarely switches". A clean fit is no evidence that the B row is right.
- **The confounding leaks into A's row in GW**: A persist 0.16 (truth 0.03, 0/5), A→BB 0.21 (0.29), run coverage 0.40. Leaving B divisions free therefore also biases A.
- **Fixing B divisions recovers B→A on the same design** (0.79 GW / 0.70 BH, 5/5 covered). Fixing them — or measuring them, e.g. by live imaging of KRT20$^+$ cells or lineage tracing — is required: it is the one modelling decision that the endpoint counts cannot make.
- Side note (BH): with B divisions free, A's lifetime is recovered (19.4–19.6 h, 5/5) while A→AA is not (0.34–0.36); B's lifetime is not (17.6–19.2 h, truth 30 h). The ridge shifts to involve B's row; not interpreted further.
- Caveat: one truth, one design per simulator, 5 seeds.

3 Design comparison — one vs three endpoints (GW)

Question

Which planned design identifies the model best, and is it the number of time points or the number of organoids that matters?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson, perfect observation
Law (free)	`two_type` (10) and `reversible_ab` (7)
Data vs inference	well specified, $\theta^\star$
Design	`single_128`: gen. 12 × 128; `three_128`: gen. 4, 8, 12 × 128; `single_384`: gen. 12 × 384; reference `three_32` (from E0)
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 20k
Seeds / runs	5 / 30 (+ 10 reference runs from E0)
Varied	design × law
Folder	`results/design_comparison/`

Result

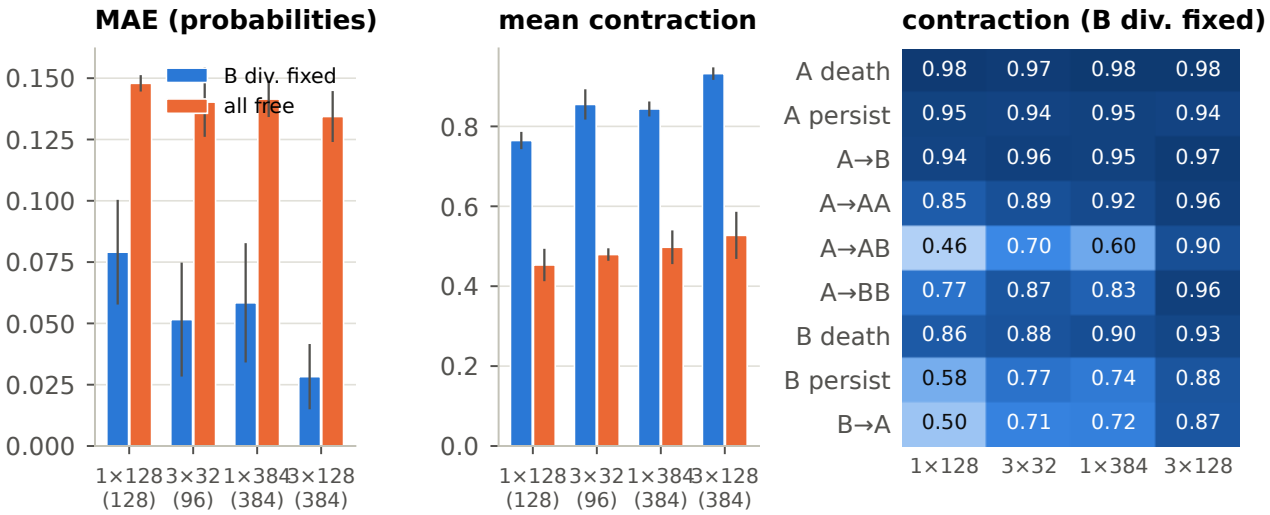


Figure 6: Left, centre: MAE and mean contraction per design (mean ± sd over 5 seeds); total organoids in brackets. Right: contraction per parameter, B divisions fixed.

Design (`reversible_ab`)	organoids	MAE	contraction	90% cov.	B→A	B→A contr.	PPC
1 × 128	128	0.079	0.77	0.87	0.61 ± 0.17	0.50	0.000
3 × 32	96	0.052	0.86	0.96	0.71 ± 0.13	0.71	0.008
1 × 384	384	0.058	0.84	0.93	0.67 ± 0.12	0.72	0.000
3 × 128	384	**0.028**	**0.93**	0.93	**0.78 ± 0.09**	**0.87**	0.031
`two_type`, any design	96–384	0.13–0.15	0.45–0.53	0.69–0.78	0.18–0.25	≤ -0.03	≤ 0.014

Comment

- At equal organoids, 3 endpoints halve the error of 1 (0.028 vs 0.058). Gains are in dynamics: A→AB contraction 0.90 vs 0.60, B→A 0.87 vs 0.72.
- 96 organoids over 3 endpoints ≈ 384 at one endpoint.
- With all transitions free no design recovers B's row (B→A contraction ≤ 0) — consistent with E0; not even 4096 per endpoint (§2.1).
- Calibration fine everywhere (SBC 0.02–0.03). Caveat: GW, one truth, generations not days.

4 E4 — Amount of data: organoids and endpoints (BH)

Question

How do contraction and error depend on organoids per endpoint (16–4096) and on the measured days? What is the minimum number to recover each parameter?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, Gamma lifetimes shape 8
Law (free)	`reversible_ab`: 7 probabilities + τ_A, τ_B (9)
Data vs inference	well specified, $\theta^\star$
Design	clones per endpoint $\in \{16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512\}$ and extensions $\{1024, 2048\}$, $\{4096\}$ × endpoints $\{240\}$, $\{144, 240\}$, $\{144, 240, 336\}$, $\{96, 144, 240\}$ h = days $\{10\}$, $\{6{,}10\}$, $\{6{,}10{,}14\}$, $\{4{,}6{,}10\}$
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k; budget check: 20k at 512 and 4096 clones (days 4/6/10) and at the real-like design, same datasets (§4.1)
Seeds / runs	5 / 180 = 120 (16–512) + 40 (1024, 2048) + 20 (4096); + 15 at 20k
Varied	clones × endpoint set; simulation budget (check only)
Folder	`results/e4/bh/` (16–512), `results/e4/bh_large/` (1024, 2048; commit `5cb6018`), `results/e4/bh_xxl/` (4096; `07fb7fe`), `results/e4/bh_xxl_20k/` (20k; `07fb7fe`, preset docs `503ec72`), `results/e4/bh_512_20k/`, `results/e4/bh_real_20k/` (20k; `503ec72`); pooled tables `results/e4/bh_all_summary_*.csv`

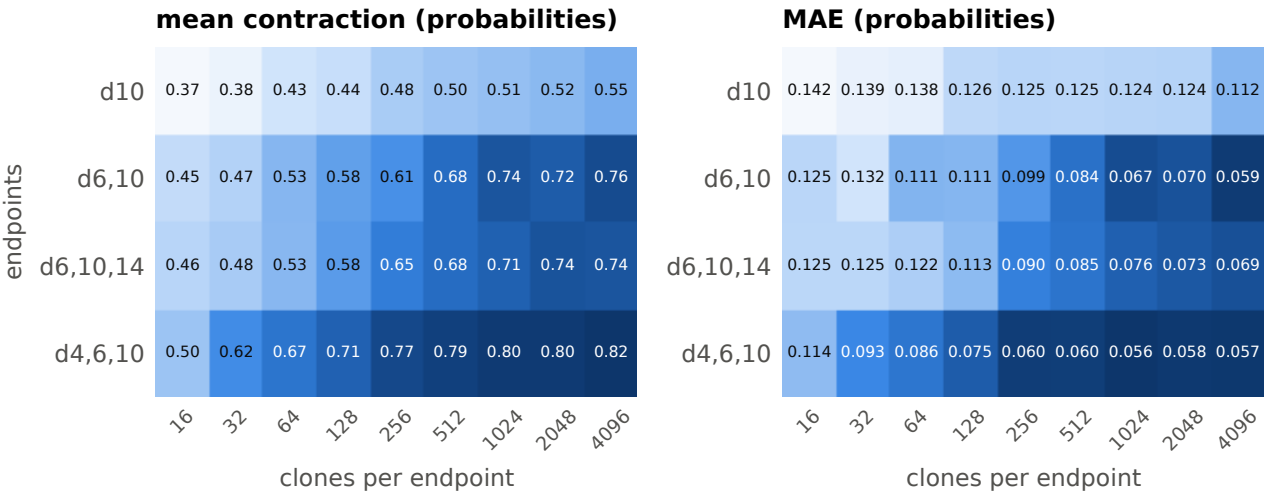


Figure 7: Mean contraction and MAE of the 7 outcome probabilities (mean over 5 seeds, NPE 5k); 1024–4096 from the extensions.

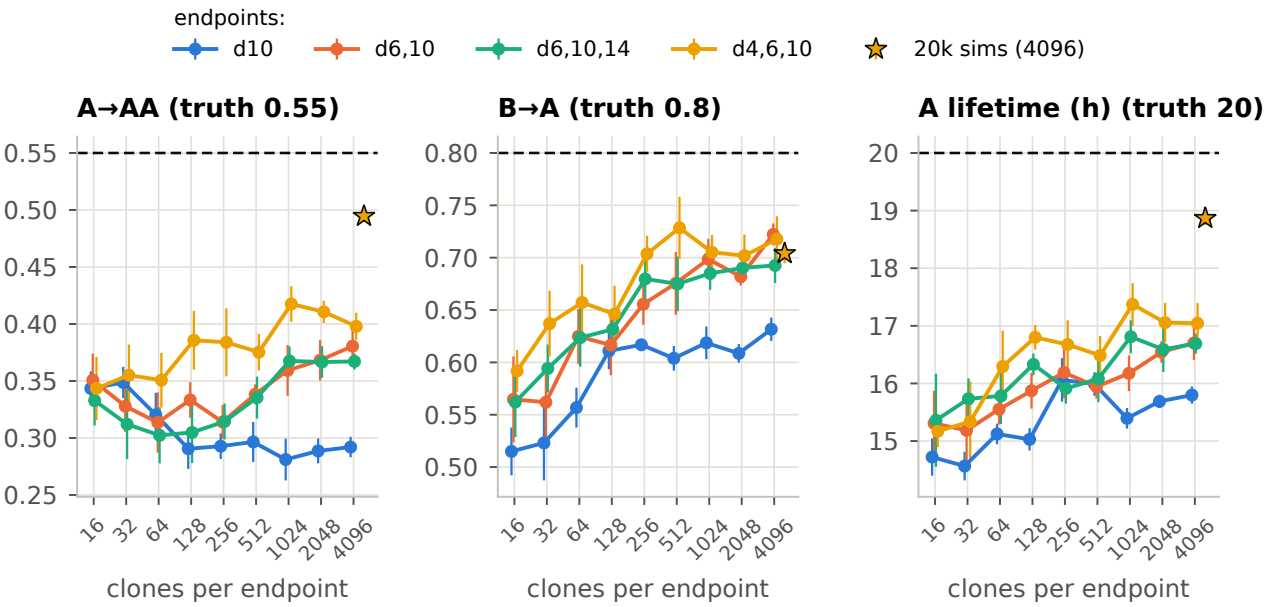


Figure 8: Posterior means (mean ± SE over seeds) vs organoids per endpoint, one line per endpoint set, NPE 5k; dashed = truth. Star: days 4/6/10 at 4096 with 20k simulations (§4.1).

Minimum organoids per endpoint for "recovered" (contraction > 0.5, $|\text{error}| < 0.05$, $\geq 4/5$ covered); — = not reached at 4096 (NPE 5k; the 1024–4096 extensions change one entry).

Parameter	day 10	days 6, 10	days 6, 10, 14	days 4, 6, 10
A death, A→B (small truths)	16	16	16	16
A→BB	—	512	256	**128**
B death	—	256	256	**128**
A→AB	—	4096[a]	—	**256**
A→AA, A persist, B persist, B→A	—	—	—	—
τ_A, τ_B (biased: τ_A 15–17 h, 0/5 covered)	—	—	—	—

[a] met only at the largest size (error 0.026, 5/5); not a stable threshold.

Extensions: 1024, 2048, 4096 clones per endpoint (5 seeds, NPE 5k; probabilities: MAE, contraction; lifetimes: mean relative error)

Endpoints (days)	MAE 1024 / 2048 / 4096	contraction 1024 / 2048 / 4096	rel. error τ_A, τ_B 1024 / 2048 / 4096	A→AA (0.55) 512 → 2048 → 4096	τ_A (20 h) 2048 / 4096
{10}	0.124 / 0.124 / 0.112	0.51 / 0.52 / 0.55	0.32 / 0.30 / 0.30	0.30 → 0.29 → 0.29	15.7 / 15.8
{6, 10}	0.067 / 0.070 / 0.059	0.74 / 0.72 / 0.76	0.29 / 0.27 / 0.24	0.34 → 0.37 → 0.38	16.5 / 16.7
{6, 10, 14}	0.076 / 0.073 / 0.069	0.71 / 0.74 / 0.74	0.25 / 0.27 / 0.27	0.34 → 0.37 → 0.37	16.6 / 16.7
{4, 6, 10}	**0.056 / 0.058 / 0.057**	**0.80 / 0.80 / 0.82**	0.24 / 0.27 / 0.27	0.38 → 0.41 → 0.40	17.1 / 17.0

A→AA and τ_A covered 0/5 at every size and design with NPE 5k.

Comment

- An early endpoint (day 4) helps most: days 4/6/10 are best on every metric at every size and the only design where A→AB is recovered from a moderate size (0.054 at 2048, 0.042 at 4096, truth 0.05; days 6/10 meet it only at 4096). Day 10 alone plateaus (contraction 0.37 → 0.50 → 0.52 → 0.55 from 16 to 512 to 2048 to 4096).
- With several endpoints and NPE 5k more organoids help up to ≈512–1024 (MAE 0.114 → 0.060 → 0.056 for days 4/6/10; 0.058 at 2048, 0.057 at 4096). B→A rises 0.59 → 0.73 and is covered at every size, but not recovered (0.61–0.72 at 1024–4096).
- **With NPE 5k the ridge does not yield to sample size.** At 4096 clones per endpoint (up to 12 288 organoids) A→AA is 0.29–0.40 (truth 0.55) and τ_A 15.8–17.0 h (truth 20), 0/5 covered in every design. The posterior creeps along the ridge (days 4/6/10: 0.34 → 0.41 from 16 to 2048, flat at 4096) with τ_A contraction 0.99: confidently on the wrong point.
- **At 4096 this is partly a training limit, at realistic sizes it is not** (§4.1): with 20k simulations on the same 4096-clone datasets A→AA moves 0.40 → 0.50 and τ_A 17.0 → 18.9 h (3/5 covered each); at 512 per endpoint only 0.38 → 0.44 (1/5), and at the real-like design not at all (0.32 → 0.33). The ridge yields gradually to data with a well-trained network; at realistic sizes lifetime information remains necessary (§6, X5b).
- Calibration at 1024–4096: SBC error rises mildly (0.028–0.039), PPC ≤ 1.4%, support mass 0.37–0.81.
- "Recovered" for A death / A→B is easy because the truths are small (|error| < 0.05 is loose there).
- Caveat: one truth, perfect assay, single A founders, 5k simulations (20k only for days 4/6/10 at 512 and 4096, and at the real-like design); GW half and comparison in §5.

4.1 Simulation budget check: 5k vs 20k simulations, from the real-like design to 4096 clones (BH and GW)

Question

Is the stuck BH ridge, and the large-design plateau, a limit of the data or of the 5k-simulation network — and does the answer depend on the size of the experiment?

Setup

Designs	BH: real-like (144/240 h × 165/101 clones; same 5 datasets as the BH ridge control and X5b vague), 512 and 4096 clones per endpoint on days {4,6,10} = {96,144,240} h (same datasets as the E4 runs); GW: 4096 clones on generations {4,6,10}
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k (from E4 / X5b) vs 20k (`budget.simulations=20000`); epoch cap 200 at 4096; 500 at real-like and 512 (`budget.max_epochs=500`; early stopping at 104–161 epochs, cap not binding)
Seeds / runs	5 paired seeds (same datasets) / 20 at 20k (5 per design)
Folder	`results/e4/bh_real_20k/`, `results/e4/bh_512_20k/` (commit `503ec72`); `results/e4/gw_xxl_20k/`, `results/e4/bh_xxl_20k/` (`07fb7fe`; preset docs `503ec72`); table `report/tables/e4_budget.csv`

Result

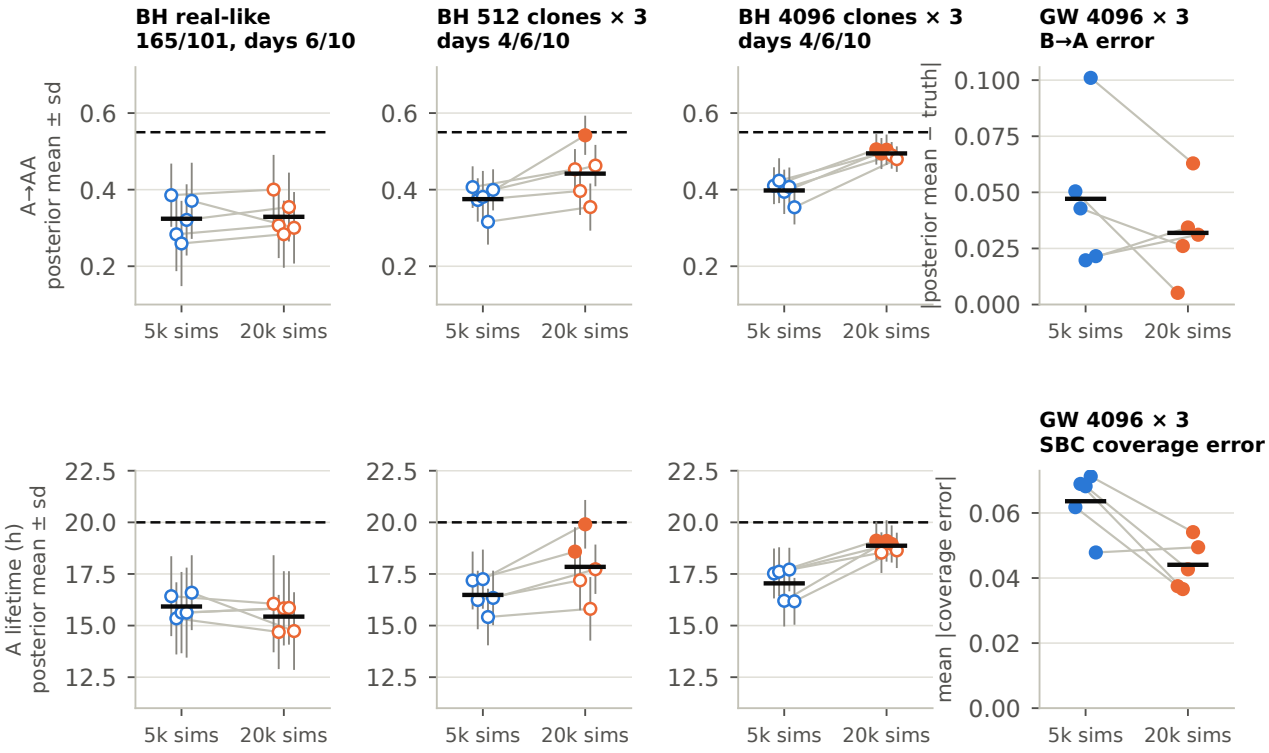


Figure 9: 5k vs 20k training simulations on the same 5 datasets (lines join seeds; bars = mean over seeds). Left three columns, BH: A→AA (top) and τ_A (bottom), posterior mean ± sd, at the real-like design, 512 and 4096 clones per endpoint (days 4/6/10); filled = truth in the 90% interval, open = not covered; dashed = truth. Right, GW at 4096 (generations 4/6/10): B→A absolute error and run SBC coverage error.

BH ridge across sizes (days 6/10 real-like; days 4/6/10 at 512 and 4096 per endpoint)

	real-like (165/101)		512 × 3		4096 × 3	
	5k	20k	5k	20k	5k	20k
A→AA (0.55): mean, covered	0.32, 0/5	0.33, 0/5	0.38, 0/5	0.44, 1/5	0.40, 0/5	**0.50, 3/5**
τ_A (20 h): mean, covered	15.9, 0/5	15.4, 0/5	16.5, 0/5	17.8, 2/5	17.0, 0/5	**18.9, 3/5**
τ_B (30 h): mean, covered	20.2, 4/5	17.8, 4/5	18.4, 3/5	21.2, 5/5	18.4, 2/5	22.5, 5/5
A→AB (0.05)	0.23	0.14	0.07	0.05	0.04	0.02
B→A (0.80)	0.63	0.70	0.73	0.69	0.72	0.70
MAE (probabilities)	0.109	**0.079**	0.060	0.058	0.057	**0.049**
Rel. error lifetimes	0.26	0.32	0.28	0.20	0.27	**0.15**
Coverage (run, 90%)	0.76	0.80	0.78	0.86	0.76	**0.93**
SBC coverage error	0.027	0.022	0.034	0.031	0.039	0.040
Epochs, mean (cap)	91 (200)	114 (500)	122 (200)	139 (500)	160 (200)	201 (200)

4096 clones per endpoint, both simulators

	GW {4,6,10}		BH {96,144,240} h	
	5k	20k	5k	20k
MAE (probabilities)	0.020	**0.017**	0.057	**0.049**
Mean contraction (all parameters)	0.964	0.977	0.842	0.893
Coverage (run, 90%)	0.93	0.93	0.76	**0.93**
SBC coverage error	0.064	**0.044**	0.039	0.040
Support mass	0.59	0.78	0.56	0.51
Epochs, mean (cap 200)	162	190	160	**201** (all 5)
B→A (0.80): mean, error, covered	0.78, 0.047, 4/5	0.79, 0.032, 5/5	0.72, 0.082, 5/5	0.70, 0.096, 5/5
A→AA (0.55): mean, covered	0.54, 5/5	0.55, 5/5	0.40, 0/5	**0.50, 3/5**

Comment

- **At the realistic design the ridge is a property of the data**: 20k simulations do not move A→AA (0.32 → 0.33) or τ_A (15.9 → 15.4 h), 0/5 covered in both. The gain (MAE 0.109 → 0.079) is in other parameters: A→AB 0.23 → 0.14, A→BB 0.19 → 0.26, B death 0.17 → 0.13.
- **With more data it resolves gradually, provided the network is trained enough**: at 512 per endpoint on three endpoints it starts to move (A→AA 0.38 → 0.44, 1/5; τ_A 16.5 → 17.8 h, 2/5; lifetime error 0.28 → 0.20), at 4096 it moves most of the way (0.40 → 0.50 and 17.0 → 18.9 h, 3/5 each; lifetime error 0.27 → 0.15). "The ridge does not yield to sample size" holds for NPE at 5k simulations, not for the data — but at realistic sizes independent lifetime information remains necessary (§6, §23.2).
- **The 5k network, not the data, sets the large-design plateau**: at 4096 four times the training simulations lower the error in both simulators and improve calibration (GW SBC 0.064 → 0.044) or coverage (BH 0.76 → 0.93). Those runs stopped at the 200-epoch cap (all 5 BH, GW 190 on average), so 20k is probably not the limit there; the realistic-size runs stopped early under a 500 cap.
- B→A in BH: no gain at 512 and 4096 (0.73 → 0.69, 0.72 → 0.70; still covered), a gain at the real-like design (0.63 → 0.70). BH support mass 0.56 → 0.51 at 4096.
- Caveat: one truth, 5 seeds; BH 512/4096 only on days 4/6/10, GW only at 4096.

5 E4 — Amount of data (GW) and comparison with BH

Question

Same as §4 for Galton–Watson: minimum organoids per endpoint and best endpoint set when there is no lifetime ridge.

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson (endpoints in *generations*; day-mapping nominal)
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (7 probabilities)
Data vs inference	well specified, $\theta^\star$
Design	clones per endpoint $\in \{16, 32, \ldots, 512\}$ and extensions $\{1024, 2048\}$, $\{4096\}$ × generations {10}, {6,10}, {6,10,14}, {4,6,10}
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k; budget check: 20k at 4096 clones, {4,6,10}, same 5 datasets (§4.1)
Seeds / runs	5 / 180 = 120 (16–512) + 40 (1024, 2048) + 20 (4096); + 5 at 20k; all with 2 000 posterior samples, 200 SBC cases
Folder	`results/e4/gw/` (16–512), `results/e4/gw_large/` (1024, 2048; commit `5cb6018`), `results/e4/gw_xxl/` (4096; `07fb7fe`), `results/e4/gw_xxl_20k/` (20k; `07fb7fe`, preset docs `503ec72`); pooled tables `results/e4/gw_all_summary_*.csv`

Result

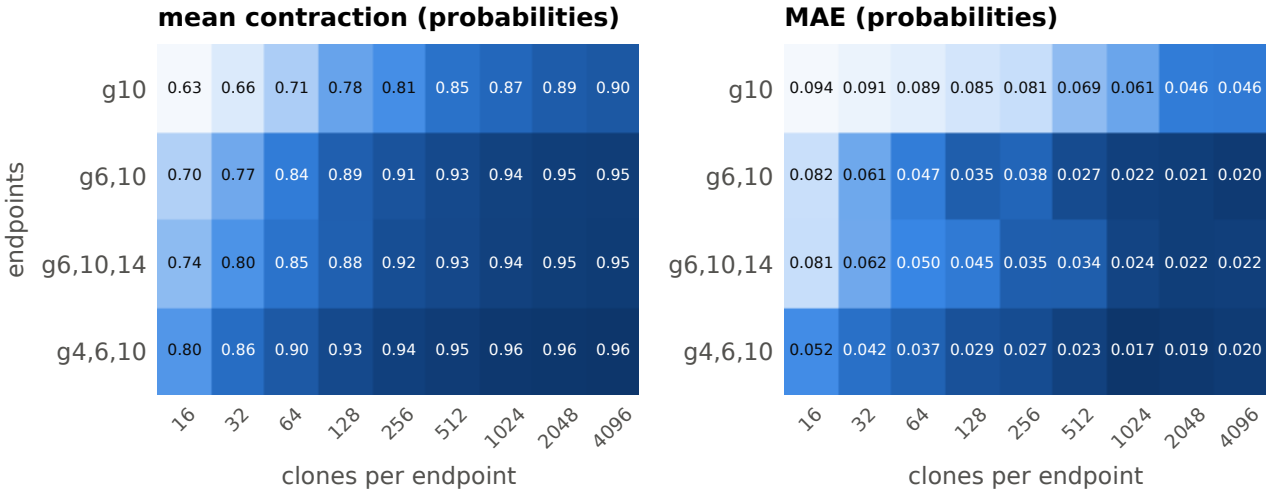


Figure 10: E4 GW: mean contraction and MAE of the outcome probabilities (mean over 5 seeds); endpoints in generations; NPE 5k; 1024–4096 from the extensions.

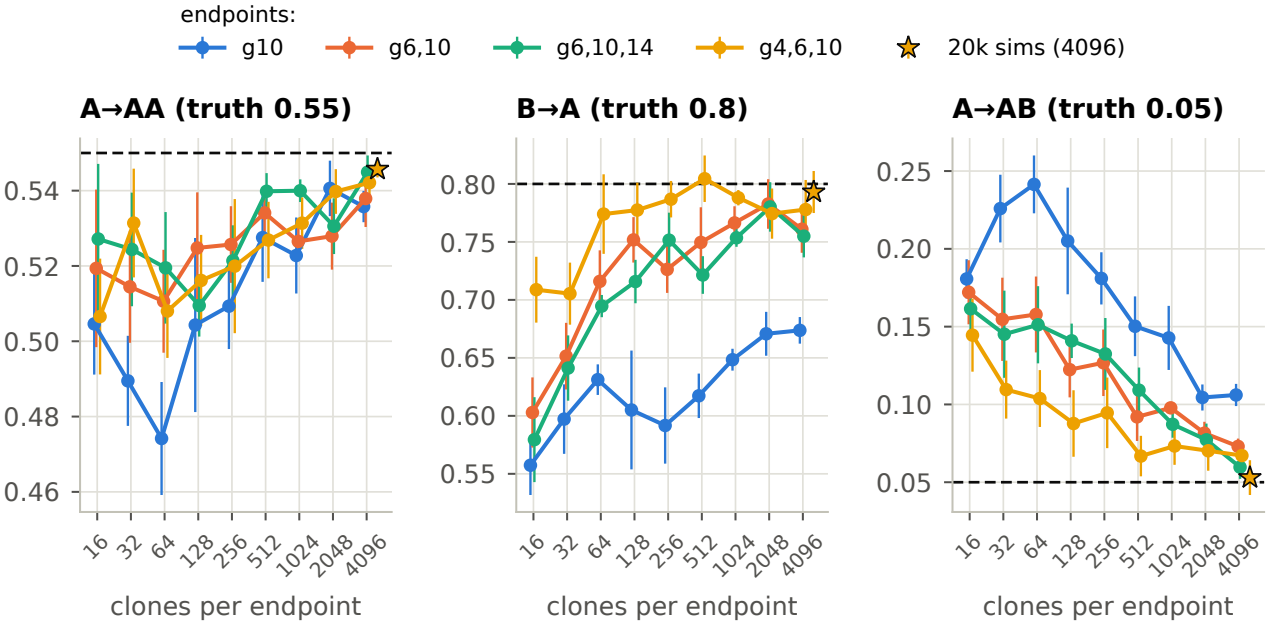


Figure 11: E4 GW: posterior means (mean ± SE over seeds) vs organoids per endpoint, NPE 5k; dashed = truth. Star: {4,6,10} at 4096 with 20k simulations (§4.1).

Minimum organoids per endpoint for "recovered" (as in §4; must hold at every larger size up to 4096; — = not reached; NPE 5k)

	GW, generations				**BH**, days
Parameter	{10}	{6, 10}	{6, 10, 14}	{4, 6, 10}	{4, 6, 10}
A death, A persist, A→B	16	16	16	16	16 (A persist: —)
B death	32	16	16	16	128
A→AA	256	16	16	2048[a]	—
A→BB	—	256	2048	**32**	128
B persist	—	512	—[c]	**64**	—
B→A	—	1024	—[c]	**128**	—
A→AB	—	512	2048	4096[b]	256

[a] error ≤ 0.04 at every size, but coverage 2–3/5 at 256–1024 (narrow posteriors, sd ≈ 0.02).
[b] also met at 128 and 512 (1024/2048: error 0.03, 3/5); at 4096 error 0.017, 4/5.
[c] 1024 up to 2048; at 4096 error 0.051 (B persist) and 0.053 (B→A), just above the 0.05 threshold.

Extensions: 1024, 2048, 4096 clones per endpoint (5 seeds, NPE 5k; MAE of probabilities / mean contraction / SBC coverage error)

Generations	512	1024	2048	4096
{10}	0.069 / 0.85 / 0.034	0.061 / 0.87 / 0.039	0.046 / 0.89 / 0.038	0.046 / 0.90 / 0.043
{6, 10}	0.027 / 0.93 / 0.037	0.022 / 0.94 / 0.044	0.021 / 0.95 / 0.045	0.020 / 0.95 / 0.050
{6, 10, 14}	0.034 / 0.93 / 0.041	0.024 / 0.94 / 0.047	0.022 / 0.95 / 0.055	0.022 / 0.95 / 0.058
{4, 6, 10}	**0.023** / **0.95** / 0.044	**0.017** / **0.96** / 0.052	**0.019** / **0.96** / 0.059	**0.020** / **0.96** / 0.064

	BH (days)	**GW** (generations)
Contraction, {4,6,10}, 16/512/2048/4096	0.50 / 0.79 / 0.80 / 0.82	0.80 / 0.95 / 0.96 / 0.96
MAE, {4,6,10}, same sizes	0.114 / 0.060 / 0.058 / 0.057	0.052 / 0.023 / 0.019 / 0.020
One late endpoint, contraction	0.37 / 0.50 / 0.52 / 0.55	0.63 / 0.85 / 0.89 / 0.90 (A→AB/BB conf.)
A→AA (0.55), NPE 5k	0.28–0.42, 0–2/5 covered	0.47–0.55 at every design
A→AA, 4096, {4,6,10}, 5k / 20k	0.40 (0/5) / 0.50 (3/5)	0.54 / 0.55 (5/5)
B→A (0.80), {4,6,10}, 128/512/2048/4096	0.65 / 0.73 / 0.70 / 0.72	0.78 / 0.80 / 0.77 / 0.78
SBC error, 16–512 / 1024–4096	0.025–0.034 / 0.029–0.039	0.024–0.044 / 0.038–0.064
Support mass / PPC (per run)	0.37–0.92 / ≤ 0.042	0.07–0.89 / ≤ 0.10 (groups ≤ 0.021)

Comment

- **Same design ranking as BH**: an early endpoint is worth most ({4,6,10} best at every size); a late extra endpoint ({6,10,14}) adds little over {6,10}; one endpoint plateaus and cannot separate A→AB from A→BB (0.15–0.24 vs 0.05; 0.15–0.20 vs 0.29 up to 512; still 0.11 and 0.24 at 4096). The ranking is a property of the endpoint information, not of the time model.
- **Without lifetimes everything is recoverable**: with {4,6,10} and ≈128 organoids per endpoint all probabilities except A→AB (met at 128 and 512, not stably) meet the criterion; A→AA is right from 16 organoids. The GW numbers are the attainable target *if* division times are known (BH with lifetimes fixed: MAE 0.059, §6).
- **Plateau at ≈1024 per endpoint with NPE 5k** (extensions): multi-endpoint designs reach MAE ≈ 0.02 and contraction ≈ 0.95 and gain nothing from 2048 or 4096; with two or three endpoints every parameter meets the criterion at 1024–2048 except A→AB with {4,6,10} (intermittent). B→A contraction 0.87–0.93.
- **The plateau is the network's**: with 20k simulations at 4096 ({4,6,10}, same datasets) MAE 0.020 → 0.017, B→A error 0.047 → 0.032 (5/5 covered), SBC 0.064 → 0.044, support 0.59 → 0.78; training used 190 of 200 epochs on average (§4.1).
- **A single endpoint never catches up**: it keeps improving, but at 4096 organoids (MAE 0.046) it is still worse than three endpoints at 32 (0.042); B→A, A→AB, A→BB and B persist never meet the criterion.
- **SBC error grows with size** (0.03 → 0.05–0.06 at 1024–4096) while coverage of the truth stays 0.87–0.98: at these sizes the amortised NPE (5k simulations) limits accuracy, as the 20k check confirms.
- Checks: single well-specified GW runs reach PPC 0.10 and support mass 0.07 ({4,6,10}, seed 4): borderline single values are not evidence of misspecification.
- Caveat: generations are not days; one truth, perfect assay, single A founders, 5k simulations (20k only for {4,6,10} at 4096). The full transition model (`law=two_type`) at 4096 clones is in §2.1: B's row stays unidentifiable.

6 BH ridge — lifetime vs self-renewal

Question

Is the BH baseline bias (A→AA ≈ 0.32, $\tau_A \approx 16$ h) a ridge on which endpoint counts fix only a combination of lifetime and self-renewal, with the prior picking the point?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	control: `reversible_ab` (9); lifetimes fixed: 7; flat prior: 9
Data vs inference	data always $\theta^\star$; only the inference model changes
Design	real-like: 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Arms	control (from E3b, shape 8); τ_A=20, τ_B=30 h fixed; flat prior on A→AA (concentration 1 vs 0.2 for A's other outcomes: A→AA ∼ Beta(1,1))
Seeds / runs	5 / 10 (+5 control)
Folder	`results/bh_ridge/` (control: `results/e3b/*lifetime_shape=8*`)

Result

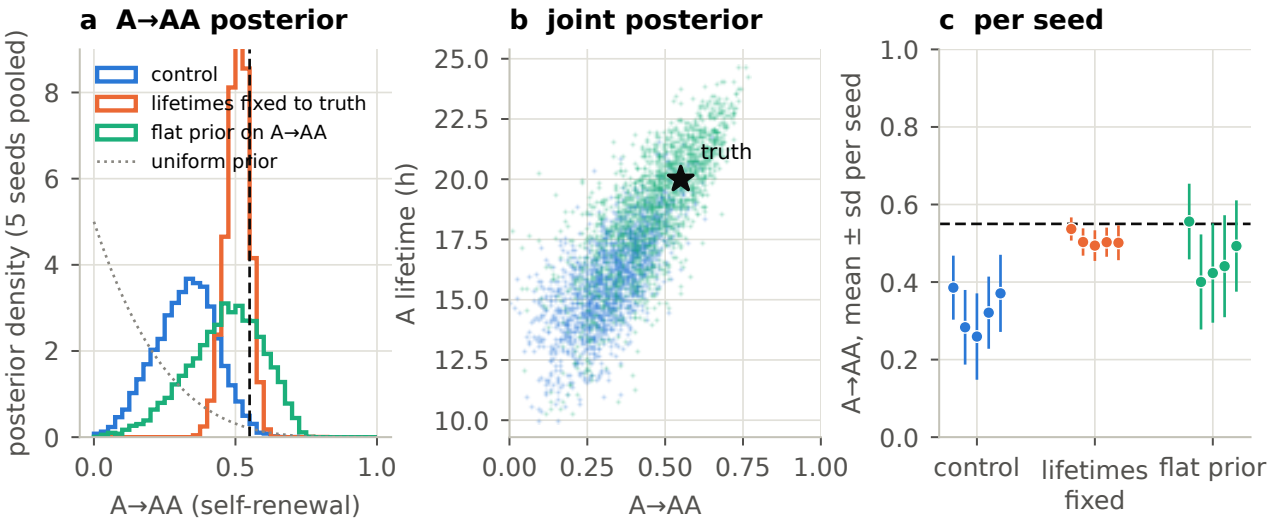


Figure 12: (a) A→AA posterior pooled over 5 seeds; dotted: uniform-Dirichlet prior Beta(1,5). (b) Joint posterior of A→AA and τ_A (blue: control; green: flat prior); star = truth. (c) Per-seed means ± sd; dashed = truth.

	Control	Lifetimes fixed	Flat prior
A→AA (0.55)	0.32 ± 0.10, 0/5, contr. 0.52	**0.51 ± 0.04, 5/5, 0.93**	0.46 ± 0.12, 5/5, 0.83
A→AB (0.05)	0.23, 3/5	0.17, 2/5	0.20, 5/5, contr. 0.00
B→A (0.80)	0.63, 5/5	0.68, 5/5	0.46, 3/5
τ_A (20 h)	15.9 ± 1.9, 0/5	fixed	18.9 ± 2.2, 5/5
MAE (probabilities)	0.109	**0.059**	0.117
SBC error / PPC / support	0.025 / 0.008 / n/r	0.031 / 0.025 / 0.65	0.079 / 0.000 / 0.51

Comment

- Ridge confirmed: posterior corr(A→AA, τ_A) ≈ +0.7 (E3c). Removing the lifetime degree of freedom recovers self-renewal and halves the error.
- The prior chose the point: only 1.8% of uniform-Dirichlet mass lies above 0.55. A flat prior re-centres (5/5 covered) but stays wide, degrades B→A and calibration: not a fix.
- GW has no lifetimes and no ridge: the GW control at the same design gives A→AA 0.52 (§7), and 0.47–0.55 at every E4 design (§5).
- Sample size alone, with the standard 5k-simulation NPE, does not leave the ridge: A→AA stays 0.29–0.41 and τ_A 15.7–17.1 h (0/5) up to 4096 clones per endpoint in every E4 design. With 20k simulations it moves gradually with size: not at the real-like design (A→AA 0.32 → 0.33, τ_A 15.9 → 15.4 h, 0/5), a little at 512 per endpoint on days 4/6/10 (0.44, τ_A 17.8 h, 2/5), most of the way at 4096 (0.50, 18.9 h, 3/5; §4.1). The ridge is a property of the data at realistic sizes, not a training artefact.
- Consequence: at realistic sizes measure A's division time (live imaging) or use it as an informative prior; otherwise report BH results with prior sensitivity. Train BH fits on ≥ 20k simulations anyway: it does not remove the ridge at the real-like design but lowers the error of the other probabilities (MAE 0.109 → 0.079). X5 tested both: a right ±25% lifetime prior gives A→AA 0.46, MAE 0.068 (§23.2); averaged over prior-drawn truths A→AA is learned well (contraction 0.82, §23.4), so the ridge bites at tail truths such as $\theta^\star$.

7 E1a — Wrong founder type (organoid death as initial conditions; BH and GW)

Question

If some organoids are founded by B cells (fraction $1 - f$) but the model assumes A founders, are the dynamics (A, B rows) biased? Does inferring the founder mix help?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris (shape 8) and Galton–Watson
Law (free)	`reversible_ab`: BH 9, GW 7; inferred arm adds `founder.A` (Dirichlet(1,1))
Data model	founder A with prob. $f \in \{1, 0.9, 0.7, 0.5\}$, else B; dynamics $\theta^\star$
Inference model	fixed arm: founder = A (wrong for $f < 1$); inferred arm: founder share free
Design	real-like: BH 144/240 h, GW generations 6/10; 165/101 organoids
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 80 (4 f × 2 arms × 2 simulators)
Control	$f = 1$ of the same arm (same trained network per seed: paired shifts)
Folder	`results/e1a/founder_type/{fixed,inferred}_{bh,gw}`

Result

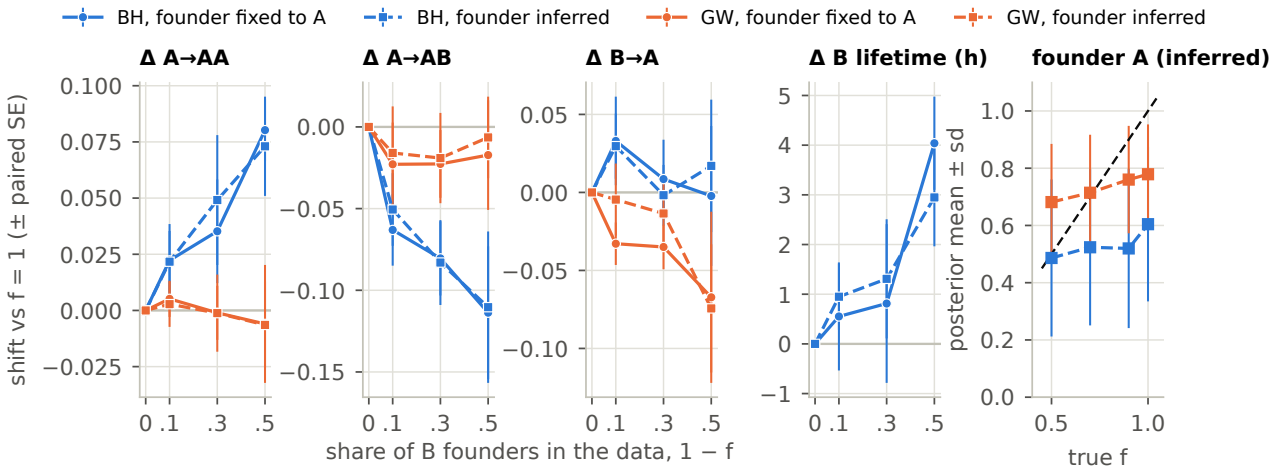


Figure 13: Shift of posterior means vs the $f = 1$ control (± paired SE over 5 seeds); blue BH, orange GW; solid = founder fixed to A, dashed = founder inferred. Right: inferred founder A share vs truth.

	BH, founder fixed				**GW**, founder fixed			
	control	$f = 0.9$	0.7	0.5	control	0.9	0.7	0.5
A→AA (0.55)	0.32 [0/5]	+0.02	+0.04	+0.08 ± .01	0.52 [3/5]	+0.01	−0.00	−0.01
A→AB (0.05)	0.23 [3/5]	−0.06	−0.08	−0.11± .04	0.12 [3/5]	−0.02	−0.02	−0.02
A→B (0.05)	0.07	+0.01	+0.01	+0.02 ± .006	0.035	+0.00	+0.01	+0.02 ± .006
B death (0.10)	0.17	−0.02	+0.00	−0.02	0.10	+0.01	+0.02	+0.03 ± .014
B→A (0.80)	0.63 [5/5]	+0.03	+0.01	−0.00	0.76 [5/5]	−0.03	−0.04	−0.07± .06
τ_B (30 h)	20.2	+0.6	+0.8	+4.0 ± 0.9			—	
MAE (probabilities)	.109	.090	.095	.089	.033	.033	.036	.047
PPC	.008	.008	0	0	.004	.008	.017	.017
support mass	n/r	n/r	n/r	n/r	0.67	0.69	0.69	0.72

Founder inferred: `founder.A` posterior mean (contraction) for $f = 1$ / 0.9 / 0.7 / 0.5:
BH 0.60 / 0.52 / 0.52 / 0.49 (0.06–0.12) GW 0.78 / 0.76 / 0.71 / 0.68 (0.49–0.62); GW support mass 0.39–0.59

Comment

- **Small shifts, PPC blind** in both simulators. BH: A→AB −0.11, A→AA +0.08 (towards the truth, by accident of the control's bias), τ_B +4 h at $f = 0.5$; all < 1 posterior sd. GW: shifts ≤ 0.07 (B→A, not resolved: ±0.06); A→B +0.02 and B death +0.03 resolved but ≈0.5 sd.
- **GW well-specified baseline is good**: MAE 0.033, contraction 0.89, A→AA 0.52 — the BH bias is specific to BH (ridge).
- **Founder mix**: not identifiable in BH (stays at prior 0.5); partly in GW (monotone but compressed: 0.68 at $f = 0.5$, 0.78 at $f = 1$). Inferring it removes none of the shifts in either simulator and costs τ_B (−3.9 h, BH).
- Plausible reason: B founders switch to A quickly (B→A = 0.8), so B- and A-founded clones look alike by day 6.

- Consequence: keep single-A founders unless measured at seeding; if measured, fix to the measured value. $f < 0.5$ not tested.

8 E1a — Wrong number of founder cells (BH)

Question

If some organoids start from 2–3 A cells (P(1 cell) = p_1) but the model assumes single-cell seeding, are the dynamics biased? Can the founder size be inferred?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (9); inferred arm adds `founder_size` (sizes 1–3, Dirichlet(8,1,1))
Data model	founder size $\{1,2,3\}$ with $p_1 \in \{1, 0.85, 0.6\}$ ($\{.85, .12, .03\}$, $\{.6, .3, .1\}$), all A
Inference model	sizes [1] (wrong for $p_1 < 1$) or [1,2,3] inferred
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 30
Folder	`results/e1a/founder_number_bh/` (GW: §9)

Result

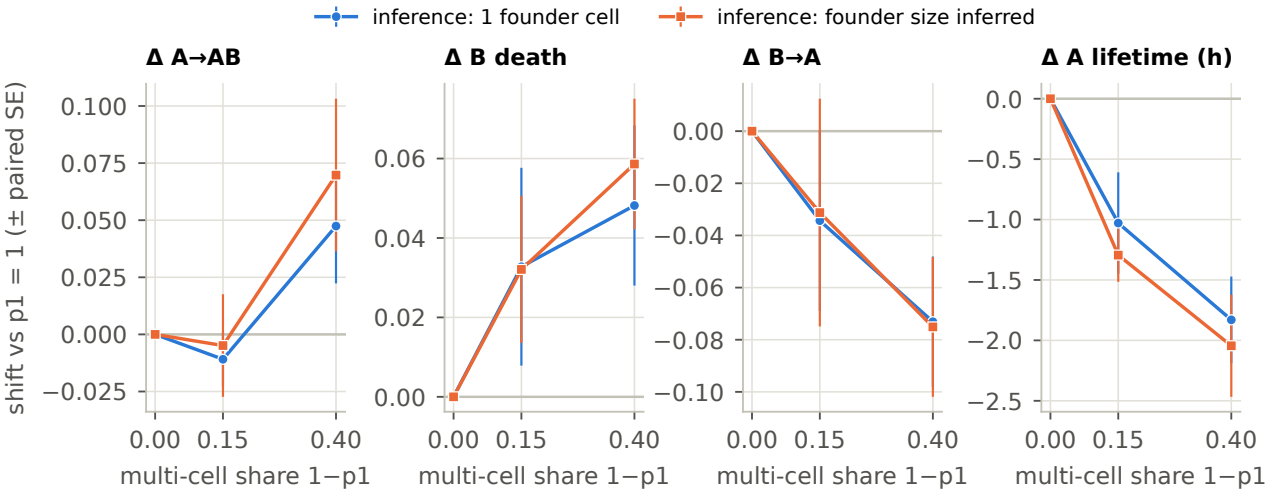


Figure 14: Shift vs the $p_1 = 1$ control of the same arm (± paired SE).

Arm, p_1	A→AB (.05)	B death (.10)	B→A (.80)	τ_A (20 h)	`founder_size.1`
[1], control	0.23	0.17	0.63 [5/5]	15.9	fixed
[1], 0.85 / 0.6	−0.01 / +0.05	+0.03 / +0.05 ± .02	−0.03 / −0.07 ± .03	−1.0 / −1.8 ± 0.4	fixed
[1,2,3], 0.85 / 0.6	−0.00 / +0.07	+0.03 / +0.06	−0.03 / −0.08	−1.3 / −2.0	0.81 / 0.78 (contr. ≤ 0.11)

Comment

- 40% multi-cell clones shift mostly lifetimes and B's row; coverage unchanged; PPC ≤ 0.008 (silent).
- Founder size stays at its prior (0.78–0.83); inferring it does not remove the shifts.
- Observed fraction rises with multi-cell seeding (0.95 → 0.97–0.98): fewer clones go extinct.
- Consequence: tolerable at $p_1 \geq 0.6$; do not infer founder size; measure it at seeding if needed. No support mass recorded (pre-`43e9e44` code).

9 E1a — Wrong number of founder cells (GW)

Question

As §8 for Galton–Watson: are the dynamics biased by multi-cell founders, can the founder size be inferred, and does the answer depend on the time model?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (7); inferred arm adds `founder_size` (sizes 1–3, Dirichlet(8,1,1))
Data model	founder size $\{1,2,3\}$, $p_1 \in \{1, 0.85, 0.6\}$, all A
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k (one network per arm and seed: paired shifts)
Seeds / runs	5 / 30
Folder	`results/e1a/founder_number_gw/`

Result

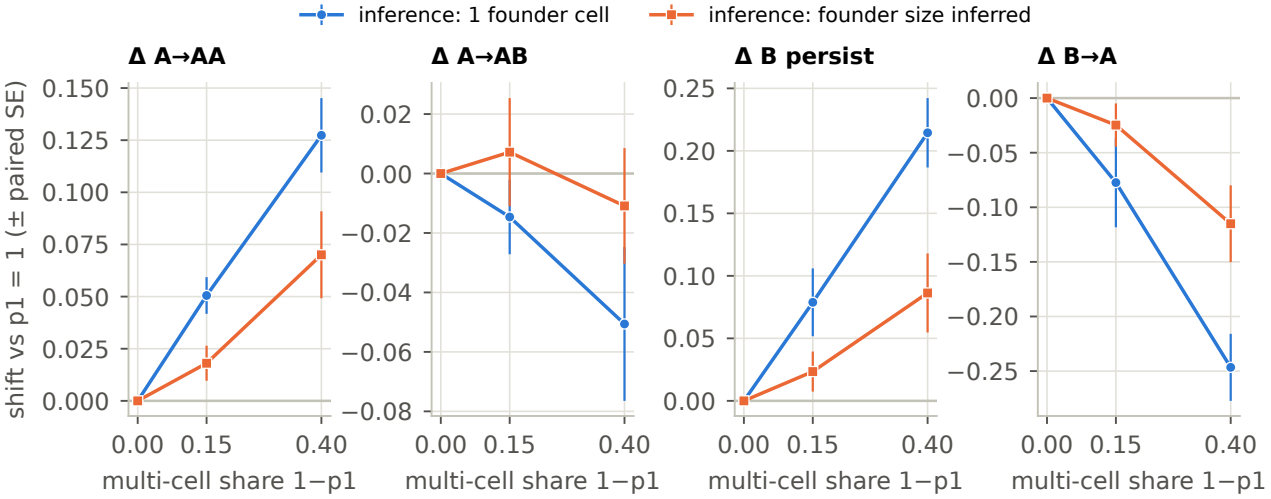


Figure 15: E1a founder number, GW: shift vs the $p_1 = 1$ control of the same arm (± paired SE).

Arm, p_1	A→AA (.55)	B persist (.10)	B→A (.80)	`founder_size.1`	PPC	support (min)
[1], control	0.52 [3/5]	0.13	0.76 [5/5]	fixed	0.004	0.67 (0.44)
[1], 0.85	+0.05 ± .01	+0.08 ± .03	−0.08 [4/5]	fixed	0.042	0.56 (0.21)
[1], 0.6	**+0.13 ± .02** [0/5]	**+0.21 ± .03** [0/5]	**−0.25 ± .03** [0/5]	fixed	**0.117**	**0.16** (0.015)
[1,2,3], control	0.46 [3/5]	0.09	0.83 [5/5]	0.85	0.000	0.55 (0.52)
[1,2,3], 0.85 / 0.6	+0.02 / +0.07 ± .02	+0.02 / +0.09	−0.02 / −0.12 ± .04 [5/5]	0.80 / 0.71	≤ 0.004	0.53 / 0.56

Comment

- **A large, partly detectable error in GW**: 40% multi-cell clones ignored inflate self-renewal (+0.13) and lower B→A (−0.25), all 0/5 covered; the fit is flagged (PPC 0.12, support 0.16). At $p_1 = 0.85$ the shifts are a third of that and the checks borderline.
- **Contrast with BH** (§8): there the same error moved B→A by only −0.07 and was silent — the lifetimes absorb part of the extra growth. A free time scale hides the error.
- **Inferring the founder size helps in GW**: misfit removed (PPC ≤ 0.004), shifts halved and covered, `founder_size.1` tracks p_1 (0.85 / 0.80 / 0.71, contraction ≈ 0.2). Cost on single-cell data: A→AA −0.06 ± 0.01, mean contraction 0.89 → 0.73.
- Consequence: record at seeding whether wells contain multi-cell seeds; if $\gtrsim$15% of organoids start from several cells, fix the measured distribution or infer it. $p_1 < 0.6$ not tested.

10 E1b — Death rates and the observed-organoid fraction (BH and GW)

Question

How strongly do A death and B death change the fraction of seeded organoids still detected at the endpoints? Is it an informative extra datum?

Setup

Simulator	BH (simulated, rejection loop) and GW (exact $1 - P$(no captured cell))
Law	`reversible_ab`; A death $\in \{0, .03, .1, .2, .3\}$ × B death $\in \{0, .1, .3, .5\}$, other entries of each row rescaled in proportion
Data vs inference	no inference used (token budget: 256 simulations, 5 epochs; posteriors meaningless)
Design	real-like: BH 144/240 h, GW generations 6/10; 165/101 recovered organoids
Seeds / runs	1 dataset per cell / 40 (20 BH + 20 GW)
Folder	`results/e1b/bh`, `results/e1b/gw`

Result

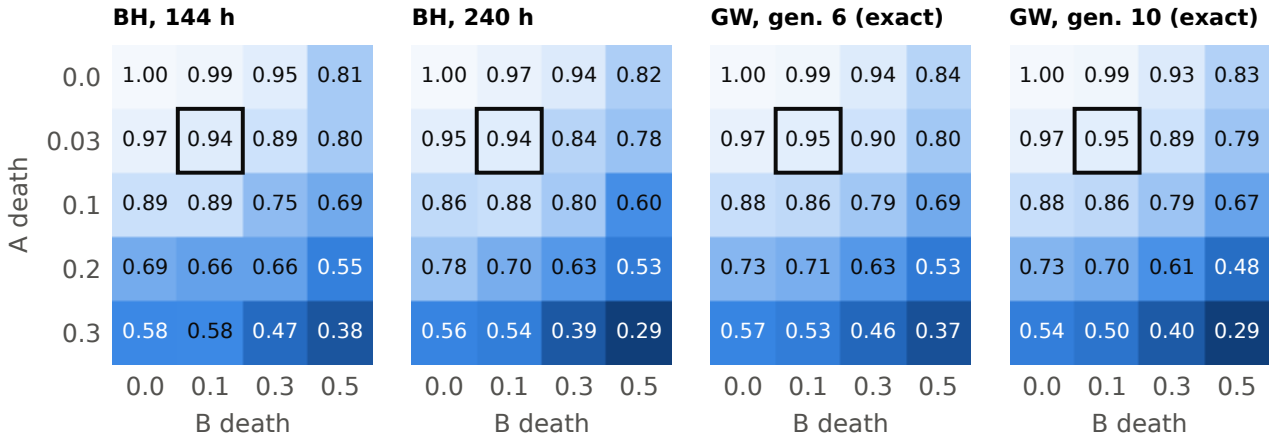


Figure 16: Observed-organoid fraction (detected/seeded) per (A death, B death); box = reference truth. BH: binomial SE ≈ 0.02–0.03 (100–530 seeded clones); GW exact.

(A death, B death)	BH 144 h	BH 240 h	GW gen. 6	GW gen. 10
(0, 0)	1.00	1.00	1.000	1.000
(0.03, 0.1) reference	**0.94**	**0.94**	**0.953**	**0.952**
(0.3, 0)	0.58	0.56	0.565	0.543
(0, 0.5)	0.81	0.82	0.840	0.832
(0.1, 0.3)	0.75	0.80	0.793	0.785
(0.3, 0.5)	0.38	0.29	0.366	0.290

Comment

- A death dominates (0 → 0.3: 1.00 → 0.54–0.58); B death 0 → 0.5 only to ≈ 0.82.
- Losses happen early (day 6 ≈ day 10), except high B death with A death ≥ 0.1.
- Different (A, B) death pairs give the same fraction — confirmed by the exact GW values ((0, 0.5) and (0.1, 0.3): 0.84 vs 0.79; (0.03, 0.5): 0.80): one constraint on a ridge, not two measurements.
- GW exact and BH simulated agree on average to 0.02 (max 0.07, both signs; within ≈ 2 binomial SE of BH) at the same days/generations.
- Consequence: record the number of seeded organoids per well (Q5). A measured fraction well below 0.9 would indicate A death $\gtrsim 0.1$. Using it as data (`observation=all_clones`) is tested in the follow-up (§10.1).
- Caveat: death also lowers the growth rate here (rows rescaled).

10.1 E1b follow-up — all seeded organoids as data, and survivor summaries (BH and GW)

Question

E1b showed that death rates change the fraction of seeded organoids still detected. If every seeded organoid is recorded (extinct ones as (0, 0) rows, `observation=all_clones`), are death rates — and the other outcomes — recovered better than from detected organoids only? Does it help to compute the summaries on surviving organoids and add the extinct fraction (`summary=survivor_moments`)?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris (shape 8) and Galton–Watson
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (BH 9, GW 7)
Data model	A death $\in \{0.03, 0.1, 0.3\}$ (other A outcomes rescaled as in E1b), B row $\theta^\star$
Arms	*detected*: `observation=perfect` (165/101 detected organoids); *all clones*: `observation=all_clones` (165/101 *seeded* organoids, `moments`); *all clones, survivor*: the same data with `summary=survivor_moments`. Data and inference share the observation model within each arm
Design	real-like: BH 144/240 h, GW generations 6/10
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 90 (3 arms × 3 A death × 2 simulators)
Folder	`results/e1b_all/{detected,all_clones,all_clones_survivor}`

Result

	A death (truth)	MAE all / surv. / det.	90% coverage all / surv. / det.	A death mean (sd) all / surv. / det.	B death contraction all / surv. / det.
GW	0.03	.063 / .057 / **.032**	.89 / .87 / .91	.024 (.013) / .028 (.018) / .029 (.021)	.91 / .87 / .86
GW	0.10	.081 / .068 / **.056**	.84 / .87 / .89	.058 (.027) / .059 (.028) / .048 (.031)	.76 / .72 / .73
GW	0.30	.134 / .119 / **.115**	.60 / .73 / .62	.167 (.069) / .179 (.066) / .141 (.064)	.27 / .30 / .30
BH	0.03	.109 / **.107** / .116	.87 / .80 / .82	.022 (.015) / .034 (.023) / .058 (.045)	.87 / .80 / .63
BH	0.10	.133 / .113 / **.110**	.82 / .87 / .84	.053 (.029) / .057 (.033) / .080 (.057)	.73 / .70 / .56
BH	0.30	.136 / .124 / **.119**	.87 / .78 / .87	.165 (.070) / .153 (.068) / .116 (.074)	.37 / .45 / .53

all = all seeded organoids, `moments`; surv. = all seeded organoids, `survivor_moments`; det. = detected organoids only. Means over 5 seeds; MAE over the outcome probabilities.
Numbers: `results/e1b_all/e1b_all_groups.csv`.

Comment

- **Recording extinct organoids sharpens the death rates**, mostly in BH: A death sd 0.015–0.033 vs 0.045–0.057 (detected only), B death contraction 0.87 vs 0.63 at low death.
- **Overall accuracy does not improve, and in GW it worsens** (MAE 0.063 vs 0.032 at A death 0.03). With the standard summaries the zero rows enter every $\log(1+n)$ statistic together with the survivors and blur the survivor distribution that carries the information on the other outcomes.
- **Survivor summaries recover part of the loss** (GW MAE 0.063 → 0.057, 0.081 → 0.068) and keep the sharper BH death estimates (sd 0.023–0.033), but GW is still worse than detected-only. Part of the gap is design: in the all-clones arms 165/101 are *seeded* organoids, so fewer organoids carry size and composition information.
- High death (0.3) is underestimated in every arm (0.12–0.18): strong death is partly traded against other outcomes.
- Consequence: the number of seeded organoids (Q5) is worth recording mainly for the death rates in BH; enter it as the extinct fraction with survivor-only summaries, not as zero rows in the count statistics.

11 E1c — Death rates fixed to wrong values (BH)

Question

If A and B death are fixed (possibly wrongly) and the rest inferred, do other parameters compensate (flat PPC valley = death not identifiable once fixed)?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` with A death, B death fixed (7 free)
Data vs inference	data always $\theta^\star$ (A death 0.03, B death 0.1); inference fixes A death $\in \{0, 0.03, 0.2\}$, B death $\in \{0, 0.1, 0.4\}$
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k (retrained per setting)
Seeds / runs	5 / 45 (3 × 3 grid; the 4 × 4 grid is the GW sweep, §12)
Control	deaths fixed at truth (0.03 / 0.1)
Folder	`results/e1c/bh/`

Result

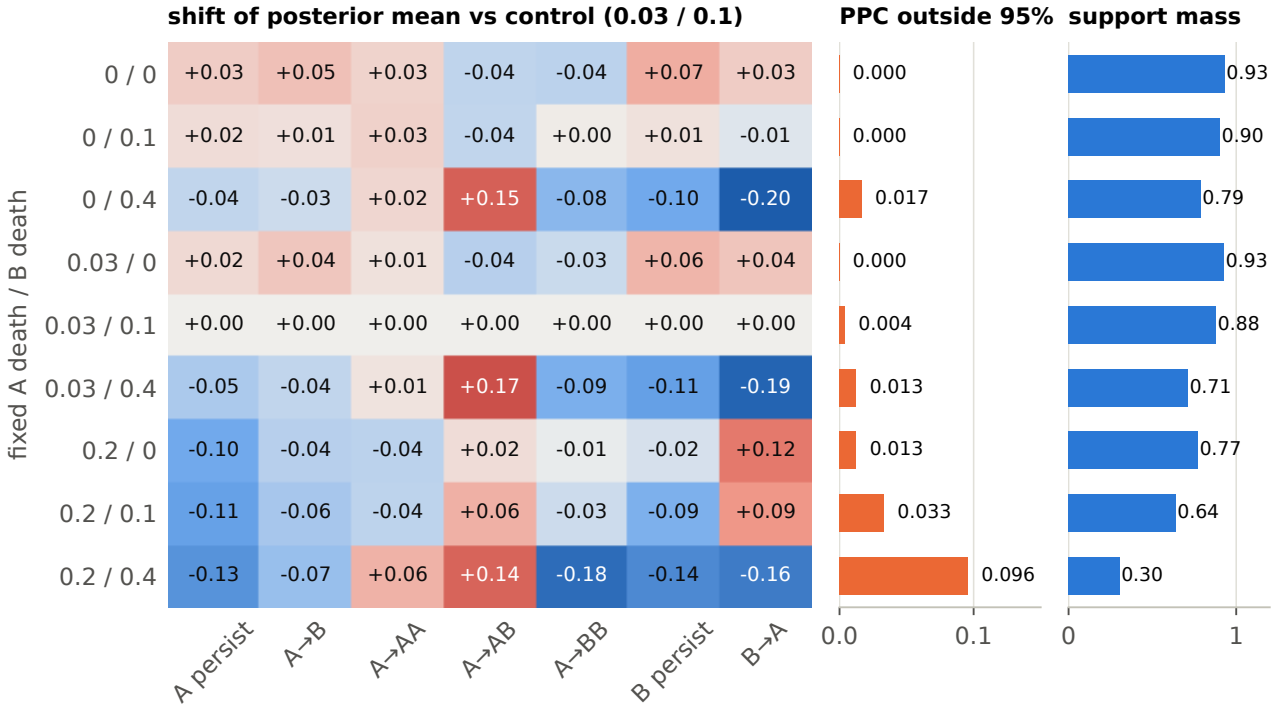


Figure 17: Left: shift of posterior means vs the control (deaths fixed at truth). Right: PPC and posterior support mass (well-specified free-death baseline: support 0.78).

Fixed A / B death	A persist	A→AB	B→A	τ_A	τ_B	PPC	support
0.03 / 0.1 (control)	0.15	0.18	0.67 [5/5]	16.1	18.1	0.004	0.88
0 / 0.4	−0.04	+0.15	−0.20 [0/5]	+0.3	+3.2	0.017	0.79
0.03 / 0.4	−0.05	+0.17	−0.19 [0/5]	−0.3	+2.9	0.013	0.71
0.2 / 0	−0.10	+0.02	+0.12	−2.1	−3.4	0.013	0.77
0.2 / 0.1	−0.11	+0.06	+0.09	−2.7	−2.1	0.033	0.64
0.2 / 0.4	−0.13	+0.14	−0.16 [0/5]	−2.4	+7.9	**0.096**	**0.30**
0 / 0, 0 / 0.1, 0.03 / 0	≤ 0.03	−0.04	≤ 0.04	≤ 0.8	≤ 2.4	0.000	0.90–0.93

Paired SE ≤ 0.03 (probabilities), ≤ 0.35 h (τ_A), ≤ 1.6 h (τ_B).

Comment

- Wrong deaths are absorbed by biologically sensible compensations: B death too high ⇒ less B→A, more A→AB; A death too high ⇒ less quiescence/switching, faster A clock.
- Bias, not information loss: mean contraction *rises* (0.72 → 0.84) while coverage falls (0.76 → 0.38): wrong models are more confident.
- Only the double error is flagged (PPC 0.096, support 0.30; seed 2 support 0.014 ⇒ not an estimate).

- Fixing deaths at the truth gains little vs free deaths (free baseline already constrains them: contraction 0.89 / 0.65).
- Consequence: do not fix death to a guess; keep free or measure (apoptosis marker). C2ST not run; intermediate values (0.1, 0.2) only in the GW sweep (§12).

12 E1c — Death rates fixed to wrong values (GW, 4 × 4 grid)

Question

As §11, on a finer grid and without the BH ridge: is there a flat PPC valley across fixed death values?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` with A, B death fixed (5 free)
Data vs inference	data always $\theta^\star$; inference fixes A death $\in \{0, .03, .1, .2\}$ × B death $\in \{0, .1, .2, .4\}$
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k (retrained per setting); bounded SBC (relaunched after the first launch hung; 1 SBC case excluded in 1 run)
Seeds / runs	5 / 80
Control	deaths fixed at truth (0.03 / 0.1)
Folder	`results/e1c/gw/`

Result

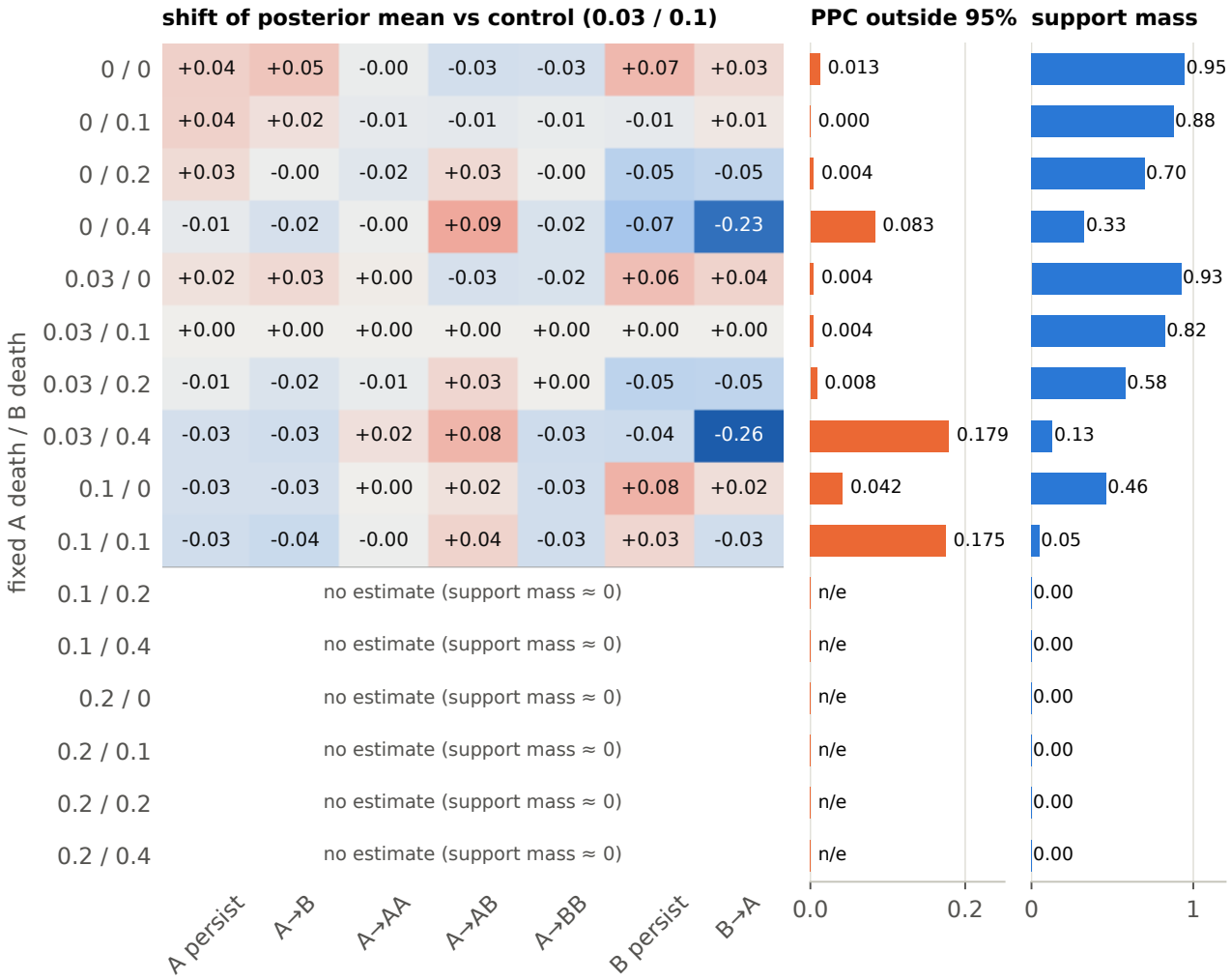


Figure 18: E1c GW. Left: shift of posterior means vs the control (deaths fixed at truth); rows with support mass < 0.02 are not estimates. Right: PPC and posterior support mass.

Fixed A / B death	A persist	A→AB	B persist	B→A	PPC	support
0.03 / 0.1 (control)	0.04	0.10	0.14	0.76 [5/5]	0.004	0.82
0 / 0, 0 / 0.1, 0.03 / 0	$\leq +0.04$	≥ -0.03	$\leq +0.07$	$\leq +0.04$	≤ 0.013	0.88–0.95
0 / 0.2, 0.03 / 0.2	$+0.03$ / -0.01	$+0.03$	-0.05	$-0.05 \pm .02$ [0/5]	≤ 0.008	0.58–0.70
0 / 0.4	-0.01	$+0.09$	-0.07	-0.23 [0/5]	**0.083**	**0.33**
0.03 / 0.4	-0.03 [1/5]	$+0.08$	-0.04	-0.26 [0/5]	**0.179**	**0.13**
0.1 / 0	-0.03 [0/5]	$+0.02$	$+0.08$	$+0.02$	0.042	0.46
0.1 / 0.1	-0.03 [0/5]	$+0.04$	$+0.03$	-0.03	**0.175**	**0.05**
0.1 / 0.2, 0.1 / 0.4	no estimate (support mass ≤ 0.004)				—	**0.00**
0.2 / any	no estimate (17/20 runs without any posterior sample)				—	**0.00**

A→AA never moves ($|\Delta| \leq 0.02$) in an estimable cell. Paired SE ≤ 0.02 for the shifts shown.

Comment

- **The valley is flat downwards, walled upwards for A**: death fixed at 0 fits as well as the truth (shifts ≤ 0.07, PPC ≤ 0.013; small, though up to ≈ 2 posterior sd for GW's narrow posteriors). A death fixed above the truth breaks the fit from 0.1 on (support ≈ 0; at 0.2 no posterior mass in the prior support): GW has one event per generation, so a higher death must be absorbed within A's simplex (A persist and A→B hit 0 first).
- **Contrast with BH** (§11): there A death 0.2 was absorbed silently by a faster A clock (PPC ≤ 0.033, support 0.64–0.77, A persist -0.10, τ_A -2 to -3 h). Whether a wrong fixed death is *detectable* depends on whether the model has a free time scale.
- **B death too high biases B→A in both**: $0.4 \Rightarrow -0.23/-0.26$ (GW, flagged: support 0.13–0.33) vs $-0.19/-0.20$ (BH, silent). B death 0.2 is silent in GW but already 0/5 covered (B→A -0.05; with B death fixed, B's row has one free coordinate and a narrow posterior).
- Fixing deaths at truth gains little over free deaths (MAE 0.028 vs 0.033). Consequence unchanged: do not fix death rates to guesses. C2ST not run.

13 E2a / E2b — A↔B mis-typing, known vs ignored (BH)

Question

Clustering mislabels cells at rate e. If the error is modelled (E2a), do we only lose information? If ignored (E2b), how large is the bias, and is it visible?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (9)
Data model	symmetric confusion $e \in \{0, .02, .05, .1, .15, .2\}$, capture 1
Inference model	E2a: `observation=noisy` with the same e (network retrained per e); E2b: perfect typing (one network per seed)
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 60
Control	$e = 0$ (= BH baseline)
Folder	`results/e2/known_bh`, `results/e2/ignored_bh`

Result

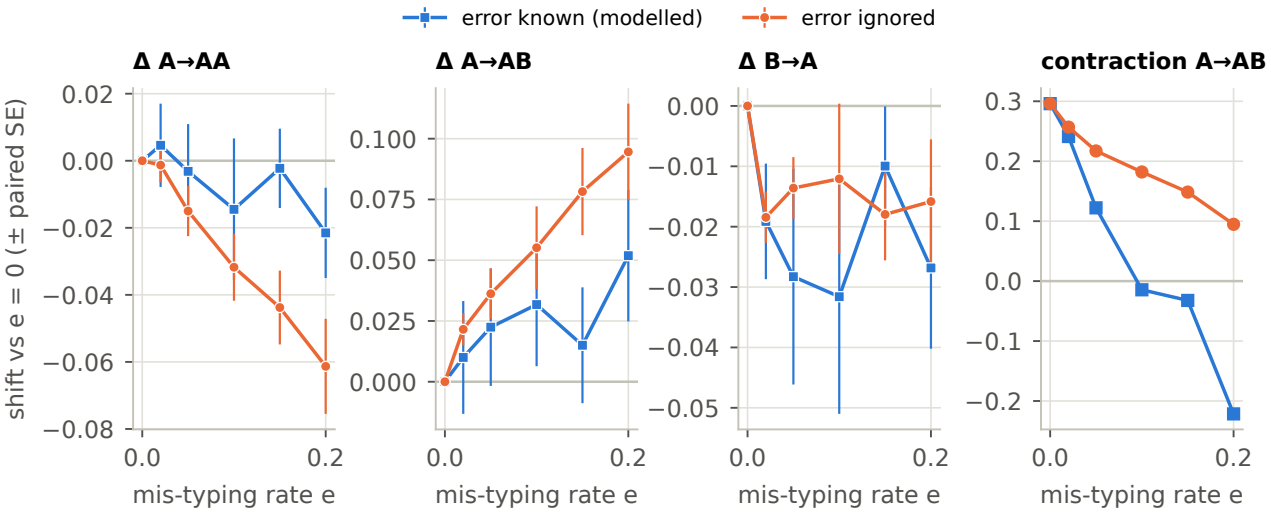


Figure 19: Shift vs $e = 0$ (± paired SE) and contraction of A→AB. Blue: error modelled; orange: error ignored.

e	0.02	0.05	0.1	0.15	0.2	PPC / support
Ignored: A→AB shift	+0.02	+0.04	+0.06	+0.08	+0.09 ± .02	≤ 0.008 / 0.78
Ignored: A→AA shift	−0.00	−0.02	−0.03	−0.04	−0.06± .01	
Ignored: shift / posterior sd (A→AB)	0.2	0.3	0.4	0.6	0.7	
Known: contraction A→AB (0.30 at e=0)	0.24	0.12	−0.01	−0.03	−0.22	≤ 0.008 / n/r
Known: contraction A→AA (0.52)	0.53	0.48	0.43	0.41	0.38	

Comment

- Known error = information loss in the division split; means within 0.05 of control, no trend.
- Ignored error = monotone bias: mislabelling makes clones look mixed, explained by more asymmetric divisions. Coverage of A→AB 3/5 → 0/5 at $e = 0.2$. Invisible to PPC and support mass.
- At the estimated rates (5% ++, 15% −−; Q2) the bias is < 1 sd at this design — tolerable only because posteriors are wide; larger designs (E4) narrow them.
- Consequence: estimate e (2D vs 3D, Q3) and pass it to the model. Asymmetric errors: §14.1.

14 E2a / E2b — A↔B mis-typing, known vs ignored (GW)

Question

As §13 for Galton–Watson: tolerance to known vs ignored mis-typing when the baseline is unbiased and the posteriors are narrower.

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (7)
Data / inference	symmetric $e \in \{0, .02, .05, .1, .15, .2\}$; modelled (E2a, network retrained per e) or ignored (E2b, one network per seed)
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 60
Control	$e = 0$ (= GW baseline)
Folder	`results/e2/known_gw`, `results/e2/ignored_gw`

Result

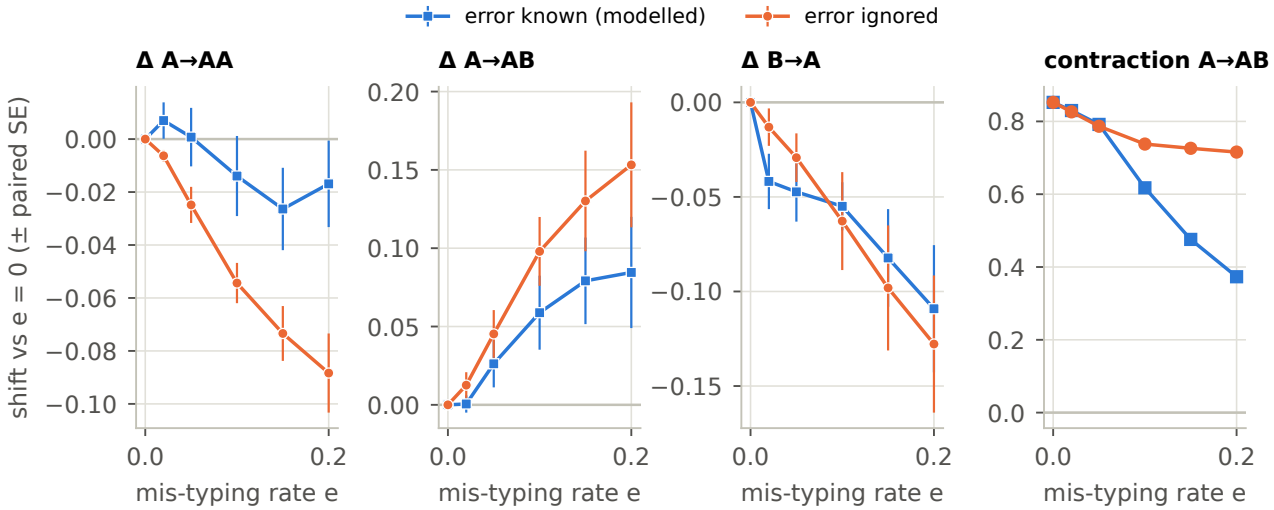


Figure 20: E2 GW: shift vs $e = 0$ (± paired SE) and contraction of A→AB. Blue: error modelled; orange: error ignored.

e	0.02	0.05	0.1	0.15	0.2	BH at 0.2
Ignored: A→AB shift	+0.01	+0.05	+0.10 [0/5]	+0.13	+0.15 ± .04 [0/5]	+0.09
Ignored: A→AA shift	−0.01	−0.02	−0.05 [0/5]	−0.07	−0.09± .01 [0/5]	−0.06
Ignored: B→A shift	−0.01	−0.03	−0.06	−0.10	−0.13± .04 [3/5]	−0.02
Ignored: shift / posterior sd (A→AB)	0.2	0.7	**1.4**	1.8	2.1	0.7
Ignored: PPC / support	.004 / .66	.004 / .64	0 / .59	.012 / .55	.033 / .48	.000 / .78
Known: contraction A→AB (0.85 at e=0)	0.83	0.79	0.62	0.48	0.37	−0.22
Known: B→A shift	−0.04	−0.05	−0.05	−0.08	−0.11± .03 [4/5]	−0.03

Comment

- **Same mechanism as BH**, about 1.5× larger and extending to B's row: mislabelled clones look mixed ⇒ more asymmetric division, less self-renewal, fewer B→A, more B persist (+0.18 at $e = 0.2$).
- **Tolerance is set by the posterior width**: GW posteriors are ≈2.5× narrower (sd of A→AB 0.05 vs 0.12), so the bias exceeds one posterior sd at $e \approx 0.1$ (0/5 covered). Tolerable $e \approx 0.05$ in GW vs ≈ 0.2 in BH.
- **Modelled error = information loss**: A→AB contraction 0.85 → 0.37; means drift towards the prior means (B→A −0.11, A→AB +0.08 at $e = 0.2$) with coverage kept — expected for a wider posterior under a uniform Dirichlet, not a bias.
- **Not detected**: PPC ≤ 0.033; support mass falls 0.67 → 0.48 (min 0.10) — a trend across the sweep, not a single-run warning.
- Consequence: estimate e (Q3) and model it; the BH tolerance will shrink to the GW one once division times are measured. Asymmetric errors: §14.1.

14.1 E2 follow-up — asymmetric A↔B mis-typing (GW and BH)

Question

Is mis-typing in one direction (A read as B, rate e_A; B read as A, rate e_B) more harmful than the other, when ignored and when modelled? E2 used symmetric errors only.

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson and Bellman–Harris (shape 8)
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (GW 7, BH 9)
Data model	confusion $(e_A, e_B) \in \{(0.10, 0), (0, 0.10), (0.05, 0.15), (0.15, 0.05)\}$, capture 1; dynamics $\theta^\star$
Inference model	ignored: perfect typing; known: `observation=noisy` with the true asymmetric confusion
Design	real-like: GW generations 6/10, BH 144/240 h; 165/101 organoids
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 80 (4 settings × 2 arms × 2 simulators)
Folder	`results/e2_asym/{ignored,known}`

Result

	(e_A, e_B)	MAE ignored → known	coverage ignored → known	support ign.	PPC ign.	B→A (0.80) ign. / known
GW	(0, 0.10)	0.040 → 0.035	0.84 → 0.96	0.70	0.000	0.74 / 0.76
GW	(0.10, 0)	**0.066** → 0.048	0.76 → 0.87	0.50	0.025	0.66 / 0.73
GW	(0.05, 0.15)	0.050 → 0.045	0.82 → 0.91	0.70	0.004	0.72 / 0.72
GW	(0.15, 0.05)	**0.086** → 0.054	**0.64** → 0.91	**0.42**	0.038	0.63 / 0.70
BH	(0, 0.10)	0.121 → 0.110	0.78 → 0.82	0.79	0.000	0.59 / 0.62
BH	(0.10, 0)	0.122 → 0.116	0.78 → 0.87	0.78	0.000	0.62 / 0.62
BH	(0.05, 0.15)	0.125 → 0.113	0.78 → 0.84	0.79	0.000	0.59 / 0.63
BH	(0.15, 0.05)	0.136 → 0.121	0.76 → 0.84	0.78	0.000	0.60 / 0.60

Means over 5 seeds; MAE over the outcome probabilities.
Numbers: `results/e2_asym/e2_asym_groups.csv`.

Comment

- **Stem cells read as differentiated (e_A) is the harmful direction.** In GW, ignoring $e_A = 0.10$–0.15 doubles the error (0.040 → 0.066–0.086) and drops coverage to 0.64; B read as A at the same rate is almost harmless (0.040, 0.84). A is the dividing, abundant type, so its mislabels create spurious B cells and pull B→A down (0.63–0.66).
- **Partly flagged**: in the A→B direction support mass falls to 0.42–0.50 and the PPC rises to 2.5–3.8% (GW); the B→A direction is not flagged.
- **Modelling the known confusion removes the bias** (GW MAE 0.035–0.054, coverage 0.87–0.96).
- **In BH the effect is small** next to the lifetime/self-renewal ridge error (MAE ≈ 0.12 in every setting); modelling still improves coverage (0.76–0.78 → 0.82–0.87). No BH setting is flagged.
- Consequence: an estimate of how often LGR5$^+$ cells are called KRT20$^+$ (Q3) matters more than the reverse; if available, pass it to the model as an asymmetric confusion (`observation=noisy`).

15 E2c — Hidden third type ignored (GW)

Question

Data contain a third type C (double negative/positive) read as A with prob. q and as B with $1 - q$. If the model ignores C, are the A and B rows still recovered, and does the PPC flag the two-type model?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Data model	`three_type`: A = {death .03, persist .02, A→C, A→AA, A→AC, A→CC}, C = {death .05, persist .10, C→B .40, C→BC .20, C→CC .25}, B = {death .10, persist .90} (B never returns to A). C fraction ≈ 5% (A→AA 0.905) or ≈ 15% (A→AA 0.79); `three_split` with $q \in \{0, 0.5, 1\}$
Inference model	two-type `reversible_ab`, perfect typing (7 free)
Truth for scored names	A death .03, A persist .02, A→AA .905 / .79, A→B = A→AB = A→BB = 0, B death .10, B persist .90, B→A 0
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 30
Control	*none* in this sweep (no two-type data with the same A row); arms with C modelled: §16
Folder	`results/e2c/ignore_c/`

Result

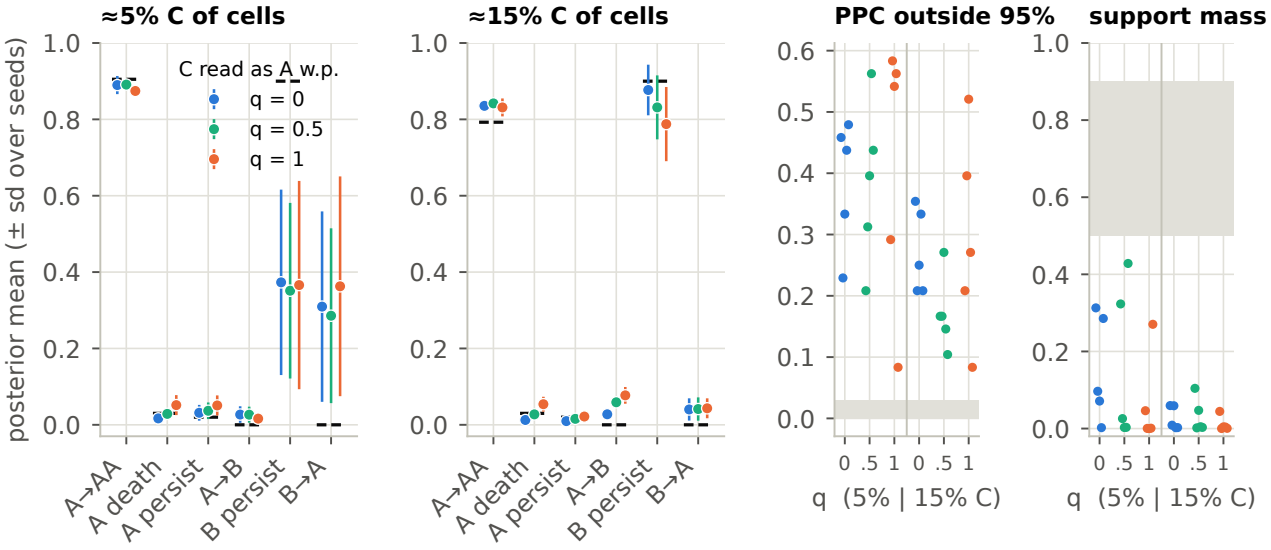


Figure 21: Left: posterior means (± sd over seeds) per q; dashes = truth of the data model. Right: PPC and support mass per run; grey = well-specified ranges.

C share	q	A→AA	A→BB (0)	A→B (0)	B persist (.90)	B→A (0)	PPC	support
≈15%	0	0.84 (.79)	0.10	0.03	0.88	0.04	0.27	0.03
	0.5	0.84	0.05	0.06	0.83	0.04	0.17	0.03
	1	0.83	0.02	0.08	0.79	0.04	0.30	0.01
≈5%	0	0.89 (.905)	0.03	0.03	0.37	0.31	0.39	0.15
	0.5	0.89	0.01	0.03	0.35	0.29	0.38	0.16
	1	0.87	0.01	0.02	0.37	0.36	0.41	0.06

Comment

- **The two-type fit is flagged**: PPC 0.17–0.41 (well specified ≤ 0.03), support mass 0.01–0.16 (well specified 0.5–0.9). Per the reading rules these posteriors are not reliable estimates.
- How C is absorbed: read as B ($q = 0$), A→CC appears as A→BB (0.10 at 15%); read as A ($q = 1$), C→B appears as A→B switching (0.08) and A death rises (0.05). A→AA is overestimated at 15% (+0.05) and slightly under at 5% (−0.02).
- At 5% C, B cells are rare (B only arises via C): B's row stays prior-like (B persist 0.37, contraction 0.25–0.45 for B death).
- **Attribution**: the data truth is far in the prior tail of the inference model (A→AA 0.79–0.905: prior mass above $< 0.05\%$; B persist 0.9: 1%), and PPC is *higher* with less C (5% vs 15%). The arms that model C (§16) fail even more although one of them is the data model: the misfit is driven by the prior tail and cannot be attributed to C.
- One run (5%, $q = 1$, seed 2) drew only 74 posterior samples.

16 E2c — Third type modelled: three-arm comparison (GW)

Question

When C is modelled (freely, or with the trajectory constraint C→B only), are A and B recovered, is C's row identifiable without its own marker, and is the misfit of §15 removed?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Data model	as §15 (same 30 datasets: $q \in \{0, .5, 1\}$, ≈5% / 15% C)
Inference arms	ignore C: `reversible_ab` (7 free, §15); C free: `three_type` + `three_split`, q known (27 free) = *the data model*; C trajectory: `three_type_traj` (C never produces A; pending Q1) + `three_split` (23 free)
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 30 per arm (90)
Folder	`results/e2c/{ignore_c,model_c_free,model_c_traj}`

Result

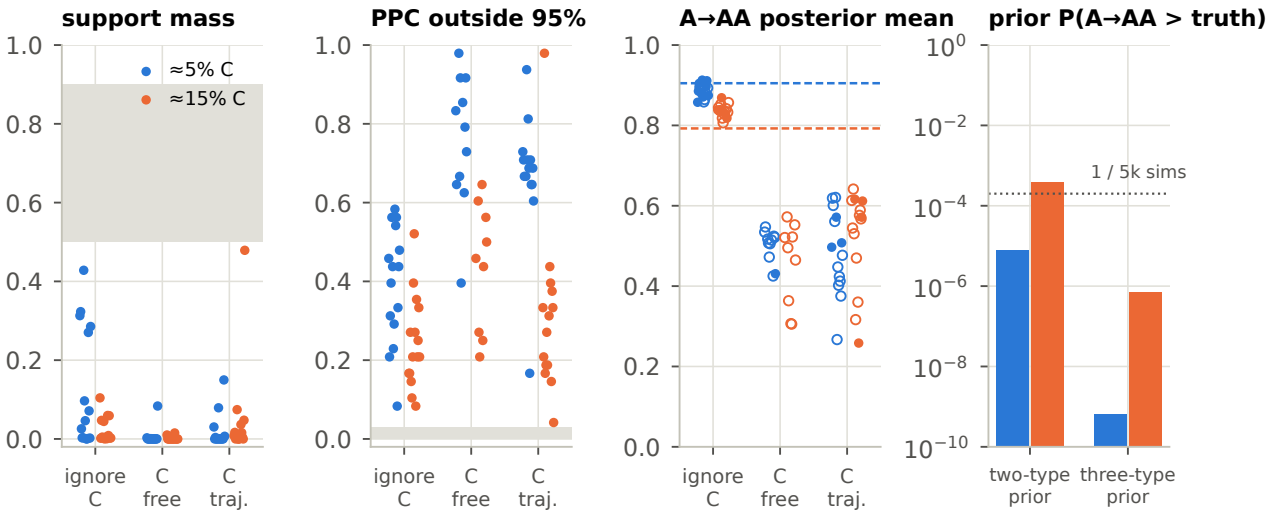


Figure 22: E2c, three inference arms on the same data (one point per run). Grey bands: well-specified ranges. A→AA: open circles = support mass < 0.02 (not estimates); dashed = truth (0.905 at 5% C, 0.79 at 15%). Right: prior probability of A→AA above the truth under each inference model (uniform Dirichlet; dotted = one in 5 000 training simulations).

Arm	C	runs with samples	support: median (max)	PPC (group means)	A→AA (truth)
ignore C	5%	15/15	0.05 (0.43)	0.38–0.41	0.87–0.89 (.905)
	15%	15/15	0.004 (0.10)	0.17–0.30	0.83–0.84 (.79)
C free (well specified)	5%	11/15	0.000 (0.08)	0.63–0.84	*0.48–0.52*
	15%	9/15	0.000 (0.02)	0.37–0.50	*0.33–0.53*
C trajectory	5%	14/15	0.000 (0.15)	0.60–0.75	*0.39–0.60*
	15%	14/15	0.008 (0.48)	0.26–0.38	*0.35–0.59*

Italics: not estimates (support ≈ 0). SBC coverage error 0.024–0.029 in every arm. Prior P(A→AA > truth) at 5% / 15% C: two-type (6 outcomes) $8 \cdot 10^{-6}$ / $4 \cdot 10^{-4}$; three-type (10 outcomes) $6 \cdot 10^{-10}$ / $8 \cdot 10^{-7}$. P(B persist > 0.9): 0.01 (two-type) vs 10^{-9} (three-type).

Comment

- **Modelling C does not remove the misfit — it makes it worse**: support ≈ 0 in almost every run (10/30 free and 2/30 trajectory runs drew no posterior sample at all), PPC 0.26–0.84. No A/B bias and nothing about C (e.g. C→B 0.01–0.12 vs 0.40) can be read from these arms.
- **The failure is a prior-tail failure, not misspecification**: the free arm *is* the data model. Under a 10-outcome uniform Dirichlet the true A→AA (0.79–0.905) and B persist (0.9) have prior probability 10^{-6}–10^{-10}: no training simulation resembles the data, and amortised NPE extrapolates outside the prior support. SBC is fine because it averages over the prior. The two-type model fits *better* than the true model because its prior has more mass near the truth.
- **Hence the ignore-C flag (PPC 0.17–0.41) cannot be attributed to C**; also within ignore-C the PPC is higher with *less* C. Whether the PPC detects a hidden type is still open. The trajectory constraint helps slightly (fewer empty posteriors; one run with support 0.48).
- Follow-up done: the rerun with truths drawn from the three-type prior (§17) confirms that this failure was the tail truth, not the method.

17 E2c rerun — hidden third type, truths from the prior (GW)

Question

The original E2c (§15, §16) used a truth deep in the three-type Dirichlet tail, so even the true model failed. With truths in the prior bulk: (1) is ignoring C detected, and (2) does modelling C (free, or trajectory-constrained) recover the A/B rows?

Setup

Simulator	Galton–Watson
Data model	`three_type`, 10 truths *drawn from the three-type prior* (`truth.source=prior`, `data_seed` = seed 0–9); `three_split` with $q \in \{0, 0.5, 1\}$ (C read as A with prob. q). Same 30 datasets in every arm
Prior-drawn truths	generic biology: C is 21–41% of cells at generation 10; B divides (B-division mass 0.37–0.84); C makes A (C→A mass 0.19–0.58)
Inference arms	ignore C: `reversible_ab` (7 free; also forbids B divisions); C free: `three_type` + `three_split`, q known (27 free) = *the data model*; C trajectory: `three_type_traj` (C never makes A; 23 free). Both constrained arms are misspecified for *every* truth, ignore C doubly so
Scored	the 9 A/B parameters present in every arm; "flagged" = support mass < 0.1 or PPC > 0.05; "usable" = at least 100 posterior samples within the 60 s sampling cap; prior-mean baseline = $\lvert\text{truth} - 0.1\rvert$ (10-outcome Dirichlet mean)
Design	real-like generations 6/10 × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	10 truths × 3 q × 3 arms = 90
Folder	`results/e2c_prior/{ignore_c,model_c_free,model_c_traj}` (`e2c_prior_runs.csv`, `e2c_prior_groups.csv`)

Result

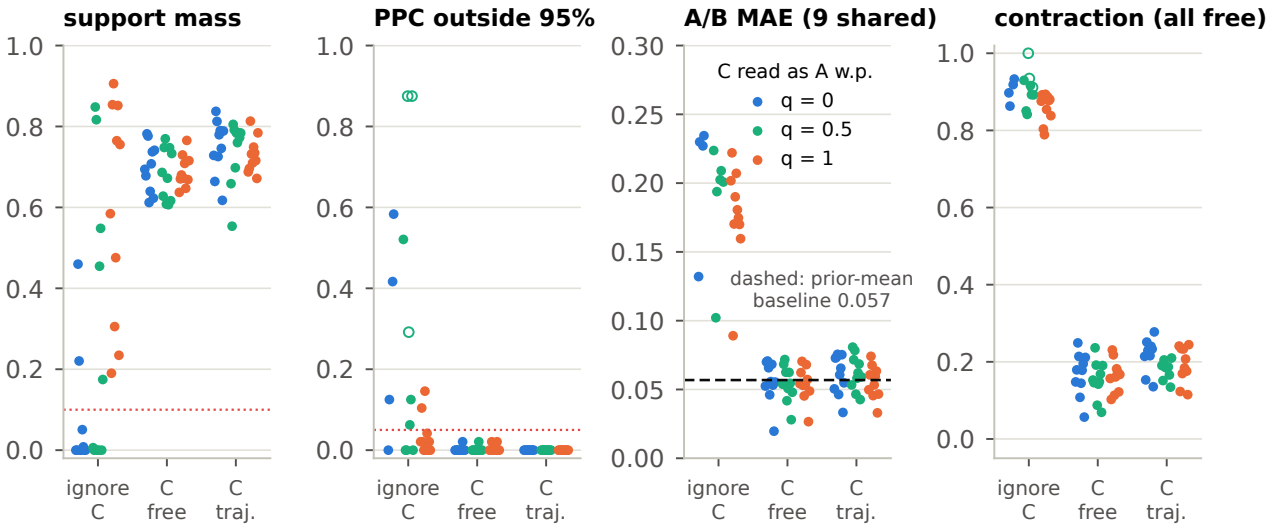


Figure 23: E2c rerun, one point per run (10 prior-drawn truths per q). Dotted red: flag thresholds (support < 0.1, PPC > 0.05). Open circles: fewer than 100 posterior samples (not estimates; A/B MAE not computed). A/B MAE over the 9 shared A/B parameters; dashed = prior-mean baseline. Contraction over all free parameters of each arm.

Arm	q	usable	flagged	support (med.)	PPC	SBC err.	A/B MAE	A/B cov.	contr.
ignore C	0	4/10	**9/10**	0.00	0.28	0.029	0.206	0.11	0.90
	0.5	6/10	**7/10**	0.09	0.31	0.029	0.189	0.20	0.91
	1	10/10	**2/10**	0.67	0.04	0.029	0.177	0.42	0.86
C free (well specified)	0–1	30/30	0	0.68–0.70	0.00	0.026–0.027	0.055	0.93	0.16
C trajectory	0–1	30/30	0	0.72–0.78	0.00	0.024–0.025	0.059	0.92	0.20
Prior-mean baseline (posterior mean replaced by the prior mean 0.1)							0.057		

Model-C rows pool the three q (per q: MAE 0.054–0.056 free, 0.055–0.062 trajectory; contraction 0.15–0.17 and 0.18–0.22). PPC and contraction for ignore C include runs with fewer than 100 samples. Numbers: `tables/e2c_prior.csv`.

Comment

- **Ignoring C is detected when C looks like B, missed when C looks like A.** At $q = 0$ 9/10 runs are flagged (support ≈ 0, PPC up to 0.58; 6/10 runs give no usable posterior). At $q = 1$ only 2/10 are flagged, while the A/B rows are still wrong (MAE 0.18, 90% coverage 0.42) with high contraction (0.86): *confident, silent bias.*
- **Modelling C is calibrated but not informative.** Both model-C arms pass every check (PPC ≈ 0, SBC 0.024–0.027, A/B coverage 0.92–0.93), but contraction is 0.16–0.20 and the A/B error equals the prior-mean baseline (0.055 / 0.059 vs 0.057). With 23–27 free parameters and two endpoints of two labels the data barely move the posterior: correct, but it is the prior speaking.

- **The trajectory constraint is wrong for every truth and nothing detects it** (C→A mass up to 0.58; PPC 0, support 0.72–0.78): the data are too weak to contradict it.
- **Resolves §16**: the "true model fails" result there came from the tail truth, not the method. In the prior bulk the well-specified model is calibrated, but a three-type model is not identifiable from two-label endpoint counts at this design.
- Caveats: 10 truths, NPE 5k, one design. Prior truths have much more C (21–41%) than the biological scenario (5–15%) and B divisions, unlike the original truth; ignore C also forbids B divisions, so its failures are not due to C alone. The A/B "truth" for the two-type arm is the three-type value of the same outcome, which a two-type row cannot match exactly (part of its error is projection).
- Consequence: if a hidden C is suspected, modelling it needs constraints that are actually true (from trajectory data), a C-specific measurement, or much richer designs. Ignoring it is risky mainly when C is read as A (q near 1).

18 E3a — Per-type division time vs one global value (BH)

Question

If B divides more slowly than A, can both lifetimes be inferred? What happens if both are fixed to one global (pooled) value, or to a wrong one (±25%)?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	free arm: `reversible_ab` (9); fixed arm: lifetimes fixed to T (7)
Data model	$\tau_A = 20$ h, $\tau_B \in \{20, 30, 45\}$ h; outcome probabilities $\theta^\star$
Inference model	(i) both lifetimes inferred; (ii) both fixed to pooled $T = (20 + \tau_B)/2$; (iii) pooled ±25%
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 60 (3 τ_B × (1 free + 3 fixed))
Control	free arm at the same τ_B
Folder	`results/e3a/free`, `results/e3a/fixed`

Result

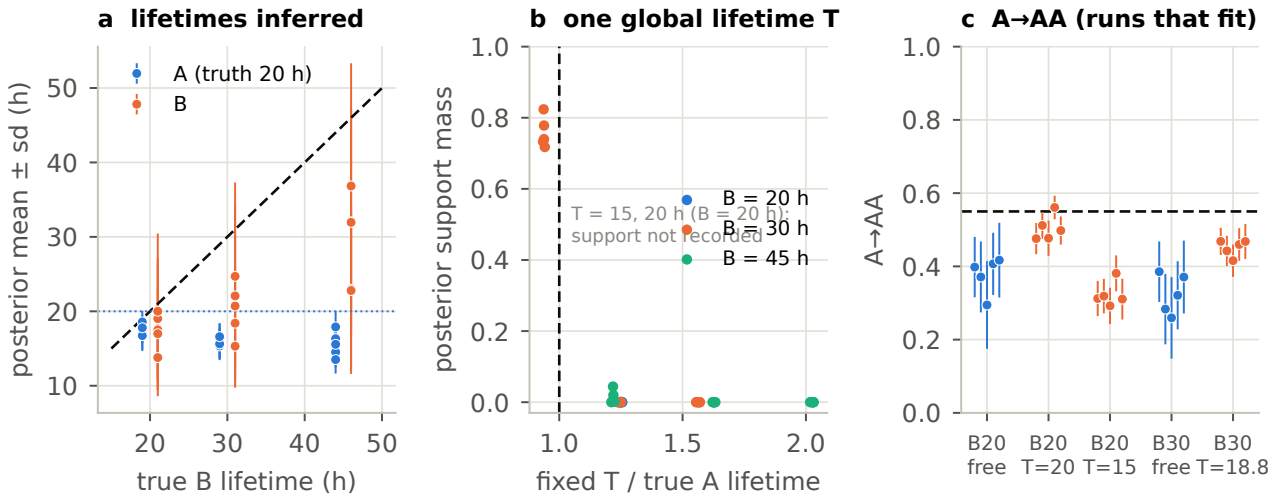


Figure 24: (a) Inferred lifetimes vs true τ_B (per run, ± sd); dotted = true τ_A. (b) Posterior support mass vs fixed T relative to the true τ_A (20 h). (c) A→AA in the settings that fit.

τ_B / T		A persist	A→AA	A→AB	B→A	MAE	PPC	support
20 / free	control	0.11	0.38 [1/5]	0.21	0.68	0.087	0.004	n/r
20 / **20**	T = truth	0.05	**0.50 [4/5]**	0.14	0.75	**0.042**	0.004	n/r
20 / 15	−25%	0.20 (+0.08)	0.32	0.15	0.79 (+0.10)	0.081	0.013	n/r
30 / 18.75	−25%	0.05	0.45 (+0.13)	0.13	0.59 [1/5]	0.072	0.000	0.76
any / ≥ 24.4	$T > \tau_A$	no estimate (0–2 000 samples; boundary values)				—	0.35–0.51	≈ 0

Free arm: τ_A 17.5 / 15.9 / 15.6 h and τ_B 17.5 / 20.2 / 29.3 h for true τ_B 20 / 30 / 45 (contraction of τ_B 0.84 / 0.75 / 0.49).

Comment

- Lifetimes fixed at the truth give the best BH recovery of all (A→AA 0.50, MAE 0.042, contraction 0.92) — direct evidence for the ridge.
- Inferred τ_A is biased short whatever τ_B; τ_B is compressed towards τ_A and weakly informed.
- T longer than A's lifetime ⇒ the model cannot fit (support ≈ 0, PPC 0.35–0.51): *detectable*. Depends on T vs τ_A, not on the pooled mean.
- T a little shorter than τ_A ⇒ fits normally but shifts outcomes by up to 0.10 (A persist absorbs the faster clock): *undetectable*.
- Consequence: measure A's division time per type; never use a pooled mean when B is slower. Caveat: coarse T grid (failure threshold between 20 and 24.4 h).

19 E3b — Desynchronisation: lifetime CV misspecified (BH)

Question

How biased is the fit when the data's lifetime variability (Gamma shape 1–32, CV 1–0.18, or per type) differs from the assumed shape 8 (CV 0.35)? Does the PPC see it?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris
Law (free)	`reversible_ab` (9)
Data model	shape ∈ {1, 2, 4, 8, 32} and per type {A 4, B 16}, {A 16, B 4}
Inference model	shape 8 always (one network per seed: paired shifts)
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 35
Control	data shape 8 (= BH baseline)
Folder	`results/e3b/`

Result

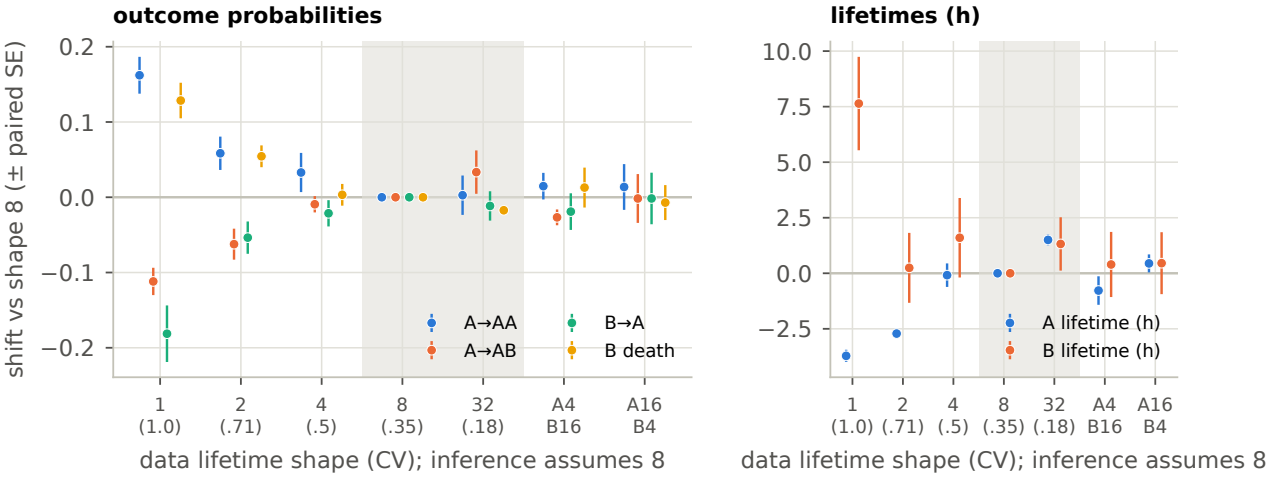


Figure 25: Shift vs shape 8 (± paired SE); grey band = CV 0.18–0.35, around the assumed value.

Data shape (CV)	A→AA	A→AB	B death	B→A	τ_A (h)	τ_B (h)	PPC
8 (0.35) control	0.32	0.23	0.17	0.63	15.9	20.2	0.008
1 (1.0)	+0.16 ± .02	−0.11	+0.13	−0.18± .04	−3.7± 0.3	+7.6 ± 2.1	0.004
2 (0.71)	+0.06	−0.06	+0.05	−0.05	−2.7	+0.2	0.000
4 (0.5)	+0.03	−0.01	+0.00	−0.02	−0.1	+1.6	0.000
32 (0.18)	+0.00	+0.03	−0.02	−0.01	+1.5 ± 0.2	+1.3	0.000
A 4 / B 16; A 16 / B 4	≤ 0.01	≤ 0.03	≤ 0.01	≤ 0.02	−0.8 / +0.4	≤ 0.5	≤ 0.004

Comment

- CV 0.18–0.5 (incl. per-type mixes) is harmless: shifts ≤ 0.035 and ≤ 1.6 h, small vs posterior sd (≈ 0.1, 2 h).
- Near-exponential cycle times are read as a faster clock with a different division split; bias is large and invisible to the PPC. (A→AA moves *towards* the truth only because the control is biased low.)

- Consequence: a rough CV estimate (live imaging) suffices; if CV $\gtrsim 0.7$ change the shape in the model. Shape was never inferred; support mass not recorded.

20 E3c — Quiescence vs division time (BH)

Question

Are quiescence (A persist) and A's lifetime confounded? What happens if quiescence is fixed to 0 while the data have A persist $\in \{0.03, 0.15, 0.30\}$?

Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8
Law (free)	free arm `reversible_ab` (9); fixed arm A persist = 0 (8)
Data model	A persist 0.03 / 0.15 / 0.30, other A entries rescaled (A→AA 0.55 / 0.48 / 0.40)
Design	real-like 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k
Seeds / runs	5 / 30
Control	free arm at the same data
Folder	`results/e3c/persist_free`, `results/e3c/persist_fixed0`

Result

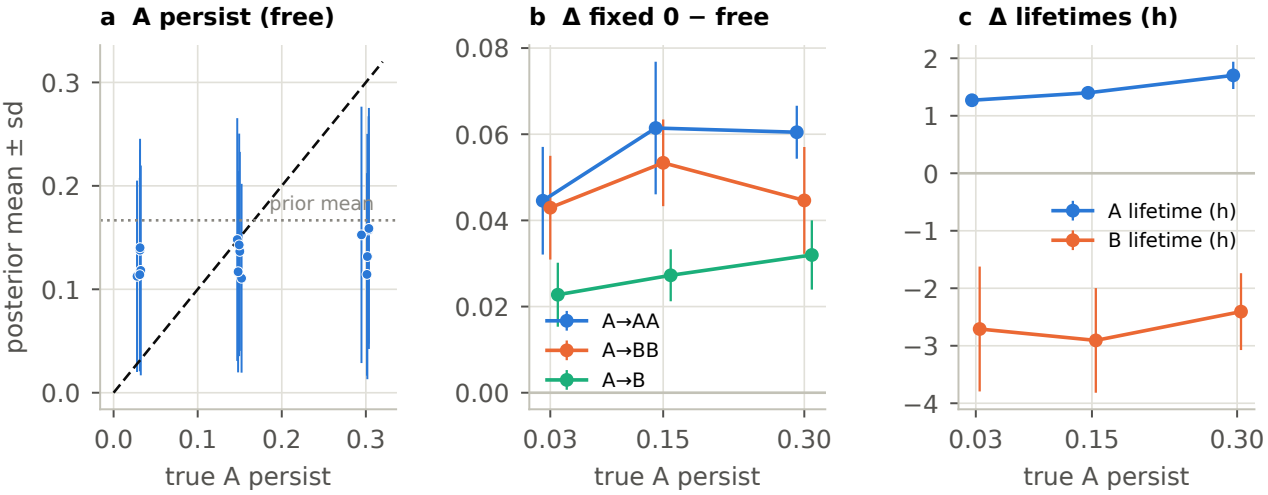


Figure 26: (a) A persist posterior (free) vs truth; dotted = prior mean 1/6. (b, c) Shift fixed-0 minus free (± paired SE).

True A persist	free: A persist (contr.)	free: τ_A	fixed 0: $\Delta\tau_A$	ΔA→AA	$\Delta\tau_B$	PPC
0.03	0.12 (0.51)	15.9	+1.3 ± 0.1	+0.05	−2.7	0.000
0.15	0.13 (0.47)	17.9	+1.4	+0.06	−2.9	0.000
0.30	0.14 (0.35)	19.3	+1.7	+0.06	−2.4	0.004

Posterior correlations (free arm): corr(A persist, τ_A) ≈ −0.6; corr(A→AA, τ_A) ≈ +0.7.

Comment

- Quiescence is not identifiable from endpoint counts: the posterior stays near the prior whatever the truth.
- Quiescence, lifetime and self-renewal lie on one ridge (the growth rate).
- Fixing it to 0 gives a constant small shift (longer lifetimes absorb it), independent of the true value, undetected by the PPC.
- Consequence: fix A persist from independent evidence (Ki67) or report lifetimes and self-renewal conditional on it; measuring A's division time also breaks the confound. Q4 (meaning of "inattivazione") open.

21 X2 — Seed spread: dataset vs training (GW and BH)

Question

Every experiment varies one `seed` per run, which changes both the reference dataset (`data_seed` = `seed`) and the network training and sampling. How much of the run-to-run spread of posterior means comes from the dataset and how much from training? Is training noise small compared with the posterior width?

Setup

Configuration	the final configuration: `reversible_ab` (B divisions fixed), real-like design (GW generations 6/10; BH 144/240 h; 165/101 clones), perfect observation, $\theta^\star$, NPE 5k (`budget=dev`), SBC 200, PPC 200; both simulators
Arms	*training*: `seed` 0–9 with `data_seed` 0 (one dataset, 10 networks); *data*: `data_seed` 0–9 with `seed` 0 (10 datasets, one network)
Seeds / runs	10 per arm and simulator (40); 10 rather than the planned 5, because an sd from 5 values is too noisy
Measures	post. sd = mean posterior sd; sd train, sd data = sd of the posterior mean over the 10 runs of each arm; training share = sd train^2 / sd data^2 (capped at 1). From 10 runs an sd ratio is uncertain by roughly ±25%
Folder	`results/x2/gw_training/`, `gw_data/`, `bh_training/`, `bh_data/` (preset `x2_seeds`, commit `503ec72`); `results/x2/x2_spread.csv` (`scripts/analyse_x2.py`); table `report/tables/x2.csv`

Result

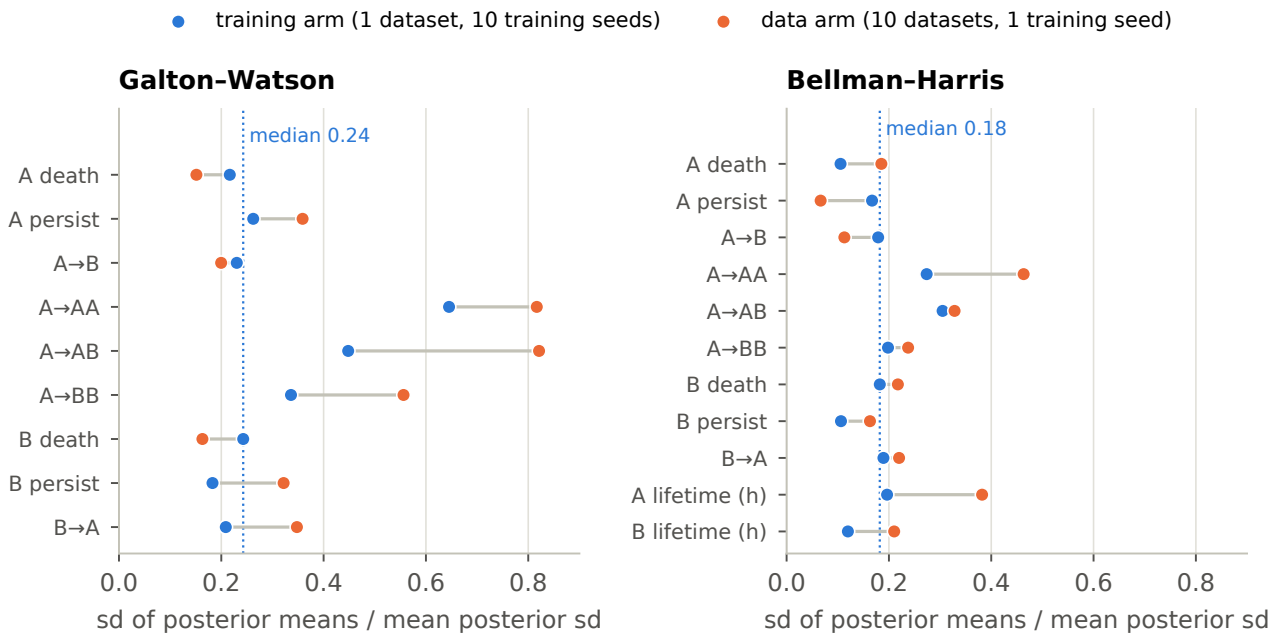


Figure 27: X2: sd of the posterior means over 10 runs, divided by the mean posterior sd, per parameter. Blue: training arm (one dataset, 10 training seeds); orange: data arm (10 datasets, one training seed; includes that network's training noise). Dotted: median of the training arm.

	Galton–Watson			Bellman–Harris		
Parameter	post. sd	sd train	sd data	post. sd	sd train	sd data
A death	0.019	0.004	0.003	0.047	0.005	0.009
A persist	0.034	0.009	0.012	0.089	0.015	0.006
A→B	0.025	0.006	0.005	0.049	0.009	0.006
A→AA	0.032	0.021	0.027	0.088	0.024	0.041
A→AB	0.047	0.021	0.038	0.107	0.033	0.035
A→BB	0.035	0.012	0.019	0.087	0.017	0.021
B death	0.084	0.020	0.014	0.137	0.025	0.030
B→A	0.123	0.026	0.043	0.194	0.037	0.043
B persist	0.106	0.019	0.034	0.178	0.019	0.029
τ_A (h)	—	—	—	1.88	0.37	0.72
τ_B (h)	—	—	—	11.5	1.38	2.42
Median sd train / post. sd		0.24			0.18	
Median training share		0.53			0.70	

Comment

- **Training noise is small relative to the posterior width**: ≈20% of the posterior sd (its variance ≈4% of the posterior variance). One trained network gives a reliable posterior, and differences between arms larger than ≈0.3 posterior sd are not training artefacts. Exception: GW A→AA, whose posterior is narrow (sd 0.032), so training noise is 65% of it.
- **At this design the dataset spread is not much larger than the training spread** (training ≈ half of the between-run variance in GW, ≈70% in BH): the seed-to-seed sd reported in the other experiments is roughly half training noise, half data noise.
- **Posterior sds are wider than the spread of posterior means across datasets** (GW B→A 0.123 vs 0.043), consistent with coverage at or near 1 for most parameters: at the real-like design the posteriors are conservative (prior-shrunk), and the seed-to-seed sd is not a measure of data uncertainty — the posterior sd is.
- **The BH ridge bias is not noise**: the means agree between arms (training vs data arm: A→AA 0.38 vs 0.36, covered in 0/10 and 1/10 runs; τ_A 16.4 vs 16.5 h), i.e. the same for every dataset and every training seed.
- Consequence: keep 5 seeds (varying both) for averaging; quote the posterior sd as uncertainty and the seed sd only as a stability check. A larger simulation budget mainly reduces the training part (§4.1).
- Caveats: one configuration (real-like, `reversible_ab`, NPE 5k); the data arm includes the training noise of seed 0, so the data spread is not "pure"; SBC and PPC also depend on `seed` and were not analysed here.

22 X3 — Galton–Watson fitted to Bellman–Harris data

Question

Real-data fits need a time model. GW (synchronous generations) is simpler, has no lifetime ridge and flags more errors; BH (Gamma lifetimes) is closer to biology. If the data are BH, can GW with a fixed generation length of τ hours recover the outcome probabilities, which τ works, and do the checks flag a wrong τ?

Setup

Data model	BH `reversible_ab`, $\theta^\star$ (τ_A 20 h, τ_B 30 h, shape 8), perfect observation; the same 5 datasets in every arm (verified by dataset hash)
Inference model	GW `reversible_ab` on an hour axis (`simulator=galton_watson_hours`, §1.5): $\tau \in \{16, 20, 24, 30\}$ h, i.e. 9/15, 7/12, 6/10, 5/8 generations at 144/240 h (rounding ≤ 0.2 generation); control: BH, the true model
Design	real-like: 144/240 h × 165/101
Inference / budget	NPE amortised, 5k; SBC 200, PPC 200. Scored on the 9 shared outcome probabilities (GW has no lifetimes)
Seeds / runs	5 / 25 (20 GW + 5 BH)
Folder	`results/x3/gw`, `results/x3/bh_control`

Result

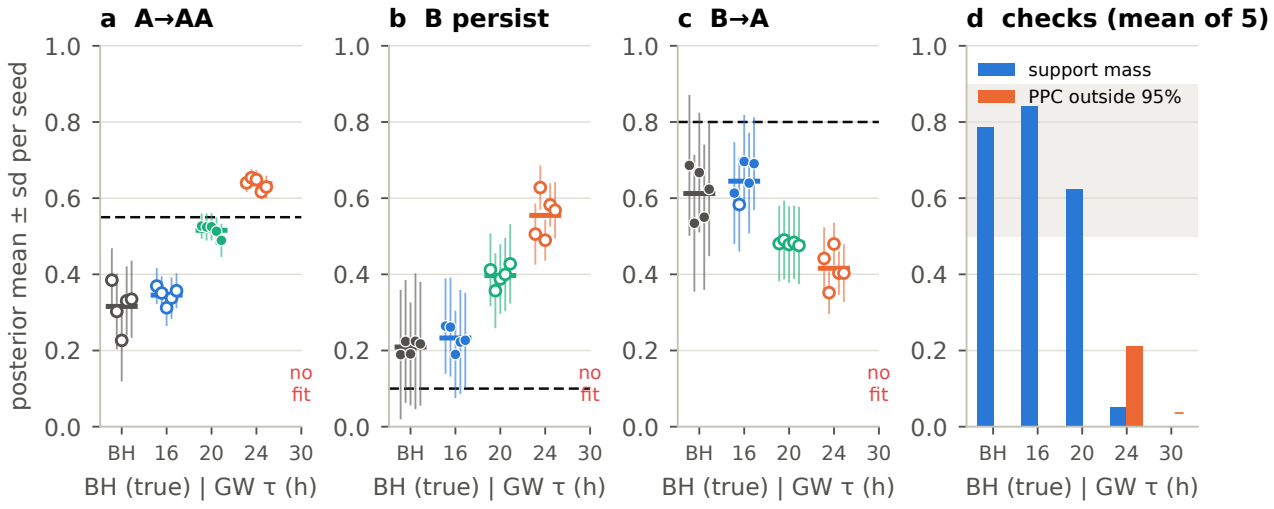


Figure 28: X3: GW with a fixed generation length τ fitted to BH data (τ_A 20 h, τ_B 30 h). (a–c) Posterior mean ± sd per seed (filled = truth in the 90% interval, open = not covered; bar = mean over seeds); dashed = truth; BH = the true model (control). τ = 30 h gives no posterior samples inside the prior. (d) Posterior support mass and PPC fraction outside 95% (mean of 5 seeds); grey band = well-specified support range.

Arm	MAE	90% cov.	contr.	support	PPC	SBC	A→AA (0.55)	B persist (0.10)	B→A (0.80)
BH (true)	0.116	0.82	0.58	0.79	0.000	0.026	0.32 [0/5]	0.21 [5/5]	0.61 [5/5]
GW $\tau = 16$ h	0.088	0.87	0.81	0.84	0.000	0.034	0.35 [0/5]	0.23 [5/5]	0.64 [4/5]
GW $\tau = 20$ h	**0.086**	0.78	0.89	0.62	0.000	0.034	**0.52 [5/5]**	0.40 [0/5]	0.48 [0/5]
GW $\tau = 24$ h	0.122	0.27	0.96	**0.05**	**0.21**	0.032	0.64 [0/5]	0.55 [0/5]	0.42 [0/5]
GW $\tau = 30$ h	—		—	**0.00**	—	0.032	no posterior samples inside the prior		

Means over 5 seeds; [covered/5].
Numbers: `results/x3/x3_groups.csv`, `x3_parameters.csv`; plotted: `tables/x3.csv`.

Comment

- **A GW model with τ at or below the fastest lifetime fits without any warning** (PPC 0, support 0.62–0.84). τ = A's lifetime (20 h) recovers A's row (A→AA 0.52; all A parameters 5/5 covered), but B divides every 30 h, not 20 h, so GW explains B's slower cycle as **persistence** (B persist 0.40 vs 0.10) and lowers B→A (0.48 vs 0.80): a silent bias in B's row. With $\tau = 16$ h the bias moves into A's row (A→AA 0.35).
- **τ longer than A's lifetime fails loudly**: GW cannot produce enough cells (τ 24 h: support 0.05, PPC 21%; τ 30 h: no posterior samples inside the prior). Same mechanism as a fixed global lifetime longer than τ_A in BH (E3a, §18).
- **GW with the right τ beats the true BH model on A's row** (MAE 0.086 vs 0.116): fixing the generation length is equivalent to fixing A's lifetime, which removes the BH lifetime/self-renewal ridge (cf. §6, lifetimes fixed: A→AA 0.51). The price is that differences in division time between types are absorbed into persistence.
- Consequence: GW is a usable approximation only with τ set from measured division times of the fastest type, and then B's persistence must be read as "slower cycle", not quiescence. Without division-time data τ is not identifiable from these checks inside 16–20 h, while $\tau \geq 24$ h is rejected. On the real data GW at 24 h per generation fails on the 2D counts and cannot reach the 3D sizes at all (§26).
- Caveats: one truth (A 20 h, B 30 h), 5 seeds, NPE 5k.

23 X5 — Role of the prior (GW and BH)

Several earlier failures (E0 B row, BH ridge, original E2c) involved truths in the prior tail. X5 separates what is the prior from what is the data in four parts. Common to all: synthetic data, real-like design (GW generations 6/10 or BH 144/240 h; 165/101 clones unless swept), perfect observation, one A founder, NPE 5k (`budget=dev`), SBC 200, PPC 200; 355 runs in total (X5a 250, X5b 15, X5c 30, X5d 60). Folder `results/x5/` (overview `info.md`, per-part tables `x5*_findings.md`).

23.1 X5a — Truth position × prior shape (GW)

Question

Does recovery of B→A depend on where the truth sits in the prior (0.1–0.9) and on the prior's shape, with B divisions free vs fixed? Is E0's failure a tail-truth effect?

Setup

Data model	GW; B→A $\in \{0.1, 0.3, 0.5, 0.7, 0.9\}$, B death = B persist = $(1 - \text{B} \to \text{A})/2$; other parameters $\theta^\star$
Laws (data = inference)	`two_type` (B divisions free, 10 free) and `reversible_ab` (B divisions fixed to 0, 7 free). Prior P(B→A > 0.9): 10^{-5} resp. 0.01
Priors (inference only)	uniform Dirichlet; Jeffreys (all concentrations 0.5); flat marginal on B→A (Beta(1,1): concentration 0.2 on B's 5 other outcomes in `two_type`, 0.5 on death/persist in `reversible_ab`). *Biological* (Dirichlet pseudo-counts per type, each row sums to 1; total ≈ 5–6 = weakly informative): **bio-B** = B row only, death/persist/to_A 1.5 and B divisions 0.2 each (`two_type`; fixed in `reversible_ab`), A row uniform; **bio** = bio-B plus A row death/persist/to_B 0.5, div_AA 2, div_AB 1, div_BB 1.5. Rationale: encode the biology without the answer — A (stem-like) mostly divides, self-renewal most likely; B (differentiated) rarely divides but may die, persist or switch back. bio-B vs bio separates B's prior from A's
Seeds / runs	5 / 125 per law (250: 150 reference + 100 biological)
Folder	`results/x5/a_two_type/`, `results/x5/a_reversible_ab/`, biological priors in `a_two_type_bio/`, `a_reversible_ab_bio/` (pooled `x5a_groups.csv`, `x5a_runs.csv` in the first two)

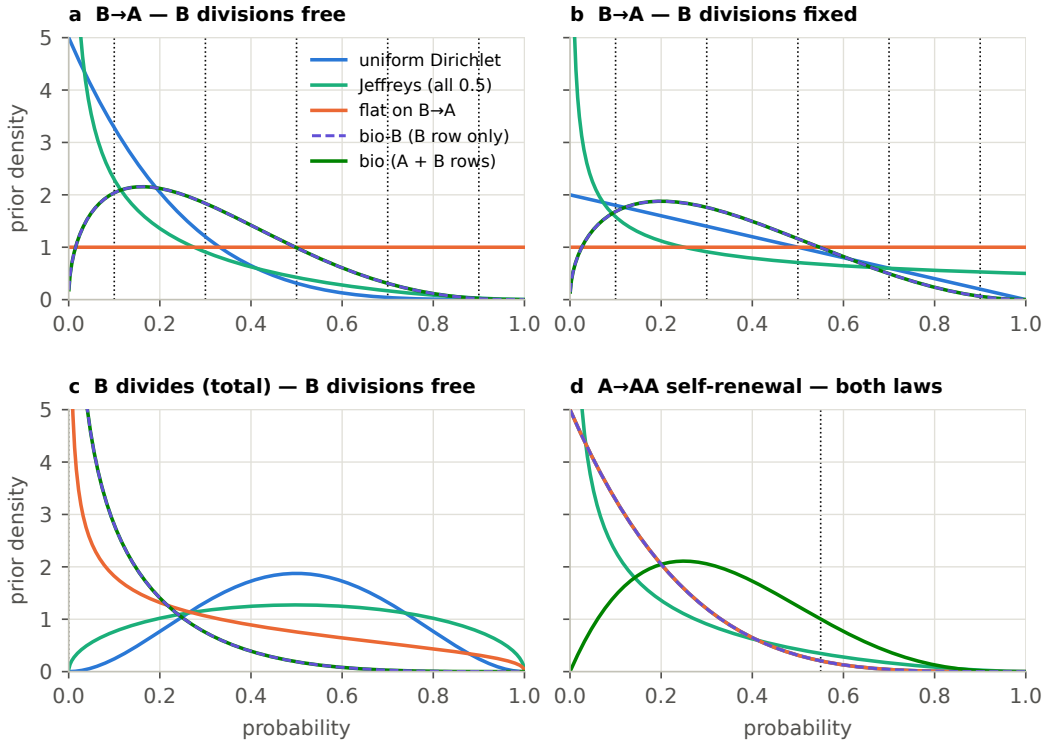


Figure 29: The five X5a priors compared (inference model; exact Beta marginals of the Dirichlet priors). (a, b) B→A with B divisions free / fixed; (c) total probability that B divides (B→AA + AB + BB), B divisions free; (d) A→AA, identical for both laws. Curves that coincide are drawn on top of each other: bio-B (dashed) = bio in (a–c); uniform = flat B→A = bio-B in (d). Dotted: truths used in X5a (B→A 0.1–0.9; B divisions 0; A→AA 0.55). Densities clipped at 5. Beta parameters, quantiles and tail probabilities: `tables/x5a_priors.csv`.

Result

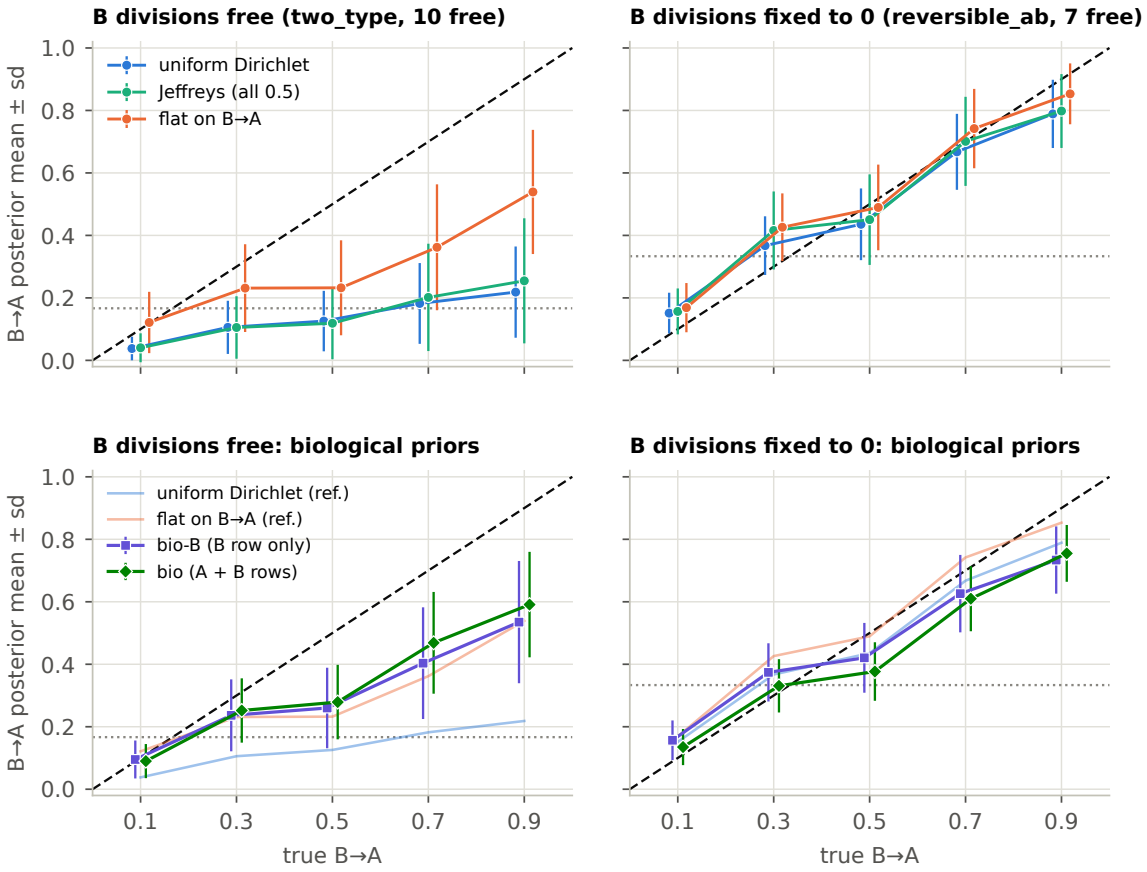


Figure 30: X5a: B→A posterior mean (mean over 5 seeds) ± mean posterior sd against the true B→A, one line per prior (slightly offset). Top: reference priors; bottom: biological priors bio-B and bio, with the uniform and flat-B→A means as thin reference lines. Dashed: identity (perfect recovery). Dotted: uniform-prior mean (1/6 left, 1/3 right).

	B divisions free (`two_type`)			B divisions fixed (`reversible_ab`)		
Truth	uniform	Jeffreys	flat B→A	uniform	Jeffreys	flat B→A
0.1	0.04 (3/5)	0.04 (5/5)	0.12 (5/5)	0.15 (5/5)	0.16 (4/5)	0.17 (5/5)
0.3	0.11 (1/5)	0.11 (2/5)	0.23 (5/5)	0.37 (5/5)	0.42 (5/5)	0.43 (4/5)
0.5	0.13 (0/5)	0.12 (0/5)	0.23 (2/5)	0.44 (5/5)	0.45 (5/5)	0.49 (5/5)
0.7	0.18 (0/5)	0.20 (0/5)	0.36 (3/5)	0.67 (5/5)	0.70 (5/5)	0.74 (5/5)
0.9	0.22 (0/5)	0.26 (0/5)	0.54 (1/5)	0.79 (5/5)	0.80 (5/5)	0.85 (5/5)
SBC error	0.037	0.054	0.080	0.032	0.056	0.037

	B divisions free (`two_type`)		B divisions fixed (`reversible_ab`)	
Truth	bio-B	bio (A+B)	bio-B	bio (A+B)
0.1	0.10 (5/5)	0.09 (5/5)	0.16 (4/5)	0.14 (5/5)
0.3	0.24 (5/5)	0.25 (5/5)	0.37 (4/5)	0.33 (5/5)
0.5	0.26 (1/5)	0.28 (1/5)	0.42 (5/5)	0.38 (4/5)
0.7	0.40 (2/5)	0.47 (3/5)	0.63 (5/5)	0.61 (4/5)
0.9	0.54 (1/5)	0.59 (1/5)	0.73 (1/5)	0.75 (3/5)
run MAE	0.05–0.09	0.03–0.07	0.03–0.06	0.03–0.05
SBC error	0.052	0.055	0.033	0.041
B-division mass	0.21	0.11	—	—

B→A posterior mean (seeds covered by the 90% interval). Run MAE = range over truths of the mean per-run MAE (all free parameters); B-division mass = posterior total of B→AA/AB/BB (truth 0; 0.54 under the uniform and flat priors). Reference priors, run MAE: free 0.12–0.15 (uniform), 0.10–0.16 (flat); fixed 0.02–0.06 (uniform). Numbers: `tables/x5a.csv`.

Comment

- **B divisions free: the estimate hardly follows the truth** (0.04 → 0.22 as the truth goes 0.1 → 0.9, uniform prior); no truth ≥ 0.5 is covered under the uniform or Jeffreys prior, and B→A contraction falls to ≤ 0 at 0.9. The data cannot separate switching from division, so the prior sets the answer — at *every* truth position, not only in the tail.
- A flat prior on B→A tracks better (0.12 → 0.54) but still shrinks heavily and costs calibration (SBC 0.080) and coverage of the other parameters (run coverage 0.62–0.87).
- **B divisions fixed: every truth is recovered under every prior** (B→A contraction 0.73–0.94; the three priors differ by ≤ 0.06, mild shrinkage at the extremes). The prior only matters once the model is structurally confounded.
- Conclusion for E0 (§2): the B-row failure is structural (switching vs division), not a bad truth position; a prior cannot substitute for the constraint. Confirmed at 4096 organoids per endpoint with a 20k network (§2.1).
- **Biological priors.** *B divisions free*: the soft "B rarely divides" prior cuts the posterior B-division mass from 0.54 to 0.21 (bio-B) and 0.11 (bio); B→A tracks like the flat prior (0.54–0.59 at truth 0.9) but with better calibration (SBC 0.05 vs 0.08) and the lowest error of any free-B prior (run MAE 0.03–0.07 for bio; the A-row prior gives most of this gain). It is still far from the hard constraint (0.79, 5/5 at truth 0.9): truths ≥ 0.5 are mostly not covered. *B divisions fixed*: the symmetric 1.5 prior on B's three outcomes (mean 1/3) shrinks B→A toward 1/3, and truth 0.9 is covered in only 1/5 (bio-B) and 3/5 (bio) seeds; the A-row prior lowers the error and raises support mass (0.79–0.89 vs 0.64–0.79 uniform). A soft biological prior helps but does not replace the constraint; with the constraint, keep B's prior near-uniform.

23.2 X5b — Informative lifetime prior, right vs wrong (BH)

Question

Fixing lifetimes resolves the BH ridge (§6). What does an informative (literature) lifetime prior do if it is centred on the truth, or 50% too long (truth outside the prior)?

Setup

Simulator / law	Bellman–Harris shape 8, `reversible_ab` (9 free); data $\theta^\star$ (τ_A 20 h, τ_B 30 h)
Lifetime priors (log-uniform)	vague: [10, 80] h for both (= BH ridge control, bit-identical to E3b); right (±25%): A [16, 25], B [24, 37.5] h; wrong (+50%): A [24, 37.5], B [36, 56.25] h
Seeds / runs	5 / 15
Folder	`results/x5/b_vague/`, `b_right/`, `b_wrong/` (`x5b_groups.csv`)

Result

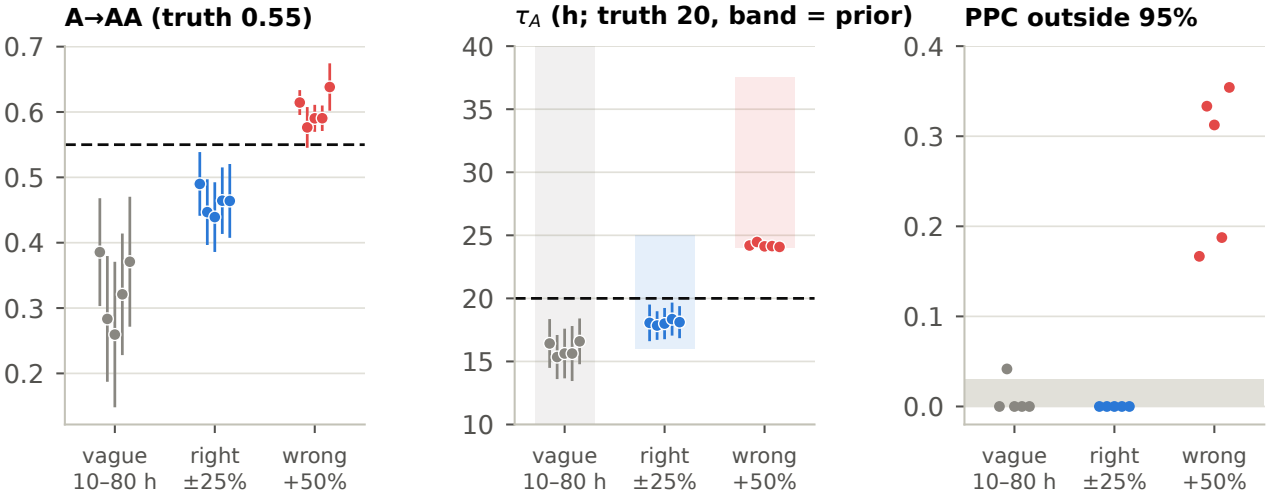


Figure 31: X5b: A→AA and τ_A per seed (posterior mean ± sd) and PPC per run for the three lifetime priors. Dashed = truth; shaded band = prior range of τ_A (vague prior extends to 80 h); grey band in the PPC panel = well-specified range.

Parameter (truth)	vague [10, 80] h	right (±25%)	wrong (+50%)
A→AA (0.55)	0.32 ± 0.10, 0/5	0.46 ± 0.05, 2/5	0.60 ± 0.03, 1/5
A→AB (0.05)	0.23 ± 0.12, 3/5	0.18 ± 0.08, 2/5	0.20 ± 0.06, 1/5
A→BB (0.29)	0.19 ± 0.09, 5/5	0.19 ± 0.06, 1/5	0.17 ± 0.04, 1/5
B→A (0.80)	0.63 ± 0.18, 5/5	0.69 ± 0.16, 5/5	0.68 ± 0.14, 5/5
τ_A (20 h)	15.9 ± 1.9, 0/5	18.1 ± 1.3, 4/5	24.2 ± 0.2 (prior edge), 0/5
τ_B (30 h)	20.2 ± 9.5, 4/5	29.5 ± 3.6, 5/5	49 ± 5.3, 0/5
MAE probabilities / rel. error lifetimes	0.109 / 0.26	**0.068** / 0.06	0.082 / 0.42
Support mass / PPC outside 95%	0.74–0.83 / 0.008	0.57–0.72 / 0.000	**0.00–0.02 / 0.27**
SBC coverage error	0.027	0.028	0.027

Mean over 5 seeds ± mean posterior sd, seeds covered. Lifetimes fixed exactly (§6): A→AA 0.51, MAE 0.059.

Comment

- **A right literature prior moves along the ridge towards the truth**: A→AA 0.32 → 0.46, lifetimes about right, MAE 0.109 → 0.068 — most of the way to fixing lifetimes exactly (0.51, 0.059), at the real-like design. More organoids alone reach a similar point only at 4096 per endpoint and with 20k simulations (A→AA 0.50); a 20k network does not help at the real-like design (0.33) and gives 0.44 at 512 per endpoint on three endpoints (§4.1). At realistic sizes lifetime information is the lever.
- **A prior 50% too long is clearly flagged**: support ≈ 0, PPC 0.27 (0.17–0.35), A's lifetime pinned at the prior's lower edge (the data push against it). Consistent with E3a, where too-long lifetimes fail visibly and too-short ones bias silently. Probabilities remain off (1/5 covered) despite high contraction.
- Caveat: one truth ($\theta^\star$), 5 seeds; a too-short wrong prior was not tested.

23.3 X5c — Data vs prior at a tail truth (GW)

Question

With all transitions free and a tail truth (B→A = 0.9, prior P = 10^{-5} under Beta(1,5)), how many organoids overrule the prior?

Setup

Data model	GW, `two_type`; B: death 0.05, persist 0.05, B→A 0.9 (B divisions 0); A row $\theta^\star$
Inference	`two_type` (10 free), uniform Dirichlet vs flat marginal on B→A (concentration 0.2 on B's other outcomes)
Design	generations 6/10 × {32, 128, 512} clones per endpoint
Seeds / runs	5 / 30
Folder	`results/x5/c_data_vs_prior/` (`x5c_groups.csv`, `x5c_runs.csv`)

Result

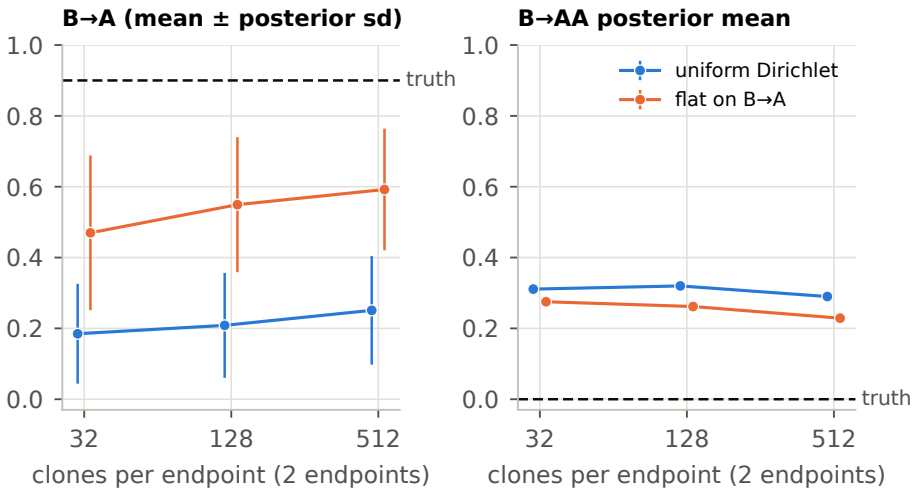


Figure 32: X5c: B→A (mean over 5 seeds ± mean posterior sd) and B→AA posterior mean against clones per endpoint; dashed = truth.

Prior	clones	B→A (0.9)	post. sd	cov.	contr.	B→AA (0)	MAE	support	SBC
uniform	32	0.19	0.14	0/5	0.01	0.31	0.161	0.79	0.031
	128	0.21	0.15	0/5	−0.10	0.32	0.151	0.72	0.037
	512	0.25	0.15	0/5	−0.17	0.29	0.139	0.55	0.044
flat B→A	32	0.47	0.22	2/5	0.44	0.28	0.119	0.49	0.078
	128	0.55	0.19	1/5	0.57	0.26	0.101	0.42	0.081
	512	0.59	0.17	1/5	0.65	0.23	0.086	0.46	0.083

PPC ≤ 0.03 in every group. Numbers: `tables/x5c.csv`.

Comment

- **1024 organoids do not overrule the uniform prior**: B→A moves 0.19 → 0.25 (truth 0.9), never covered, contraction ≤ 0; the mass goes to B→AA (≈0.3, truth 0) — the switching/division confounding of E0.
- A flat prior helps and improves with data (0.47 → 0.59, contraction up to 0.65) but is still far from 0.9 at 1024 organoids and costs calibration (SBC 0.08).
- Endpoint counts of this kind cannot resolve the confounding by sample size at realistic scales; the structural constraint (B divisions fixed, X5a) is what works. Whether a far larger design with a better-trained network would succeed (a larger simulation budget does matter at very large designs, §4.1) is tested in §2.1: it does not.

23.4 X5d — Performance averaged over the prior (GW and BH)

Question

Every other experiment uses one hand-picked truth, partly in the prior tail. Averaged over truths drawn from the prior, are GW and BH calibrated and informative?

Setup

Data = inference	`reversible_ab`, 30 truths drawn from the prior (`truth.source=prior`, `data_seed` = seed 0–29; no redraws needed); BH lifetime prior log-uniform [10, 80] h
Design	real-like: GW generations 6/10, BH 144/240 h; 165/101 clones
Seeds / runs	30 per simulator (60)
Prior-mean baseline	error of the uniform Dirichlet mean (1/6 for A's outcomes, 1/3 for B's)
Folder	`results/x5/d_gw/`, `results/x5/d_bh/` (`prior_average_parameters.csv`, `prior_average_runs.csv`)

Result

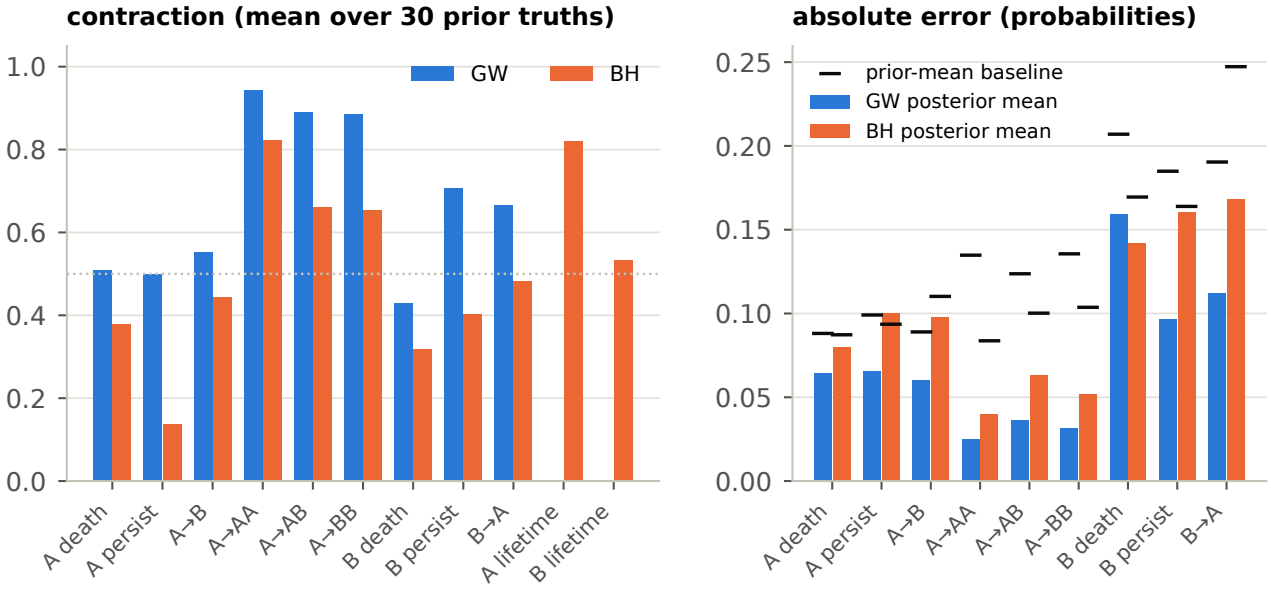


Figure 33: X5d: per-parameter contraction (left) and absolute error of the posterior mean (right; black ticks = prior-mean baseline), averaged over 30 truths drawn from the prior; GW vs BH.

	GW	BH
SBC coverage error	0.032	0.028
90% coverage across truths	0.90	0.90
Mean contraction	0.68	0.51
MAE probabilities (prior-mean baseline)	0.072 (0.139)	0.100 (0.129)
A→AA contraction	0.94	0.82
B→A contraction / coverage	0.67 / 0.90	0.48 / 0.80
Support mass median (min)	0.88 (0.54)	0.89 (0.29)
PPC outside 95%	0.006	0.003

BH mean contraction includes τ_A (0.82) and τ_B (0.53); relative lifetime error 0.21 / 0.35. Numbers: `tables/x5d.csv`.

Comment

- **The methods are calibrated on average**: with truths drawn from the prior both simulators give 90% coverage and SBC error $\approx$ 0.03. Single-truth failures are about specific truths and priors, not broken inference.
- GW learns A's divisions well (contraction 0.89–0.94), A's death/persist/switch about halfway ($\approx$ 0.5), B's row moderately (0.43–0.71; B death weakest).
- **BH learns less** (contraction 0.51 vs 0.68; MAE 0.100 vs 0.072): the lifetimes absorb information; A persist barely moves (contraction 0.14, error no better than the prior mean) and B death / B persist stay close to the prior-mean baseline (0.142 / 0.160 vs 0.170 / 0.164).
- **The BH ridge is a tail-truth effect**: averaged over the prior A→AA is learned well (contraction 0.82), so the failure at $\theta^\star$ (A→AA 0.55, 0/5 covered, §6) is specific to a truth with 1.8% prior mass above it, where the prior picks the point on the lifetime/self-renewal ridge (at realistic sizes whatever the training

budget — 20k simulations leave A→AA at 0.33; the data override the prior gradually, 0.44 at 512 and 0.50 at 4096 per endpoint with 20k, §4.1).
- Caveat: X5d uses real-like generations 6/10; the E0/design-comparison single-truth runs used 4/8/12, so they are not directly comparable.

24 Device and batch-size benchmark

Question

Do GPU training and/or a larger batch (512 vs 128) make runs faster without degrading the posterior?

Setup

Configuration	GW, `two_type`, generations 4/8/12 × 32, NPE 20k, seed 0, SBC 200, PPC 200, 4 threads
Hardware	20-core CPU; NVIDIA RTX A1000 (8 GB, also driving the display)
Varied	device (CPU/GPU) × batch (128/512); SNPE 4 rounds on CPU and GPU
Protocol	one job at a time, contention checked every 15 s (all 6 jobs clean); single measurements
Folder	`results/gpu_bench/` (branch `gpu-bench`, `811d8ca`)

Result

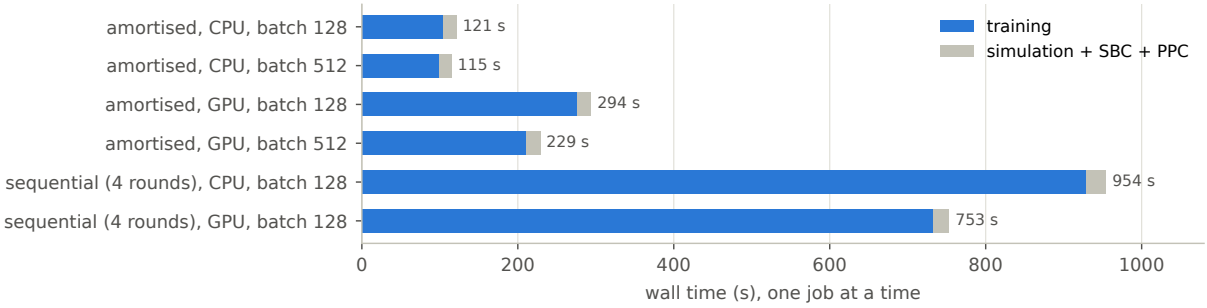


Figure 34: Wall time per job (blue = network training).

Job	wall (s)	s/epoch	epochs	MAE	SBC error
amortised, CPU, 128	121	1.47	71	0.140	0.032
amortised, CPU, 512	115	0.65	151	0.140	0.028
amortised, GPU, 128	294	4.07	68	0.137	0.033
amortised, GPU, 512	229	1.27	166	0.138	0.031
SNPE, CPU, 128	954	4.3	215	0.135	—
SNPE, GPU, 128	753	3.2	226	0.129	—

Comment

- Amortised NPE: GPU 2–2.4× slower (small flows, launch overhead). Batch 512: epochs 2.3× faster but 2× more epochs: −5%.
- SNPE: GPU 21% faster. Quality identical across devices.
- Keep CPU + batch 128; GPU only for SNPE or as extra capacity. Together with P0 (§24.1) these are the only valid timings in this report.

24.1 P0 — Bellman–Harris timing on an idle machine

Question

What does one BH run cost at the real-like design, measured on an idle machine? (Run times in the sweep metrics were recorded under heavy contention.)

Setup

Configuration	`law=reversible_ab`, real-like design (BH 144/240 h, GW generations 6/10; 165/101 clones), NPE, `workers=4 torch_threads=4`
Protocol	one job at a time, nothing else of ours running (load 0.1 at start); single measurement each
Folder	`results/p0_bh_timing/` (`smoke/`, `dev/`, `gw_dev/`)

Result

Run	Budget	Total (s)	Simulation (s)	Training (s)	Epochs
BH	smoke (256 simulations)	3	0.7	0.5	6
BH	dev (5k simulations, SBC 200, PPC 200)	**42**	4	35	102
GW (reference)	dev	45	3	38	80

Comment

- At the real-like design a BH run costs the same as a GW run (≈ 45 s at `budget=dev`); simulation is $< 10\%$ of the time, training $\approx 85\%$.
- The minutes per run recorded in the sweeps reflect machine contention, not BH cost. Larger designs scale simulation roughly linearly in clones (E4: 4096 clones per endpoint take several minutes).

Part II
Real data (CRC0322)

The experiments above used synthetic data only. This part fits the measured CRC0322 organoid counts: it describes the data (§25), climbs a ladder of twelve models until one fits (§26) and reports the final model with the identifiability of each estimate (§27). Write-up: `results/real/info.md`.

25 R — CRC0322 data and fitting procedure

Question

What do the measured CRC0322 organoids look like in the terms of the model, and how are they fitted?

Setup

Organoids	CRC0322, day 6 (165 organoids) and day 10 (101); per organoid, counts of A = LGR5$^+$ and B = KRT20$^+$ cells. Every cell is called A or B (no unlabelled cells: double-positive/negative cells are already forced into one of the two)
Data variants	*3D mean* (primary): rounded mean of the three 3D whole-organoid estimates; *3D sample 1–3*: each estimate alone (organoids with a failed 0-cell estimate dropped: 1/4/4 at day 6, 1/1/2 at day 10); *2D*: the section counts
Relation 3D–2D	3D $\approx$ 4–5$\times$ 2D (median ratio 4.0 at day 6, 4.8 at day 10) with the same A fraction per organoid (correlation 0.996–0.998): the 3D estimates are the 2D section scaled to the whole organoid, not independent measurements
Models	12 candidate models (Table 2), each trained once at the real-like design (BH 144/240 h; 165/101 organoids) with `budget=full`: 50k simulations, SBC on 1000 prior draws
Fit	each trained network conditioned on each data variant (`bio-sbi-infer ... --ppc 500`): posterior support mass and PPC on the 48 summary features (500 predictive datasets)
Criterion	a model *fits* if its support mass is in the synthetic well-specified range (0.5–0.9) and few features lie outside their 95% predictive interval (well-specified synthetic runs: 0–0.10)
Folder	`data/real/` (`scripts/prepare_real_data.py`, `data/real/README.md`); `results/real/<model>/fit_<variant>/`; table `results/real/real_fits.csv`

Result

Feature (across organoids)	3D mean		2D sections	
	day 6	day 10	day 6	day 10
Mean cells per organoid	52	157	13	31
Growth day 6 $\rightarrow$ 10	$\times$3.0 (after $\approx$5.7 doublings in 6 days)		$\times$2.4	
sd of log total cells	0.55	0.73	0.33	0.53
A fraction per organoid, mean (sd)	0.68 (0.28)	0.63 (0.30)	0.68 (0.28)	0.63 (0.30)
corr(A, B) across organoids, counts	-0.13	0.00	-0.45	-0.19
corr(A, B) across organoids, $\log(1+n)$	-0.28	-0.08	-0.53	-0.29
Organoids larger than 2^{day} cells	43 / 165	0 / 101	0	0

Comment

- **Growth decelerates**: $\approx$25 h per doubling up to day 6, $\approx$60 h from day 6 to day 10 (3D).
- **A-rich and B-rich organoids coexist**: the A fraction varies widely between organoids (sd $\approx$ 0.3) and A and B counts are uncorrelated or *negatively* correlated across organoids, although larger organoids have more cells of both types under any shared-parameter branching model.
- GW at one generation per day cannot reach the day-6 3D sizes (43 organoids exceed 2^6 cells); all real fits except one 2D control use BH.
- 3D and 2D differ in scale by a near-constant factor; parameters tied to the size scale (lifetimes, K) are expected to differ between them, composition parameters not.

26 R — Model ladder: what the organoids require

Question

Which model ingredients do the organoids require? Starting from the synthetic baseline (`reversible_ab`, one A founder, constant lifetimes), each step adds one ingredient suggested by the previous failure.

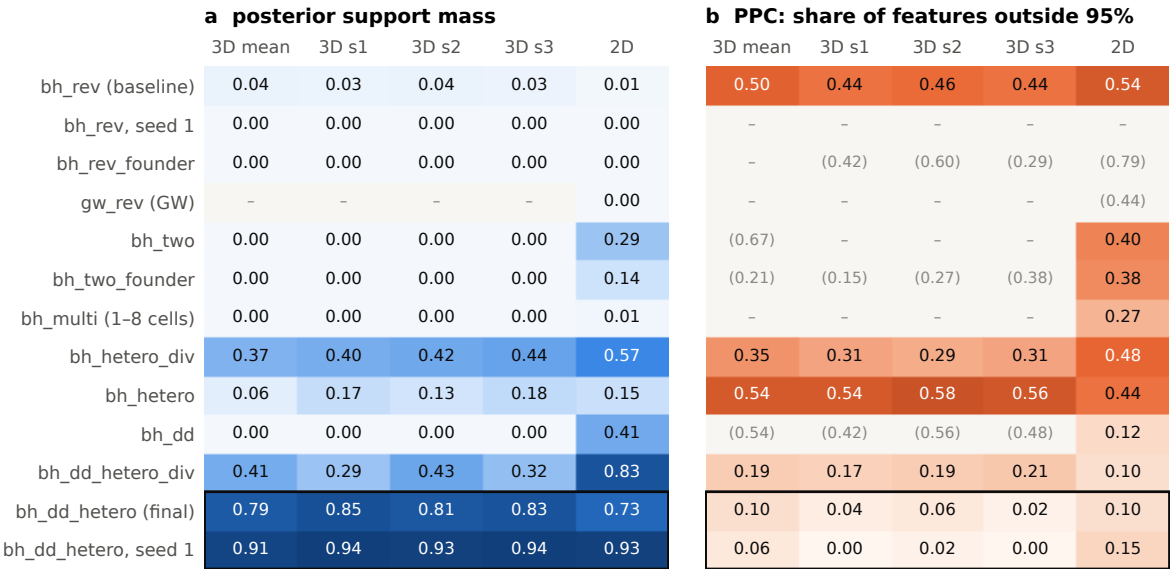
Setup

Simulator	Bellman–Harris, shape 8 (`gw_rev`: GW, one generation per day, 2D only); `bellman_harris_dd` for density dependence
Laws	`reversible_ab` (B does not divide), `two_type` (all 12 outcomes free), `multi_founder` (1, 2, 4, 8 founder cells), `two_type_hetero` (organoid heterogeneity of whole rows, or of the divisions only: `_div`); founder type fixed to A or inferred
Budget	`budget=full` (50k simulations, SBC 1000); one training seed per model, two for `bh_rev` and the final model
Variants	3D mean, 3D samples 1–3, 2D (`gw_rev`: 2D only)
Folder	`results/real/<model>/`

Result

Table 2: Real-data model ladder. Support mass: 3D mean / range over the three 3D samples / 2D (well-specified synthetic fits: 0.5–0.9). PPC: share of the 48 features outside the 95% predictive interval (3D mean / 2D; in brackets: from fewer than 100 posterior samples, unreliable). corr(A,B) z: (observed − predictive mean)/predictive sd of the log-count A–B correlation, day 6 / day 10, 3D mean (`gw_rev`: 2D). Support near 0 means the network extrapolates: such posterior means are not estimates. Full table: `results/real/real_fits.csv`.

Model	B div.	founder	heterog.	dens. dep.	support 3D mean / samples / 2D	PPC 3D / 2D	corr z d6 / d10
`bh_rev` (synthetic baseline)	no	A	–	–	0.04 / 0.03–0.04 / 0.01	0.50 / 0.54	−21 / −60
`bh_rev_s1` (2nd seed)	no	A	–	–	0.00 everywhere	–	–
`bh_rev_founder`	no	inferred	–	–	0.00 everywhere	–	–
`gw_rev` (GW, 2D only)	no	A	–	–	– / – / 0.00	– / (0.44)	−28 / −22
`bh_two`	yes	A	–	–	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.29	(0.67) / 0.40	−16 / −48
`bh_two_founder`	yes	inferred	–	–	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.14	(0.21) / 0.38	−2.6 / −3.8
`bh_multi` (1–8 cells)	yes	inferred	–	–	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.01	– / 0.27	–
`bh_hetero_div`	yes	inferred	divisions	–	0.37 / 0.40–0.44 / 0.57	0.35 / 0.48	−2.0 / −2.2
`bh_hetero`	yes	inferred	all rows	–	0.06 / 0.13–0.18 / 0.15	0.54 / 0.44	+1.3 / +0.4
`bh_dd`	yes	inferred	–	yes	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.41	(0.54) / 0.12	−2.2 / −1.6
`bh_dd_hetero_div`	yes	inferred	divisions	yes	0.41 / 0.29–0.43 / 0.83	0.19 / 0.10	−0.2 / +2.5
`bh_dd_hetero`	yes	inferred	all rows	yes	**0.79 / 0.81–0.85 / 0.73**	**0.10 / 0.10**	−0.7 / +0.8
second seed (`_s1`)					0.91 / 0.93–0.94 / 0.93	0.06 / 0.15	−1.2 / +0.04



–: not fitted (gw_rev: 2D only) or no posterior sample inside the prior. Grey (0.xx): PPC from < 100 posterior samples (support ≈ 0), not reliable.

Figure 35: Real-data model ladder: posterior support mass (a) and PPC share of features outside the 95% predictive interval (b) for every model × data variant. Box: final model, both training seeds. Grey values in brackets: PPC from fewer than 100 posterior samples inside the prior (support ≈ 0), unreliable. Plotted numbers: `tables/real_ladder.csv`.

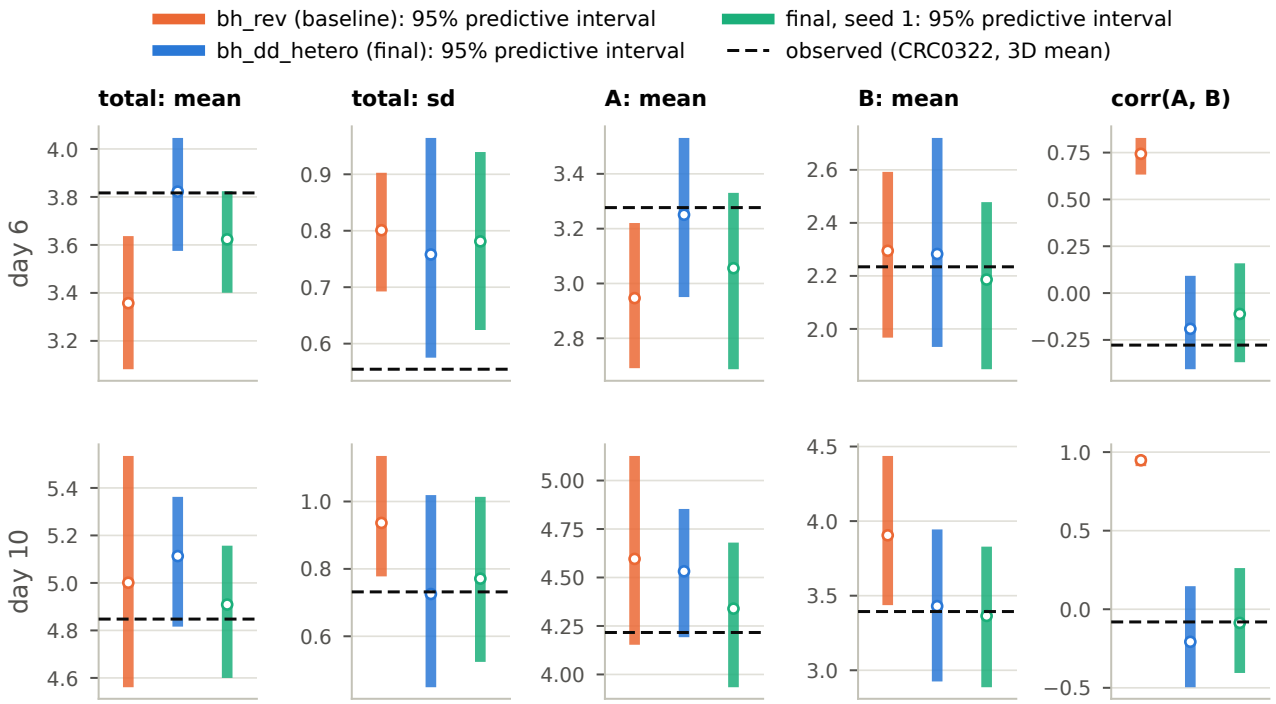


Figure 36: Posterior predictive check on the 3D-mean data, key features of $\log(1+n)$ per organoid (mean of total, A and B counts; sd of the total; correlation of log A and log B across organoids), day 6 (top) and day 10 (bottom). Bars: 95% predictive interval (circle: predictive mean) of the synthetic baseline `bh_rev` (orange) and the final model `bh_dd_hetero` (blue: seed 0; green: seed 1). Dashed: observed. The baseline predicts a strongly positive A–B correlation and too wide, too small day-6 organoids. Plotted numbers: `tables/real_ppc.csv`.

Comment

- **Single-founder branching with shared parameters cannot produce the organoids** (`bh_rev`, `bh_two`, `bh_rev_founder`): it predicts a strongly positive A–B correlation across organoids (larger organoids have more of both), where the data are negative, with A-rich and B-rich organoids side by side. B never dividing (the synthetic baseline) is the worst; letting B divide and inferring the founder type removes most of the correlation misfit (z $-21 \to -2.6$) but not the misfit of sizes (3D support 0.00). The baseline's second training seed does not even put posterior mass inside the prior.
- **Organoids differ in fate**: letting each organoid draw its own outcome probabilities around the shared ones is the first change that brings 3D support into the synthetic range (0.37–0.44 with `bh_hetero_div`).
- **Growth decelerates**: without density dependence day-6 organoids are too small and day-10 organoids too large. Density dependence alone fails (`bh_dd`: 3D support 0.00); with fate-only heterogeneity it fits day 6 but makes day-10 sizes too uniform (z of the day-10 total sd +2.8); with whole-row heterogeneity (organoids differ also in death and persistence) both days fit (`bh_dd_hetero`).
- **Multi-cell seeding does not help** (`bh_multi`, 1–8 founder cells: support ≤ 0.01); its 2D fit, unreliable as it is (support 0.01), puts 76% on single-cell founders.
- **The failures are the ones the synthetic experiments warned about.** Support mass and PPC flag the misfit as in E1a/E1c (GW) and the E2c rerun; the posterior means of the failing models are extrapolations, not estimates (support ≈ 0, as in E2c, §16). GW at 24 h per generation fails as τ longer than A's cycle did in X3 (§22). What the synthetic experiments could not anticipate is that the organoids are not exchangeable copies of one process: every synthetic data set was simulated from shared parameters.

27 R — Final model: fate heterogeneity and density-dependent growth

Question

What does the model that fits say about the organoids, and which of its estimates can be trusted?

Setup

Model	`bh_dd_hetero`: Bellman–Harris, lifetime shape 8; all 12 outcomes free (`two_type_hetero`); founder type inferred; organoid-level heterogeneity of every outcome row (κ); density-dependent lifetimes $\tau_k(1 + N/K)$ (§1.5). 15 free parameters
Priors	uniform Dirichlet per row and for the founder type; lifetimes log-uniform on [10, 80] h; K log-uniform on $[10, 10^5]$; κ log-uniform on [1, 1000]
Training	real-like design, `budget=full` (50k simulations, SBC 1000); two training seeds (`bh_dd_hetero`, `bh_dd_hetero_s1`)
Synthetic check	the trained network on one synthetic dataset from the reference law with $K = 300$, $\kappa = 10$ (`recovery.csv` of the training run)
Folder	`results/real/bh_dd_hetero/`, `results/real/bh_dd_hetero_s1/`

Result

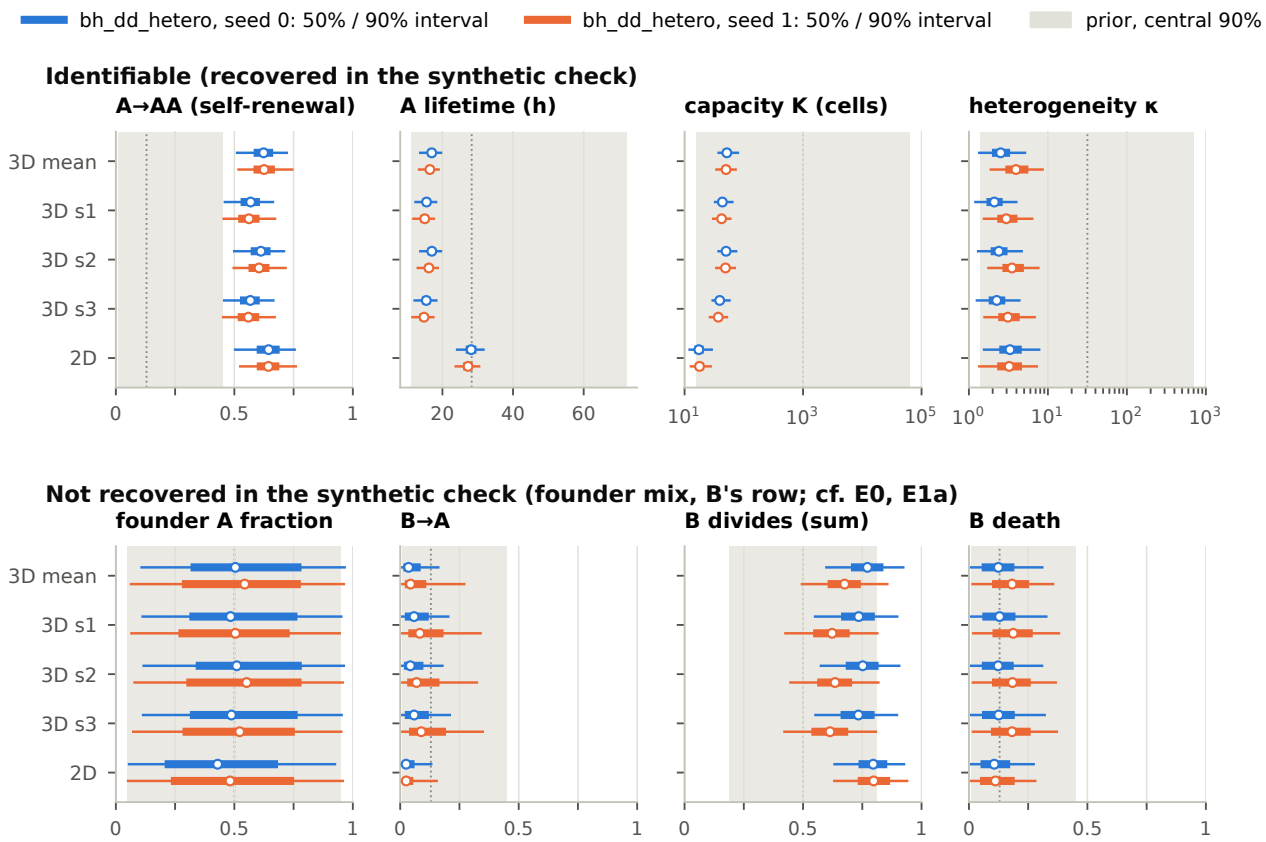


Figure 37: Final model, posterior marginals for every data variant and both training seeds (thick: 50% interval, thin: 90%, circle: median); grey band: central 90% of the prior (dotted: prior median). Top: parameters recovered in the synthetic check. Bottom: founder mix and B's row, not recovered in the synthetic check (B divides = B→AA + AB + BB). Size-scale parameters (A lifetime, K) differ between 3D and 2D by the 3D/2D scale factor. Plotted numbers: `tables/real_posterior.csv`.

Parameter	3D mean	2D	Identifiable? (synthetic check)
A→AA (self-renewal)	**0.62 ± 0.06**	0.64 ± 0.08	yes: 0.51 vs truth 0.55, contraction 0.76
A death / persist / →B	0.09 / 0.06 / 0.09	0.06 / 0.03 / 0.09	moderately (covered; contraction 0.55–0.88)
A→AB / A→BB	0.03 / 0.11	0.08 / 0.10	moderately (A→BB 0.07 vs 0.29, not covered)
A mean lifetime (small organoid)	**16.9 ± 1.7 h**	28.0 ± 2.3 h	yes: 17.3 vs 20 h, contraction 0.99; scale differs 3D vs 2D
Carrying capacity K	**54 ± 13 cells**	18 ± 5	yes: median 216 vs 300, contraction 0.98; scale differs
Heterogeneity κ	**2.8 ± 1.2**	3.8 ± 2.3	yes: median 16 vs 10, contraction 1.00
B mean lifetime	17.2 ± 2.3 h	27.2 h	weakly: 36 vs 30 h, contraction 0.60
B row: →A / →AA / →AB / →BB / death	0.06 / 0.25 / 0.09 / 0.42 / 0.13		**no**: B→A 0.18 vs 0.80, contraction 0.05 (cf. E0)
Founder A fraction	0.54 ± 0.28	0.46	**no**: contraction 0.10, stays at the prior (cf. E1a)

Posterior mean ± sd, seed 0. Synthetic check of the trained network: SBC coverage error 0.012, support 0.89, 90% coverage 0.85. Robustness: over the three 3D samples support 0.81–0.85, PPC 2–6%; a second training seed gives support 0.91–0.94 (3D) and 0.93 (2D), PPC 0–6% (3D) and 15% (2D), and the same estimates: A→AA 0.56–0.63 vs 0.56–0.62, A lifetime 14.7–16.4 h vs 15.4–16.9 h, K 51 vs 54, founder A 0.50–0.54; κ 3.4–4.5 vs 2.3–2.8 (strong heterogeneity either way; the exact value is less stable).

Comment

- **The organoids need fate heterogeneity and slowing growth.** $\kappa \approx 3$ means the per-organoid outcome probabilities vary widely around the population mean (for A→AA ≈ 0.6: sd ≈ 0.25 between organoids); $K \approx 50$ means the division time doubles by ≈ 50 cells in the 3D counts. Neither alone fits; together they reproduce sizes, size spread, composition spread and the A–B anticorrelation on both days (Fig. 36; the day-6 total sd is still at the lower edge of the predictive interval, z -2.1).
- **Identifiable**: stem-like cells self-renew in $\approx 62\%$ of their fates and divide every ≈ 17 h early on. In the synthetic check A→AA came out at 0.51 (truth 0.55), not on the BH ridge value 0.32 of the constant-lifetime model (§6) — possibly because the deceleration carries timing information; one synthetic dataset only.
- **Not identifiable**: how KRT20$^+$ cells contribute (dividing vs reverting to LGR5$^+$) and how many organoids start from each type. The reported B row is shaped by the prior and the model structure, as E0 (§2.1) and E1a (§7) predicted; it is not evidence that KRT20$^+$ cells divide.
- **2D and 3D agree on composition** (A→AA, A's other outcomes, κ) and differ on the size scale (lifetime, K), as expected if 2D sections sample $\approx 1/4$ of the cells.
- Caveats: one trained network per model except the final one (two seeds); support values near 0 depend on extrapolation. The heterogeneity and density-dependence forms are simple choices (Dirichlet around the mean rows; $\tau(1 + N/K)$ with N at birth); alternatives may fit equally well. Mis-typing is not modelled (cf. §14.1: A read as B is the harmful direction), and the 3D counts are derived from the 2D sections (Q3). The synthetic conclusions of Part I (design, error sizes) were obtained under the homogeneous model and should be re-checked under this model class.

Part III

Running and planned experiments

All sweeps of E0–E4, the E2c rerun, X2, X3, X5, P0, the follow-ups of E1b and E2 and the real-data fits are finished (Parts I–II). X1 and X4 are running; their sections will be filled in when the sweeps finish. The other items below have not been started.

28 Running and planned work (X1, X4, follow-ups)

Question

- **X1 methods** (running): NPE vs NLE vs NRE (and SNPE) at the baseline and the worst realistic error.
- **X4 combined errors** (running): realistic combination (organoid death + mis-typing + C + lifetime CV), real-like design: the error budget to quote with a real-data fit. Note that it uses the homogeneous synthetic model, which the real data reject (Part II).
- **Real-data follow-ups** (planned): mis-typing in the real-data model (asymmetric confusion, §14.1); alternative forms of heterogeneity (e.g. per-organoid lifetimes, a mixture of organoid classes) and of density dependence; synthetic checks of the final model class at more truths and designs (which conclusions of Part I carry over); the extinct fraction with survivor summaries once seeded organoids are counted (§10.1).
- **Measurements, then a refit** (implied by §2.1, §4.1 and Part II): A's division time, whether B cells divide, the LGR5→KRT20 mis-typing rate and the number of seeded organoids. Once measured, refit with them as informative priors carrying their measurement uncertainty (as in X5b), with ≥ 20k simulations.

Setup

X1	`+experiment=compare_methods`; NLE/NRE with 50 SBC cases; 3 seeds; folder `results/x1/`
X4	real-like design, 5 seeds; folder `results/x4/`
Blocking	Q1 (C trajectory), Q2 (C proportions), Q3 (2D vs 3D mislabelling), Q4 (meaning of inactivation), Q5 (seeded organoids known?)

Result pending — X1 running

X1: error, contraction and SBC per method (NPE, NLE, NRE, SNPE); to be added when the sweep finishes.

Result pending — X4 running

X4: total bias vs posterior sd per parameter under combined errors; to be added when the sweep finishes.

A Reproducibility

Code versions. `manifest.json` in each run records `git_commit` (HEAD at run time; since `6b45d23` also the commit of the loaded code). Nearly all runs have `git_dirty = true`. Several sweeps span several HEAD values because commits were made while they ran; the loaded code is that of the launch commit (verified for GW E1a: identical networks across settings per seed).

Experiment	Launch commit	Command (preset; `hydra.sweep.dir=results/...`)
E0	`194e31f`, `b3cbae0`	`+experiment=b_row_identifiability law=two_type|reversible_ab; inference.method.rounds=4; +experiment=b_row_flat_prior`
Design comparison	`b3cbae0`	`+experiment=design_comparison` (laws two_type, reversible_ab)
Device benchmark	`811d8ca` (gpu-bench)	`scripts/run_device_benchmark.sh`
E4 BH	`43e9e44`	`+experiment=e4_design simulator=bellman_harris design.horizons=[240],[144,240],[96,144,240],[144,240,336]`
	`5cb6018` (1024, 2048)	same + `design.clones=1024,2048` (folder `results/e4/bh_large`)
	`07fb7fe` (4096)	same + `design.clones=4096` (folder `results/e4/bh_xxl`)
	`07fb7fe` (20k; docs `503ec72`)	`simulator=bellman_harris design.clones=4096 'design.horizons=[96,144,240]' budget.simulations=20000 seed=0,1,2,3,4` (folder `results/e4/bh_xxl_20k`)
	`503ec72` (20k, real-like, 512)	`+experiment=x5b_lifetime_prior budget.simulations=20000 budget.max_epochs=500 seed=0,1,2,3,4` (folder `results/e4/bh_real_20k`) `+experiment=e4_design simulator=bellman_harris design.clones=512 'design.horizons=[96,144,240]' budget.simulations=20000 budget.max_epochs=500 seed=0,1,2,3,4` (folder `results/e4/bh_512_20k`)
E0 at 4096 (`two_type`)	`503ec72`	`+experiment=e4_design law=two_type design.clones=4096 'design.horizons=[4,6,10]' seed=0,1,2,3,4` (folder `results/e4/gw_xxl_two_type_5k`); BH: add `simulator=bellman_harris` with `'design.horizons=[96,144,240]'` (`bh_xxl_two_type_5k`); 20k: add `budget.simulations=20000 budget.max_epochs=500` (`*_two_type_20k`)
BH ridge	`19a10ea`	`+experiment=bh_ridge` (+ lifetimes fixed / A concentration)

Experiment	Launch commit	Command (continued)
E1a type	BH `27b1d61`; GW `19a10ea/d46b4c2`	`+experiment=e1a_founder_type simulator=...` (fixed; inferred with `'~law.fixed.founder'`)
E1a number BH	`27b1d61`	`+experiment=e1a_founder_number simulator=bellman_harris`
E1b	BH `43e9e44`; GW `d46b4c2`	`+experiment=e1b_death_detection simulator=...`
E1c BH	`43e9e44/c919397`	`+experiment=e1c_fixed_death simulator=bellman_harris law.fixed.A.death=0,0.03,0.2 law.fixed.B.death=0,0.1,0.4`
E2a/E2b BH	`27b1d61`–`c919397`	`+experiment=e2a_typing_known`, `+experiment=e2b_typing_ignored`
E4 GW	`19a10ea`	`+experiment=e4_design`
	`5cb6018` (1024, 2048)	`+experiment=e4_design design.clones=1024,2048` (folder `results/e4/gw_large`)
	`07fb7fe` (4096)	`+experiment=e4_design design.clones=4096` (folder `results/e4/gw_xxl`)
	`07fb7fe` (20k; docs `503ec72`)	`+experiment=e4_design design.clones=4096 'design.horizons=[4,6,10]' budget.simulations=20000 seed=0,1,2,3,4` (folder `results/e4/gw_xxl_20k`)
E1a number GW	`b0789d3`	`+experiment=e1a_founder_number simulator=galton_watson`
E1c GW	`d46b4c2`	`+experiment=e1c_fixed_death` (4 × 4 grid; relaunched with bounded SBC)
E2a/E2b GW	`12c0827`	`+experiment=e2a_typing_known|e2b_typing_ignored simulator=galton_watson`
E2c ignore C	`19a10ea`	`+experiment=e2c_third_type`
E2c C modelled	free `d46b4c2`; traj. `12c0827`	`+experiment=e2c_third_type law=three_type|three_type_traj observation=three_split`
E3a / E3b / E3c	`27b1d61`–`c919397`	`e3a_lifetime_free`, `e3a_lifetime_fixed`, `e3b_desync`, `e3c_persist`
E2c rerun (prior truths)	`36d7b07`	ignore C: `+experiment=e2c_prior_truth` C free: `+experiment=e2c_prior_truth law=three_type observation=three_split` C traj.: `+experiment=e2c_prior_truth law=three_type_traj observation=three_split` (folders `results/e2c_prior/<arm>`)

Experiment	Launch commit	Command (continued)
X2	503ec72	+experiment=x2_seeds [simulator=bellman_harris]; training arm seed=0,...,9; data arm data_seed=0,...,9 seed=0 (folders results/x2/<sim>_training, <sim>_data)
X5a	d403cac; bio 7f4a11f	+experiment=x5a_truth_position law=two_type|reversible_ab '++law.concentration={},<Jeffreys>,<flat B.to_A>' biological priors: same with '++law.concentration=<bio-B>,<bio>' (folders results/x5/a_*_bio) (exact lists in the preset header and results/x5/a_*/info.md)
X5b	d403cac	vague: +experiment=x5b_lifetime_prior right / wrong: add '~simulator.model.lifetime_mean_bounds' and '+simulator.model.lifetime_mean_bounds={A:[16,25],B:[24,37.5]}' resp. {A:[24,37.5],B:[36,56.25]}
X5c	d403cac	+experiment=x5c_data_vs_prior
X5d	d403cac	+experiment=x5d_prior_average simulator=galton_watson|bellman_harris
X3	d59df24; BH control a64d17e	+experiment=x3_gw_fit_bh (folder results/x3/gw; τ = hours_per_generation=16,20,24,30) control: simulator=bellman_harris law=reversible_ab design=real_like budget=dev seed=0,1,2,3,4 (results/x3/bh_control); analysis scripts/analyse_x3.py
E2 asymmetric	ignored: BH fa3e96a, GW a64d17e; known a64d17e	ignored: +experiment=e2_asymmetric (results/e2_asym/ignored) known: add observation=noisy observation.capture=1.0 'observation.confusion=${data.observation.confusion}' (results/e2_asym/known)
E1b follow-up	a64d17e; survivor a63b3a8	+experiment=e1b_all_clones (results/e1b_all/all_clones); add observation=perfect (detected); add summary=survivor_moments (all_clones_survivor)
P0 timing	f0924e6	single runs (no -m): simulator=bellman_harris law=reversible_ab design=real_like budget=smoke|dev; GW reference simulator=galton_watson ... budget=dev; hydra.run.dir=results/p0_bh_timing/{smoke,dev,gw_dev}
R real data: data	341e149	uv run python scripts/prepare_real_data.py (writes data/real/); table uv run python scripts/analyse_real.py; runner scripts/run_real.sh
R: training	bh_rev, bh_rev_founder: 7d16a44; bh_two, bh_two_founder, bh_multi, gw_rev: 08b62fc; bh_rev_s1, bh_hetero, bh_hetero_div: de468b4; bh_dd, bh_dd_hetero, bh_dd_hetero_div: bae0b90; bh_dd_hetero_s1: a63b3a8	single runs: uv run bio-sbi <model> design=real_like budget=full hydra.run.dir=results/real/<name>, <model>: bh_rev: simulator=bellman_harris law=reversible_ab (_s1: seed=1; _founder: '~law.fixed.founder') gw_rev: simulator=galton_watson law=reversible_ab bh_two: law=two_type (_founder as above) bh_multi: law=multi_founder 'law.founder_sizes=[1,2,4,8]' '++law.concentration={}' bh_hetero: law=two_type_hetero '~law.fixed.founder'; _div: add '+law.clone_heterogeneity.outcomes=[div_AA,div_AB,div_BB]' bh_dd*: the same with simulator=bellman_harris_dd
R: fits	as training	uv run bio-sbi-infer results/real/<name> data/real/crc0322_<variant>_bh.csv --out results/real/<name>/fit_<variant> --ppc 500 (_gw files for gw_rev)

Every command has the form

```
uv run bio-sbi -m <overrides> torch_threads=4 workers=4 hydra.sweep.dir=<folder>
```

The exact command, grid and fixed settings are in each folder's info.md; each run's .hydra/config.yaml reproduces it. Packages: bio-sbi 0.2.0, sbi 0.27.0, torch 2.14.1+cu126, numpy 2.5.4, numba 0.68.0, hydra-core 1.3.8, Python 3.12.13.

Rebuilding this report (from the repository root):

```
uv run python report/make_figures.py      # figures/*.pdf, tables/*.csv
cd report && /home/matteo/miniconda3/envs/latex/bin/tectonic report.tex
```

make_figures.py only reads results/ (real-data figures: results/real/real_fits.csv and the fit_* outputs); incomplete sweeps would be skipped and shown as pending boxes. Numbers in tables come from the info.md analyses in results/ (overview: results/overview.md) or from scripts/summarize.py functions (mae_probabilities, per-parameter rows); plotted numbers are in report/tables/.

B Glossary

A, B (C)	LGR5$^+$ stem-like, KRT20$^+$ differentiated (hidden third type)
Amortised NPE	one network trained on prior simulations, usable for any dataset
BH / GW	Bellman–Harris (continuous time, lifetimes) / Galton–Watson (generations)
C2ST	classifier two-sample test; accuracy 0.5 = indistinguishable
Clone / organoid	all descendants of one seeding event; recovered if ≥ 1 cell detected
Contraction	$1 - \mathrm{Var}_{\mathrm{post}}/\mathrm{Var}_{\mathrm{prior}}$
Control (paired)	well-specified run of the same sweep with the same seeds and datasets
Coverage (90%)	seeds whose 90% credible interval contains the truth
Design	endpoints (horizons) $\times$ organoids per endpoint
Endpoint / horizon	destructive measurement time (generations for GW, hours for BH)
Founder	seeded cell; `founder` = type mix, `founder_size` = cells per clone
Heterogeneity κ	concentration of the per-organoid outcome rows (§1.5); small = organoids differ strongly
Carrying capacity K	organoid size at which density-dependent lifetimes have doubled, $\tau_k(1 + N/K)$
Data variant	one version of the CRC0322 counts: 3D mean, 3D sample 1–3, 2D sections (§25)
Lifetime τ_A, τ_B	mean time from birth to the cell's event (BH), Gamma with shape 8
MAE	mean absolute error of posterior means over the outcome probabilities
Observed fraction	detected / seeded organoids
Paired SE	SE over seeds of the difference misspecified − control
PPC	posterior predictive check; fraction of summaries outside the 95% predictive interval
Ridge	direction in parameter space along which the data are (nearly) constant
SBC	simulation-based calibration over prior draws
SNPE	sequential NPE (rounds focus on the observed data)
Support mass	share of the NPE posterior inside the prior support
$\theta^\star$	reference truth (Table 1)
Well specified	data model = inference model